

# Optimal Dynamic Selection Under Costly Evaluation: Evidence from Graduate Admissions

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# Motivation

- **Economic Problem:** Selecting best options under costly evaluation
  - Determining each option's true quality costs decision-maker time and effort
  - Low-cost screening of all options  $\Rightarrow$  high-cost evaluation of surviving options
  - **Examples:** Admissions and hiring, clinical trials, matching platforms
- **Why Graduate Admissions:** Benefits graduate programs and future applicants
  - Graduate programs invest time and money into students' development
  - If programs were undervaluing applicants with certain characteristics, future such applicants may receive formerly-withheld opportunities

# Research Questions

- ❶ Which factors in applications affect admission and success in graduate school?
    - Literature measures success with program completion and job placement ranking
  - ❷ Are admissions committees optimizing, or are they making mistakes?
    - Goal is to accept applicants with highest success probabilities who will matriculate
    - Predictors of admission only (success only) may be overvalued (undervalued)
  - ❸ If they are making mistakes, how can they make better admissions decisions?
    - In turn, by changing decision rules, how much better of a cohort can they admit?
- ★ This paper's methods generalize to admissions, hiring, and other settings

# Methodology and Main Results

- Build structural models of admissions committee's decision problem that support:
  - Statistical tests of whether committee's decision rule aligns with desired objective
  - Counterfactual simulations quantifying gains from deviating to model's decision rule
- Estimate model parameters with admissions data from a major research university
  - Do estimated success probabilities align with those implied by committee's decisions?
  - Tests reject optimality and counterfactual deviation gains statistically significant when committee misvalues applicant characteristics, but not when it optimizes

# Literature Review

- **Graduate Admissions:** Regress acceptance and success on applicant characteristics
  - **Original Literature:** Attiyeh & Attiyeh (1997); Krueger & Wu (2000); Grove & Wu (2007); Athey, Katz, Krueger, Levitt & Poterba (2007)
  - **Study of 2002 Cohort:** Stock, Finegan & Siegfried (2006–2015)
  - **New Predictors/Methods:** Bai, Esche, MacLeod & Shi (2022)
- **Optimal Dynamic Selection Under Costly Evaluation:**
  - **Sequential Search:** McCall (1970); Mortensen (1970); Weitzman (1979)
  - **Rational Inattention:** Sims (2003); Matějka & McKay (2015); Caplin & Dean (2015)
- ★ **This Paper:** Builds and estimates dynamic selection models of admissions, which test optimality by relating acceptance effects to success effects

# Synthetic Data Protocol (IRB-Approved)

## ① Administrative office receives data from university departments

- Algorithmically extracts variables from textual files, such as recommendation letters

## ② Synthetic data (Patki et al. 2016) used for model development

- Estimate joint distribution of variables, and simulate synthetic dataset from it
- Rows do not correspond to real subjects, preventing identity disclosure
- Cells with  $< 5$  comparable observations binned to prevent attribute disclosure

## ③ Administrative office executes final estimation code on actual data

- Only summary statistics and parameter estimates are returned to researcher

★ **Contribution:** Privacy-protecting framework for researchers studying sensitive data

# Outline

- 1 Reduced-Form Analysis
- 2 Structural Models
- 3 Structural Estimation
- 4 Optimality Tests

# Data Description

- **Sample:** Applicants to research university's economics, government, history, linguistics, and psychology PhD programs from 2015 to 2023
- **Dependent Variables:** Measures of admission and success
  - **Admission:** Indicators for all stages of admissions process, including waitlist
  - **Success:** Completion and placement category/quality for **all** applicants, with academia-equivalent rankings for non-academic placements (Krueger & Wu 2000)
- **Independent Variables:** Objective vs. subjective
  - **Objective:** Demographics and performance measures, such as GRE scores
  - **Subjective:** Textual processing of recommendation letters, application essays, CVs, and supplemental forms using dictionaries to construct variables



# Reduced-Form Summary

- **Data:** All applicants to all 5 graduate programs from 2020 to 2023
  - Currently have results for acceptance and objective variables only
  - Implementing synthetic data protocol to complete the empirical work
- **Method:** Logistic regressions with lasso for variable selection
- **Results:** Economics admissions cares most about quantitative GRE and undergraduate GPA, and is most data-driven based on goodness of fit
  - Need success data to see if other programs are making mistakes
  - Prolific recommenders increase acceptance probability  $\Rightarrow$  network effects

# Post-Lasso AMEs: Predicting Acceptance

| Dependent Variable = Accept     | Economics | Government | History   | Linguistics | Psychology |
|---------------------------------|-----------|------------|-----------|-------------|------------|
| GRE Verbal Percentile           | 0.0012*** | 0.0013**   | 0.0032*** |             | 0.0022**   |
| GRE Quantitative Percentile     | 0.0119*** | 0.0006*    | 0.0019*** | 0.0009      |            |
| GRE Analytic Percentile         | 0.0014*** | 0.0009**   |           | 0.0009      |            |
| Undergraduate GPA               | 0.1710*** | 0.0267     | 0.0985**  | 0.0499      |            |
| TOEFL/IELTS                     | 0.0299    | 0.0254     | 0.0758*   | 0.0474      |            |
| Elite U.S. University           | 0.0635*** | 0.0144     | 0.0452*   |             | 0.0346     |
| Elite U.S. Liberal Arts College | 0.0806*** | 0.0247*    | 0.0771**  |             | 0.0604     |
| Elite Foreign University        | 0.0365*   |            | 0.0432    | 0.0535      |            |
| Graduate Degree                 |           |            | 0.0210    |             |            |
| Work Experience                 | 0.0293**  | 0.0157     | 0.0383    |             | 0.0722**   |
| #Professor Recommenders         |           |            | 0.0436**  | 0.0259*     |            |
| #Prolific Recommenders          | 0.0209*** | 0.0115**   | 0.0160    | 0.0184**    | 0.0195     |
| #Math Courses                   | 0.0131*** |            |           |             |            |
| Advanced Math                   | 0.0180    |            |           |             |            |
| Pseudo-R2                       | 0.2671    | 0.1500     | 0.1847    | 0.1722      | 0.1844     |

# Acceptance vs. Success AMEs

| Program = Economics             | Accept    | Success |
|---------------------------------|-----------|---------|
| GRE Verbal Percentile           | 0.0012*** |         |
| GRE Quantitative Percentile     | 0.0119*** |         |
| GRE Analytic Percentile         | 0.0014*** |         |
| Undergraduate GPA               | 0.1710*** |         |
| TOEFL/IELTS                     | 0.0299    |         |
| Elite U.S. University           | 0.0635*** |         |
| Elite U.S. Liberal Arts College | 0.0806*** |         |
| Elite Foreign University        | 0.0365*   |         |
| Work Experience                 | 0.0293**  |         |
| #Prolific Recommenders          | 0.0209*** |         |
| #Math Courses                   | 0.0131*** |         |
| Advanced Math                   | 0.0180    |         |

- Admissions literature regresses acceptance and success on variables in applications, and qualitatively compares the effects
- While such comparisons are of interest, they are insufficient to test optimality
- Need model of admissions to relate acceptance effects to success effects

► Insufficiency of Comparing AMEs

# Outline

- 1 Reduced-Form Analysis
- 2 Structural Models**
- 3 Structural Estimation
- 4 Optimality Tests

# Why Structural Models?

- **Reason 1:** Test whether committee's decision rule aligns with desired objective
  - Per literature, committee should accept applicants with highest success probabilities
  - Committees also accept applicants with higher matriculation probabilities
- **Reason 2:** Find counterfactual decision rule in which committee optimizes
  - Quantify gains from deviating from actual to counterfactual decision rule

# Model Framework

- **Portfolio Choice Problem:** Accept subset of applicants with highest sum of success probabilities subject to capacity constraint on number of acceptances
- For each applicant  $n \in \{1, \dots, N\}$ , make decision  $d_n \in \{\text{Accept}, \text{Reject}\}$  given:

$$\max_{(d_1, \dots, d_N) \in \{A, R\}^N} \sum_{n=1}^N \underbrace{P(y_n = S | x_n, z_n)}_{\text{Success probability}} \underbrace{\mathbb{1}(d_n = A)}_{\text{Acceptance}}, \text{ such that: } \sum_{n=1}^N \underbrace{\mathbb{1}(d_n = A)}_{\text{Acceptance}} \leq N_A,$$

where  $x$  = objective variables,  $z$  = subjective variables,  $y \in \{\text{Success}, \text{Failure}\}$ ,  
 $N$  = number of applicants, and  $N_A$  = maximum number of acceptances

# Model Framework

- **Portfolio Choice Problem:** Accept subset of applicants with highest sum of success probabilities subject to capacity constraint on number of acceptances

$$\max_{(d_1, \dots, d_N) \in \{A, R\}^N} \sum_{n=1}^N \underbrace{P(y_n = S | x_n, z_n)}_{\text{Success probability}} \underbrace{\mathbb{1}(d_n = A)}_{\text{Acceptance}}, \text{ such that: } \sum_{n=1}^N \underbrace{\mathbb{1}(d_n = A)}_{\text{Acceptance}} \leq N_A$$

- BEMS (2022) prove that portfolio choice problem reduces to cutoff rule problem
  - Accept applicant if and only if their success probability exceeds cutoff probability
  - Decisions across applicants now independent, so no need to consider all subsets

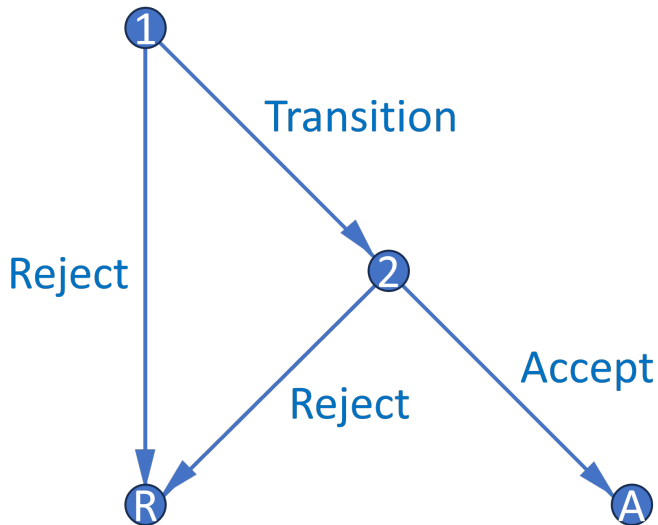
►► Portfolio Choice to Cutoff Rule

# Cutoff Rule Problem

- Start with two-round cutoff rule problem that accounts for costly evaluation:
  - **Round 1:** See only objective variables (e.g. GRE). Can transition application file to Round 2 to see subjective variables (e.g. recommendation letters), or can reject
  - **Round 2:** If chose to transition application file in Round 1, can accept or reject
  - Assume for now committee transitions and accepts optimal number of files
- Along with the baseline dynamic model, there are two additional models
  - Static model makes it possible to compare cutoff probabilities across rounds
  - Waitlist model adds a third round and accounts for matriculation probabilities



# Decision Graph



# Dynamic Model

- **States:**  $r$  = round,  $x$  = objective variables,  $z$  = subjective variables,  $t$  = year,  $\epsilon_r$  = Type 1 extreme value preference shock with scale parameter  $\sigma$
- **Controls:**  $d_1 \in \{\text{Transition, Reject}\}$ ,  $d_2 \in \{\text{Accept, Reject}\}$
- **Outcomes:**  $y \in \{\text{Success, Failure}\}$ ,  $y_r^*$  = marginal outcome

►► Dynamic Parameterization

# Dynamic Model

- **States:**  $r = \text{round}$ ,  $x = \text{objective variables}$ ,  $z = \text{subjective variables}$ ,  $t = \text{year}$ ,  $\epsilon_r = \text{Type 1 extreme value preference shock with scale parameter } \sigma$
- **Controls:**  $d_1 \in \{\text{Transition, Reject}\}$ ,  $d_2 \in \{\text{Accept, Reject}\}$
- **Outcomes:**  $y \in \{\text{Success, Failure}\}$ ,  $y_r^* = \text{marginal outcome}$

## Round 2:

$$v_2(x, z, t, \epsilon_2) = \max_{d_2 \in \{A, R\}} u_2(x, z, t, d_2) + \epsilon_2(d_2), \text{ such that:}$$

$$u_2(x, z, t, d_2) = \underbrace{P(y = S|x, z)\mathbb{1}(d_2 = A)}_{\text{If accept, get } P(\text{Success})} + \underbrace{P(y_2^* = S|t)\mathbb{1}(d_2 = R)}_{\text{If reject, get } P(\text{Cutoff})}$$

# Dynamic Model

## Round 1:

$$v_1(x, t, \epsilon_1) = \max_{d_1 \in \{T, R\}} u_1(x, t, d_1) + \epsilon_1(d_1), \text{ such that:}$$

$$u_1(x, t, d_1) = \underbrace{\mathbb{E}[v_2(x, z, t, \epsilon_2)|x, t]\mathbb{1}(d_1 = T)}_{\text{If transition, get } \mathbb{E}[\text{Social Surplus}]} + \underbrace{L(y_1^* = S|t)\mathbb{1}(d_1 = R)}_{\text{If reject, get } L(\text{Cutoff})}, \text{ such that:}$$

$$\mathbb{E}[v_2(x, z, t, \epsilon_2)|x, t] = \int_{\tilde{z}} \sigma \log \left( e^{P(y=S|x, \tilde{z})/\sigma} + e^{P(y_2^*=S|t)/\sigma} \right) dF(\tilde{z}|x)$$

» Dynamic Parameterization

# Dynamic Model

## Round 1:

$$v_1(x, t, \epsilon_1) = \max_{d_1 \in \{T, R\}} u_1(x, t, d_1) + \epsilon_1(d_1), \text{ such that:}$$

$$u_1(x, t, d_1) = \underbrace{\mathbb{E}[v_2(x, z, t, \epsilon_2)|x, t]\mathbb{1}(d_1 = T)}_{\text{If transition, get } \mathbb{E}[\text{Social Surplus}]} + \underbrace{L(y_1^* = S|t)\mathbb{1}(d_1 = R)}_{\text{If reject, get } L(\text{Cutoff})}, \text{ such that:}$$

$$\mathbb{E}[v_2(x, z, t, \epsilon_2)|x, t] = \int_{\tilde{z}} \sigma \log \left( e^{P(y=S|x, \tilde{z})/\sigma} + e^{P(y_2^*=S|t)/\sigma} \right) dF(\tilde{z}|x)$$

## Conditional Choice Probabilities:

$$P(d_r|x, (z), t) = \frac{\exp(u_r(x, (z), t, d_r)/\sigma)}{\sum_{\tilde{d}_r \in D_r} \exp(u_r(x, (z), t, \tilde{d}_r)/\sigma)}$$

- **Goal:** Make Round 1 cutoff a probability bounded between 0 and 1

» Static Parameterization

- **Goal:** Make Round 1 cutoff a probability bounded between 0 and 1

## Round 2:

$$v_2(x, z, t, \epsilon_2) = \max_{d_2 \in \{A, R\}} u_2(x, z, t, d_2) + \epsilon_2(d_2), \text{ such that:}$$

$$u_2(x, z, t, d_2) = \underbrace{P(y = S|x, z)\mathbb{1}(d_2 = A)}_{\text{If accept, get } P(\text{Success})} + \underbrace{P(y_2^* = S|t)\mathbb{1}(d_2 = R)}_{\text{If reject, get } P(\text{Cutoff})}$$

► Static Parameterization

# Static Model

- **Goal:** Make Round 1 cutoff a probability bounded between 0 and 1

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$$u_2(x, z, t, d_2) = \underbrace{P(y = S|x, z)\mathbb{1}(d_2 = A)}_{\text{If accept, get } P(\text{Success})} + \underbrace{P(y_2^* = S|t)\mathbb{1}(d_2 = R)}_{\text{If reject, get } P(\text{Cutoff})}$$

## Round 1:

$$v_1(x, t, \epsilon_1) = \max_{d_1 \in \{T, R\}} u_1(x, t, d_1) + \epsilon_1(d_1), \text{ such that:}$$

$$u_1(x, t, d_1) = \underbrace{P(y = S|x)\mathbb{1}(d_1 = T)}_{\text{If transition, get } P(\text{Success})} + \underbrace{P(y_1^* = S|t)\mathbb{1}(d_1 = R)}_{\text{If reject, get } P(\text{Cutoff})}$$



# Static Model

- **Goal:** Make Round 1 cutoff a probability bounded between 0 and 1

## Round 2:

$$v_2(x, z, t, \epsilon_2) = \max_{d_2 \in \{A, R\}} u_2(x, z, t, d_2) + \epsilon_2(d_2), \text{ such that:}$$
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- $P(y = S|x)$  estimates inconsistent, but fitted values account for  $x$ 's effect on  $z$

# Portfolio Choice with Matriculation

- Accept subset of applicants with highest sum of success times matriculation probabilities subject to capacity constraint on expected number of matriculants
- For each applicant  $n \in \{1, \dots, N\}$ , make decision  $d_n \in \{\text{Accept}, \text{Reject}\}$  given:

$$\max_{(d_1, \dots, d_N) \in \{A, R\}^N} \sum_{n=1}^N \underbrace{P(y_n = S | x_n, z_n)}_{\text{Success probability}} \underbrace{P(m_n = M | x_n, z_n)}_{\text{Matriculation probability}} \underbrace{\mathbb{1}(d_n = A)}_{\text{Acceptance}},$$

$$\text{such that: } \sum_{n=1}^N \underbrace{P(m_n = M | x_n, z_n)}_{\text{Matriculation probability}} \underbrace{\mathbb{1}(d_n = A)}_{\text{Acceptance}} \leq N_M,$$

where  $(x, z)$  = variables,  $y \in \{\text{Success}, \text{Failure}\}$ ,  $m \in \{\text{Matriculate}, \text{Decline}\}$ ,  
 $N$  = number of applicants, and  $N_M$  = maximum number of matriculants

# Portfolio Choice with Matriculation

- Accept subset of applicants with highest sum of success times matriculation probabilities subject to capacity constraint on expected number of matriculants

$$\max_{(d_1, \dots, d_N) \in \{A, R\}^N} \sum_{n=1}^N \underbrace{P(y_n = S | x_n, z_n)}_{\text{Success probability}} \underbrace{P(m_n = M | x_n, z_n)}_{\text{Matriculation probability}} \underbrace{\mathbb{1}(d_n = A)}_{\text{Acceptance}},$$

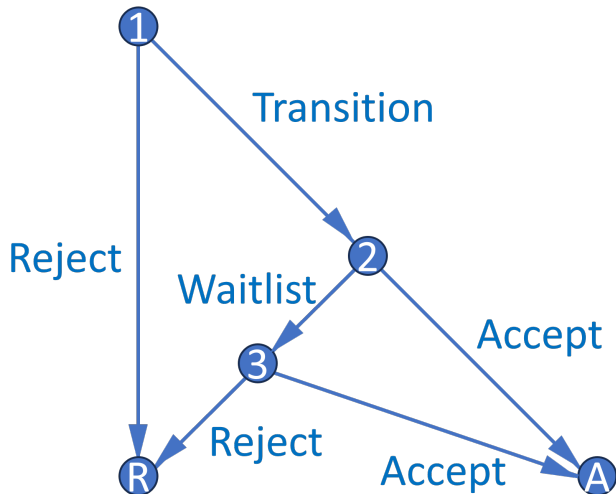
such that:  $\sum_{n=1}^N \underbrace{P(m_n = M | x_n, z_n)}_{\text{Matriculation probability}} \underbrace{\mathbb{1}(d_n = A)}_{\text{Acceptance}} \leq N_M$

## Theorem 1 (Proof)

*For large  $N$ , this problem reduces to a cutoff rule problem on **success** probabilities.*

- Likely matriculants more valuable, but also more expensive  $\Rightarrow$  effects cancel
- Upshot:** Matriculation probabilities only matter if there are dynamic effects

# Waitlist Model



- Three-round model features waitlist and accounts for applicants' decisions
- Equations analogous to those in baseline two-round dynamic model
- Dynamic mechanism incentivizes giving early acceptances to likely matriculants

» Waitlist Equations

# Waitlist Memory

- Respecify Round 3 cutoff  $P(y_3^* = S|t)$ , where  $t = \text{year}$ , as  $P(y_3^* = S|\overline{m_{2A}})$ 
  - $\overline{m_{2A}}$  = average early accepted applicant's matriculation probability based on  $(x, z)$
  - Enthusiasm variables can affect matriculation independently of success
  - $P(y_3^* = S|\overline{m_{2A}})$  increases in  $\overline{m_{2A}}$  because larger  $\overline{m_{2A}}$  means fewer openings
- What information available at start of Round 2 determines  $\overline{m_{2A}}$ ?
  - For all transitioned applicants,  $\ddot{m}_2$ .  $\ddot{m}_2$  is defined as  $\overline{m_2}^t$  with  $m_2$  excluded, where  $m_2$  = applicant's own matriculation probability. Within  $t$ , low  $m_2$  implies high  $\ddot{m}_2$
  - Estimate  $f_{\overline{m_{2A}}|\ddot{m}_2}$  on all transitioned applicants; slope parameter's expected sign is positive provided there is variation in  $\overline{m_2}^t$  across years (e.g. due to Covid)

# Waitlist Dynamics

## Theorem 2 (Proof)

*Success probability equal, an applicant's Round 2 acceptance probability is strictly increasing in their matriculation probability.*

- Compared to high  $m_2$  applicant, low  $m_2$  applicant has high  $\ddot{m}_2$ , and therefore high  $\bar{F}_{\overline{m_2A}|\ddot{m}_2}$ ,  $\mathbb{E}[P(\text{Cutoff})_3]$ , and  $\mathbb{E}[v_3]$ . This increases relative payoff of waitlisting them
- $\mathbb{E}[v_3]$  discounted so payoff from acceptance in Round 3 less than in Round 2
  - Captures chance of losing applicant to another university between rounds
  - If committee is more selective in Round 2, discount factor is closer to 1

★ **Upshot:** Accepting applicants who want to matriculate benefits the program

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# Maximum Likelihood Estimation

$$\begin{aligned}
 \mathcal{L}_N^U(\theta) = & \prod_{n=1}^{N_T} \underbrace{f(z_n|x_n; \theta_F)}_{\text{Density of } z|x} \underbrace{P_{d_{1,n}}(\theta_T) P_{d_{2,n}}(\theta_A)^{\mathbb{1}(d_{2,n}=A)} (1 - P_{d_{2,n}}(\theta_A))^{\mathbb{1}(d_{2,n}=R)}}_{\text{Conditional choice probabilities}} \\
 & \underbrace{P_{y_n}(\theta_S)^{\mathbb{1}(y_n=S)} (1 - P_{y_n}(\theta_S))^{\mathbb{1}(y_n=F)}}_{\text{Outcome probabilities}} \prod_{n=N_T+1}^N \underbrace{f(z_n|x_n; \theta_F)}_{\text{Density of } z|x} \underbrace{(1 - P_{d_{1,n}}(\theta_T))}_{\text{Conditional choice probability}}
 \end{aligned}$$

- In unrestricted likelihood  $\mathcal{L}^U$ , parameterize CCPs with flexible logit specifications
- In restricted likelihood  $\mathcal{L}^R$ , use model CCPs, which depend on structural parameters
- Do success probabilities implied by outcomes align with those implied by CCPs?



# Cutoff Probability Identification

## Theorem 3 (Proof)

*The maximum likelihood cutoff probability estimate is such that the number of acceptances  $N_A$  equals the expected  $N_A$ . Also, for any cutoff probability and  $N_A$ , the likelihood is highest when the committee accepts the best  $N_A$  applicants.*

- Identify each year's cutoffs by how selective committee is that year
- While selectivity identifies cutoffs, sorting improves restricted likelihood
  - If committee engages in sorting, likelihood-ratio test less likely to reject
  - $LR = 2[\log(\hat{\mathcal{L}}^U) - \log(\hat{\mathcal{L}}^R)] \sim \chi_Q^2$ , such that  $Q = \dim(\theta^U) - \dim(\theta^R)$

# Unrestricted Dynamic AMEs (Optimal)

|                             | Advanced Math         | Committee Score        | Transition            | Accept                 | Success               |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------|------------------------|-----------------------|------------------------|-----------------------|
| GRE Quantitative Percentile | 0.0160***<br>(0.0020) | 0.0581***<br>(0.0088)  | 0.0209***<br>(0.0019) | 0.0173***<br>(0.0033)  | 0.0183***<br>(0.0039) |
| Gender                      | -0.0087<br>(0.0308)   | 0.3312***<br>(0.1204)  | 0.0002<br>(0.0298)    | 0.0361<br>(0.0448)     | -0.0089<br>(0.0481)   |
| Demographic 1               | 0.1173***<br>(0.0400) | -1.2807***<br>(0.1529) | -0.0739*<br>(0.0416)  | -0.0853<br>(0.0659)    | -0.0651<br>(0.0707)   |
| Demographic 2               | -0.0097<br>(0.0452)   | -0.9447***<br>(0.1759) | 0.0091<br>(0.0447)    | -0.0316<br>(0.0691)    | 0.1110<br>(0.0676)    |
| Advanced Math               |                       | 0.8894***<br>(0.1239)  |                       | 0.1340***<br>(0.0463)  | 0.1217**<br>(0.0512)  |
| Committee Score             |                       |                        |                       | 0.0167<br>(0.0113)     | 0.0047<br>(0.0119)    |
| Year Transition More        |                       |                        | 0.1727***<br>(0.0276) | -0.2328***<br>(0.0379) |                       |

- Data simulated from reduced-form-calibrated data-generating parameters
- Committee's decision rule aligns with maximizing success probabilities

# Unrestricted Dynamic AMEs (Suboptimal)

|                             | Advanced Math         | Committee Score        | Transition            | Accept                 | Success               |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------|------------------------|-----------------------|------------------------|-----------------------|
| GRE Quantitative Percentile | 0.0160***<br>(0.0020) | 0.0581***<br>(0.0088)  | 0.0194***<br>(0.0020) | 0.0074**<br>(0.0036)   | 0.0175***<br>(0.0039) |
| Gender                      | -0.0086<br>(0.0308)   | 0.3310***<br>(0.1204)  | 0.0377<br>(0.0297)    | 0.0682<br>(0.0441)     | -0.0097<br>(0.0475)   |
| Demographic 1               | 0.1174***<br>(0.0400) | -1.2830***<br>(0.1529) | -0.1024**<br>(0.0412) | -0.1053*<br>(0.0638)   | -0.0517<br>(0.0700)   |
| Demographic 2               | -0.0094<br>(0.0452)   | -0.9475***<br>(0.1759) | 0.0066<br>(0.0441)    | -0.0167<br>(0.0675)    | 0.1142*<br>(0.0659)   |
| Advanced Math               |                       | 0.8895***<br>(0.1239)  |                       | 0.0800*<br>(0.0482)    | 0.1360***<br>(0.0504) |
| Committee Score             |                       |                        |                       | 0.0422***<br>(0.0120)  | 0.0010<br>(0.0121)    |
| Year Transition More        |                       |                        | 0.1887***<br>(0.0273) | -0.2301***<br>(0.0398) |                       |

- Data simulated from reduced-form-calibrated data-generating parameters
- *Demographic 1* and *Advanced Math* undervalued, *Committee Score* overvalued

# Restricted Static Estimates (Optimal)

|                                   | $P(\text{Cutoff})_1$ | $P(\text{Cutoff})_2$ | Success 1   | Success 2  | Sigma     |
|-----------------------------------|----------------------|----------------------|-------------|------------|-----------|
| Year Transition Fewer   Intercept | 49.77%               | 36.60%               | -10.0587*** | -8.9338*** |           |
|                                   | (38.43%, 61.13%)     | (28.53%, 45.50%)     | (2.2082)    | (2.4363)   |           |
| GRE Quantitative Percentile       |                      |                      | 0.1090***   | 0.0882***  |           |
|                                   |                      |                      | (0.0259)    | (0.0275)   |           |
| Gender                            |                      |                      | 0.0070      | 0.0220     |           |
|                                   |                      |                      | (0.1080)    | (0.1620)   |           |
| Demographic 1                     |                      |                      | -0.3346*    | -0.2945    |           |
|                                   |                      |                      | (0.1803)    | (0.2626)   |           |
| Demographic 2                     |                      |                      | 0.1444      | 0.2881     |           |
|                                   |                      |                      | (0.1702)    | (0.2608)   |           |
| Advanced Math                     |                      |                      |             | 0.6055***  |           |
|                                   |                      |                      |             | (0.1854)   |           |
| Committee Score                   |                      |                      |             | 0.0657     |           |
|                                   |                      |                      |             | (0.0419)   |           |
| Year Transition More              | 31.86%               | 64.56%               |             |            |           |
|                                   | (27.27%, 36.83%)     | (47.28%, 78.72%)     |             |            |           |
| Sigma                             |                      |                      |             |            | 0.2149*** |
|                                   |                      |                      |             |            | (0.0597)  |
| LR Statistic   DF   P-Value       | 8.4729               | 9                    | 0.4873      |            |           |

- Likelihood-ratio test does not reject model fitting the data
- In *Year Transition Fewer*, Round 1 cutoff probability  $>$  Round 2 cutoff probability

# Restricted Static Estimates (Suboptimal)

|                                   | $P(\text{Cutoff})_1$ | $P(\text{Cutoff})_2$ | Success 1   | Success 2  | Sigma     |
|-----------------------------------|----------------------|----------------------|-------------|------------|-----------|
| Year Transition Fewer   Intercept | 53.84%               | 37.04%               | -10.3327*** | -7.2584*** |           |
|                                   | (40.49%, 66.66%)     | (27.83%, 47.29%)     | (1.9333)    | (2.2514)   |           |
| GRE Quantitative Percentile       |                      |                      | 0.1123***   | 0.0663**   |           |
|                                   |                      |                      | (0.0227)    | (0.0260)   |           |
| Gender                            |                      |                      | 0.1010      | 0.0839     |           |
|                                   |                      |                      | (0.1144)    | (0.1650)   |           |
| Demographic 1                     |                      |                      | -0.4233**   | -0.3725    |           |
|                                   |                      |                      | (0.1783)    | (0.2547)   |           |
| Demographic 2                     |                      |                      | 0.1588      | 0.2935     |           |
|                                   |                      |                      | (0.1773)    | (0.2525)   |           |
| Advanced Math                     |                      |                      |             | 0.5525***  |           |
|                                   |                      |                      |             | (0.1957)   |           |
| Committee Score                   |                      |                      |             | 0.1161***  |           |
|                                   |                      |                      |             | (0.0447)   |           |
| Year Transition More              | 31.62%               | 66.37%               |             |            |           |
|                                   | (26.62%, 37.07%)     | (47.08%, 81.40%)     |             |            |           |
| Sigma                             |                      |                      |             |            | 0.2473*** |
|                                   |                      |                      |             |            | (0.0680)  |
| LR Statistic   DF   P-Value       | 19.2965              | 9                    | 0.0228      |            |           |

- Likelihood-ratio test rejects model fitting the data at 5% level
- In *Year Transition Fewer*, Round 1 cutoff probability  $>$  Round 2 cutoff probability

# Unrestricted Waitlist AMEs (Optimal)

|                                  | Advanced Math         | Committee Score        | $\ddot{m}_2$         | $\overline{m}_{2A}$   | Transition            | Accept 2            | Accept 3               | Success               |
|----------------------------------|-----------------------|------------------------|----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|---------------------|------------------------|-----------------------|
| GRE Quantitative Percentile      | 0.0164***<br>(0.0020) | 0.0564***<br>(0.0088)  | -0.0083*<br>(0.0045) |                       | 0.0173***<br>(0.0020) | 0.0045<br>(0.0028)  | 0.0082**<br>(0.0034)   | 0.0204***<br>(0.0035) |
| Gender                           | -0.0078<br>(0.0308)   | 0.3118***<br>(0.1188)  | -0.0469<br>(0.0637)  |                       | 0.0116<br>(0.0296)    | -0.0503<br>(0.0362) | -0.0223<br>(0.0404)    | -0.0082<br>(0.0486)   |
| Demographic 1                    | 0.1376***<br>(0.0401) | -1.5764***<br>(0.1549) | 0.0091<br>(0.0902)   |                       | -0.0588<br>(0.0407)   | 0.0284<br>(0.0600)  | 0.0541<br>(0.0654)     | -0.0984<br>(0.0716)   |
| Demographic 2                    | 0.0142<br>(0.0457)    | -1.3590***<br>(0.1784) | 0.0816<br>(0.0969)   |                       | -0.0164<br>(0.0449)   | 0.0493<br>(0.0592)  | 0.0186<br>(0.0675)     | 0.1001<br>(0.0743)    |
| Advanced Math                    |                       | 0.9127***<br>(0.1212)  | 0.1322**<br>(0.0669) |                       |                       | 0.0303<br>(0.0367)  | -0.0076<br>(0.0484)    | -0.0256<br>(0.0520)   |
| Committee Score                  |                       |                        | 0.0112<br>(0.0166)   |                       |                       | -0.0020<br>(0.0096) | 0.0086<br>(0.0118)     | 0.0291**<br>(0.0133)  |
| Year Transition/Matriculate More |                       |                        |                      |                       | 0.1666***<br>(0.0277) |                     |                        |                       |
| $\ddot{m}_2$                     |                       |                        |                      | 1.4277***<br>(0.0007) |                       | -0.0182<br>(0.0158) |                        |                       |
| $\overline{m}_{2A}$              |                       |                        |                      |                       |                       |                     | -0.1459***<br>(0.0034) |                       |

• AME signs as expected  $\Rightarrow$  results extend to three-round waitlist model

# Unrestricted Waitlist AMEs (Suboptimal)

|                                  | Advanced Math         | Committee Score        | $\ddot{m}_2$         | $\overline{m}_{2A}$   | Transition            | Accept 2              | Accept 3               | Success               |
|----------------------------------|-----------------------|------------------------|----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|------------------------|-----------------------|
| GRE Quantitative Percentile      | 0.0160***<br>(0.0020) | 0.0566***<br>(0.0088)  | -0.0082*<br>(0.0045) |                       | 0.0218***<br>(0.0019) | -0.0023<br>(0.0032)   | 0.0062*<br>(0.0034)    | 0.0178***<br>(0.0040) |
| Gender                           | -0.0090<br>(0.0308)   | 0.3124***<br>(0.1188)  | -0.0468<br>(0.0637)  |                       | 0.0684**<br>(0.0286)  | 0.0499<br>(0.0386)    | -0.0954**<br>(0.0442)  | -0.0039<br>(0.0505)   |
| Demographic 1                    | 0.1369***<br>(0.0401) | -1.5750***<br>(0.1549) | 0.0087<br>(0.0902)   |                       | -0.0387<br>(0.0401)   | -0.0205<br>(0.0592)   | -0.1554**<br>(0.0706)  | -0.0159<br>(0.0801)   |
| Demographic 2                    | 0.0116<br>(0.0457)    | -1.3568***<br>(0.1784) | 0.0814<br>(0.0969)   |                       | 0.0901**<br>(0.0431)  | 0.0359<br>(0.0606)    | -0.1432**<br>(0.0661)  | -0.0333<br>(0.0811)   |
| Advanced Math                    |                       | 0.9118***<br>(0.1212)  | 0.1320**<br>(0.0669) |                       |                       | 0.0613<br>(0.0415)    | -0.0034<br>(0.0470)    | 0.0268<br>(0.0543)    |
| Committee Score                  |                       |                        | 0.0112<br>(0.0166)   |                       |                       | 0.0007<br>(0.0087)    | 0.0161<br>(0.0103)     | 0.0074<br>(0.0122)    |
| Year Transition/Matriculate More |                       |                        |                      |                       | 0.1977***<br>(0.0264) |                       |                        |                       |
| $\ddot{m}_2$                     |                       |                        |                      | 1.0524***<br>(0.0003) |                       | -0.0414**<br>(0.0192) |                        |                       |
| $\overline{m}_{2A}$              |                       |                        |                      |                       |                       |                       | -0.1962***<br>(0.0081) |                       |

• AME signs as expected  $\Rightarrow$  results extend to three-round waitlist model

# Outline

- 1 Reduced-Form Analysis
- 2 Structural Models
- 3 Structural Estimation
- 4 Optimality Tests



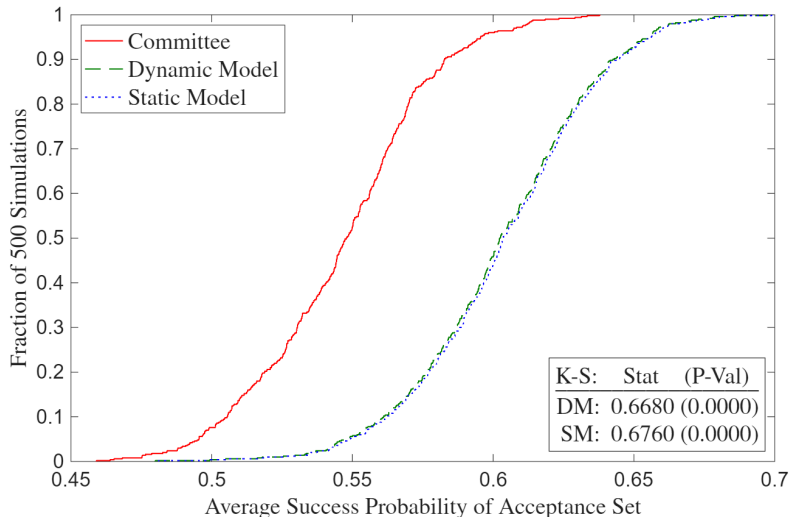
# Likelihood-Ratio and Deviation Gains Tests

- **Likelihood-Ratio:** Determines whether model fits data generated by committee's decision rule, but not whether committee can do better by changing decision rule
- **Deviation Gains:** Suppose committee adopts model's decision rule. Will average success probability of acceptance/matriculation set increase, and if so, by how much?
  - Solve model with  $\sigma = 0$  in CCPs, compute average yearly  $P(\text{Success})$  of model's acceptance/matriculation set, and compare to that of actual decision rule's set
  - $\hat{\theta}_S^R$  may be biased to rationalize suboptimal behavior, so plug in  $\hat{\theta}_S^U$
  - **Example:** If committee puts too little weight on *Advanced Math*, then its restricted success probability parameter estimate will be biased down

# Deviation Gains Interpretation

- Suppose there are meaningfully large deviation gains. Then committee may have incorrect beliefs about which types of applicants are most likely to succeed
  - Matriculation rate of model's acceptance set may be less than that of actual decision rule's acceptance set, making estimated gains an upper bound
  - In waitlist counterfactual, compare success probabilities of matriculation sets by simulating accepted applicants' matriculation decisions after Rounds 2 and 3
- ★ **Robustness:** Given too few observations for holdout set and infeasibility of large  $k$ -fold cross-validation due to runtime, implement randomization test
  - Compute average success probabilities with perturbations of  $\hat{\theta}_S^U$

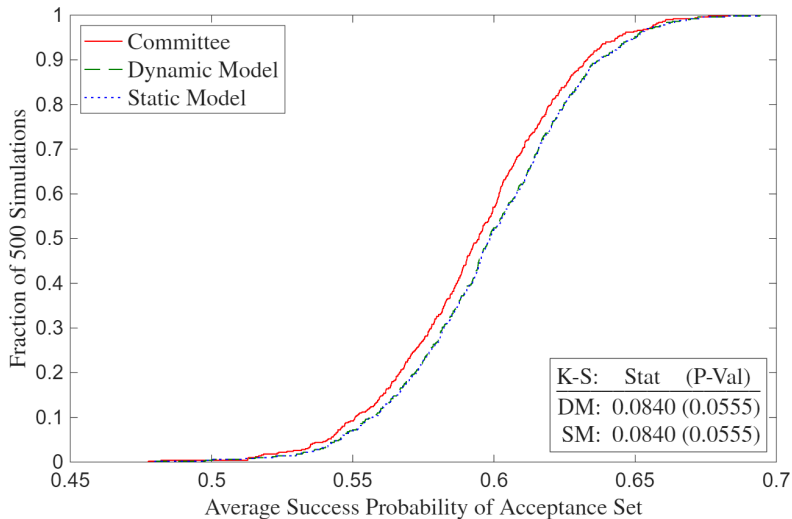
# Deviation Gains (Suboptimal)



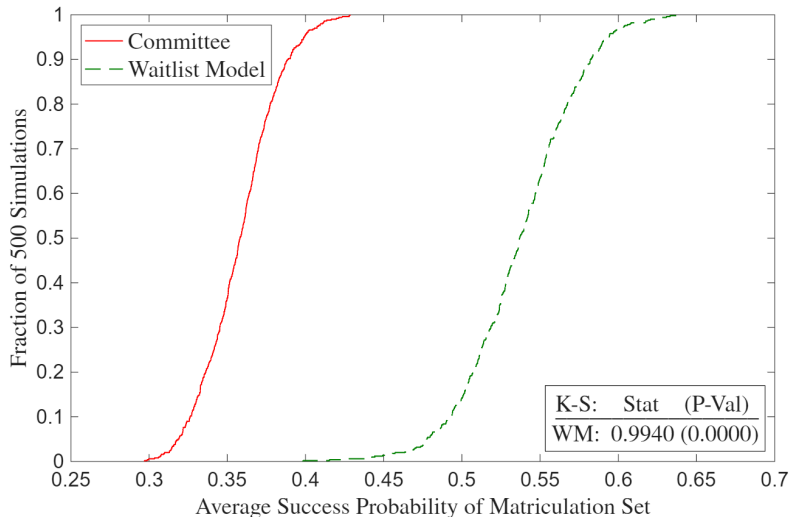
►► Full Deviation Gains (Suboptimal)

►► Deviation Gains Missing (Suboptimal)

# Deviation Gains (Optimal)



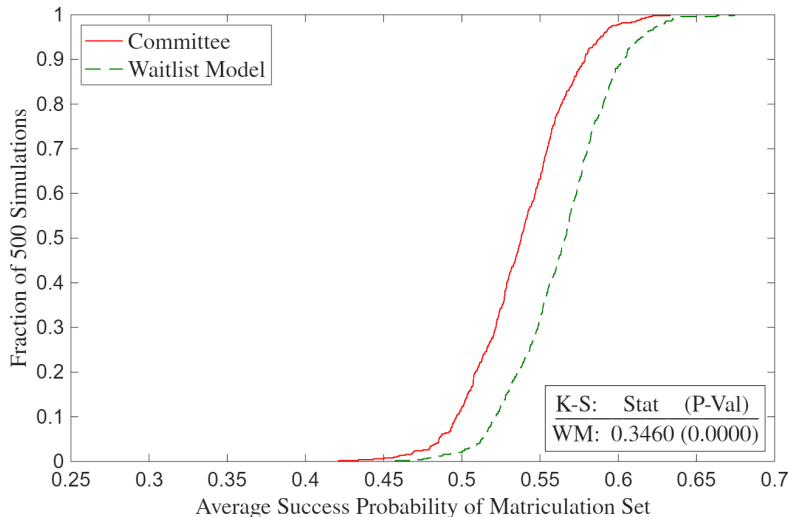
# Waitlist Deviation Gains (Suboptimal)



» Full Waitlist Deviation Gains (Suboptimal)

» Waitlist Deviation Gains Missing (Suboptimal)

# Waitlist Deviation Gains (Optimal)



» Full Waitlist Deviation Gains (Optimal)

» Waitlist Deviation Gains Missing (Optimal)

# Conclusion

- **Economic Problem:** Selecting best options under costly evaluation
- **Application:** Graduate admissions using synthetic data protocol to protect privacy
- **Contribution:** Build models to test optimality and quantify deviation gains
  - ① Economics admissions more data-driven than other social science programs
  - ② Tradeoff between marginal cost of reading file vs. quality of marginal acceptance
    - Exploit tradeoff to calculate, in dollars, how much success is worth to committee
    - Alternatively, what if committee uses AI to transition all the applicants?
- **Future Research:** Two-sided matching model across multiple universities

Thank You!



# A1: Synthetic Rows $\neq$ Real Subjects

| Transition | Accept | Success | GREQuantPct | Gender | Demographic1 | Demographic2 | AdvMath | ComScore |
|------------|--------|---------|-------------|--------|--------------|--------------|---------|----------|
| 0          | 0      | 0       | 89          | 0      | 0            | 0            | .       | .        |
| 1          | 0      | 1       | 96          | 0      | 1            | 0            | 1       | 5        |
| 0          | 0      | 1       | 88          | 0      | 1            | 0            | .       | .        |
| 0          | 0      | 0       | 80          | 1      | 1            | 0            | .       | .        |
| 1          | 1      | 1       | 99          | 0      | 1            | 0            | 1       | 9        |
| 1          | 0      | 1       | 81          | 0      | 0            | 1            | 1       | 4        |
| 1          | 0      | 1       | 92          | 0      | 1            | 0            | 1       | 4        |
| 1          | 1      | 1       | 93          | 0      | 0            | 1            | 0       | 6        |
| 1          | 0      | 1       | 83          | 1      | 0            | 1            | 0       | 7        |
| 0          | 0      | 0       | 87          | 0      | 1            | 0            | .       | .        |



| Transition | Accept | Success | GREQuantPct | Gender | Demographic1 | Demographic2 | AdvMath | ComScore |
|------------|--------|---------|-------------|--------|--------------|--------------|---------|----------|
| 1          | 0      | 0       | 90          | 1      | 1            | 0            | 0       | 5        |
| 1          | 0      | 0       | 83          | 0      | 0            | 1            | 1       | 6        |
| 1          | 1      | 1       | 91          | 0      | 0            | 1            | 0       | 5        |
| 1          | 1      | 1       | 92          | 0      | 0            | 1            | 0       | 5        |
| 0          | 0      | 1       | 83          | 0      | 0            | 0            | .       | .        |
| 1          | 0      | 0       | 93          | 0      | 0            | 1            | 0       | 9        |
| 0          | 0      | 0       | 84          | 0      | 0            | 1            | .       | .        |
| 1          | 1      | 1       | 88          | 0      | 1            | 0            | 1       | 4        |
| 1          | 0      | 1       | 86          | 0      | 1            | 0            | 0       | 6        |
| 0          | 0      | 1       | 86          | 1      | 0            | 1            | .       | .        |

# A1: Dependent Variables

Table 1a: Dependent Variables

| Admission                         | Success                         |
|-----------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| <b>1(Transition)</b>              | <b>1(Complete PhD Program)</b>  |
| <i>1(Accept)</i>                  | <i>1(Academic Placement)</i>    |
| <b>1(Waitlist)</b>                | <b>1(Government Placement)</b>  |
| <b>1(Open House)</b>              | <b>1(Consulting Placement)</b>  |
| <i>1(Matriculate)</i>             | <i>1(Tech Placement)</i>        |
| <b>1(Attend PhD Program)</b>      | <b>Placement U.S. Ranking</b>   |
| <b>PhD Program U.S. Ranking</b>   | <b>Placement Global Ranking</b> |
| <b>PhD Program Global Ranking</b> | <b>1(Good Placement)</b>        |

- Economics-only variables bold, non-economics-only variables italic
- U.S. News PhD program rankings, IDEAS/RePEc placement rankings
  - For non-tenure track, use weighted average of university's and maximum rankings
  - For non-academia, use average of ChatGPT, Claude, and Gemini's rankings

# A1: Objective Variables

Table 1b: Objective Independent Variables

| Demographic                     | Performance                          | Economics-Only Performance              |
|---------------------------------|--------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| 1(Covid Year)                   | GRE Verbal Percentile                | <b>Masters GPA</b>                      |
| Winsorized Age                  | GRE Quantitative Percentile          | 1( <b>Missing Masters GPA</b> )         |
| 1(Female)                       | GRE Analytic Percentile              | 1( <b>Elite U.S. Masters</b> )          |
| 1(U.S. African/Hispanic/Native) | 1(Missing GRE Percentiles)           | 1( <b>Elite International Masters</b> ) |
| 1(U.S. Asian)                   | Undergraduate GPA                    | 1( <b>Other International Masters</b> ) |
| 1(International Asian)          | 1(Missing Undergraduate GPA)         | 1( <b>Research Experience</b> )         |
| 1(International Other)          | TOEFL/IELTS Score                    | <b>Objective Score</b>                  |
|                                 | 1(Missing TOEFL/IELTS Score)         | <b>Relative Committee Score</b>         |
|                                 | 1(Elite U.S. University)             |                                         |
|                                 | 1(Elite U.S. Liberal Arts College)   |                                         |
|                                 | 1(Elite International University)    |                                         |
|                                 | 1(Other International University)    |                                         |
|                                 | 1(Graduate Degree)                   |                                         |
|                                 | 1(Work Experience)                   |                                         |
|                                 | Number of Professor Recommenders     |                                         |
|                                 | Number of Prolific Recommenders      |                                         |
|                                 | <i>Concentration Dummy Variables</i> |                                         |

# A1: Subjective Variables

**Table 1c:** Subjective Independent Variables

| Recommendation Letter        | Essay/CV/Supplemental Form                          |
|------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Relative Letter Length       | Essay Length (Essay)                                |
| Relative Letter Features     | $\mathbb{1}(\text{Specific Topic})$ (Essay)         |
| Positive Words (YS 2012)     | $\mathbb{1}(\text{Specific Professor})$ (Essay)     |
| Negative Words (YS 2012)     | $\mathbb{1}(\text{Economics Work Experience})$ (CV) |
| Standout Words (BEMS 2022)   | $\mathbb{1}(\text{Working Paper})$ (CV)             |
| Ability Words (BEMS 2022)    | $\mathbb{1}(\text{Publication})$ (CV)               |
| Research Words (BEMS 2022)   | $\mathbb{1}(\text{Coding})$ (CV)                    |
| Grindstone Words (BEMS 2022) | Number of Math Courses (Supplemental)               |
| Teaching Words (BEMS 2022)   | $\mathbb{1}(\text{Advanced Math})$ (Supplemental)   |
| Communal Words (BEMS 2022)   | $\mathbb{1}(\text{Theory Field})$ (Essay/CV)        |
| Agentic Words (MHM 2009)     | $\mathbb{1}(\text{Applied Field})$ (Essay/CV)       |

- Dictionaries from Madera, Hebl & Martin (2009), Young & Soroka (2012), and Bai, Esche, MacLeod & Shi (2022)
- #MathCourses and  $\mathbb{1}(\text{AdvMath})$  objective after 2020

# A1: Academia-Equivalent Rankings (Government)

- **European Institutions:** European Central Bank (40), HM Treasury (80)
- **Foreign Central Banks:** Banco Central do Brasil (93), Banco de México (93), Bank of Canada (80), Bank of England (67), Bank of Israel (93), Bank of Italy (80), Bank of Japan (80), Bank of Spain (80), Banque de France (80), Central Bank of Chile (93), Central Bank of Colombia (93), Central Bank of Korea (93), Central Bank of Turkey (93), Norges Bank (80), Reserve Bank of Australia (80), Reserve Bank of India (93), Reserve Bank of New Zealand (93), Sveriges Riksbank (80), Swiss National Bank (80)
- **Multilaterals/International:** African Development Bank (93), Asian Development Bank (93), Bank for International Settlements (53), European Bank for Reconstruction and Development (93), European Investment Bank (93), Inter-American Development Bank (93), International Monetary Fund (40), Statistics Canada (107), World Bank (40)
- **Policy Research Institutes:** American Enterprise Institute (93), American Institutes for Research (107), Becker Friedman Institute (80), Brookings Institution (80), Center for Global Development (93), Center for Migration Studies in New York (112), Center for Strategic and International Studies (107), Cowles Foundation (80), Harris School Policy Labs (93), Hoover Institution (80), IDinsight (112), Innovations for Poverty Action (93), J-PAL (80), MDRC (107), National Bureau of Economic Research (67), Peterson Institute for International Economics (80), Pew Research Center (107), RAND Corporation (80), Resources for the Future (93), Urban Institute (107)
- **U.S. Executive/Cabinet:** Department of Commerce (107), Department of Justice (80), Department of Labor (107), Department of the Treasury (80)
- **U.S. Executive Policy Offices:** Council of Economic Advisers (80), Office of Management and Budget (93)
- **U.S. Federal Reserve System:** Board of Governors (40), Atlanta (80), Boston (80), Chicago (80), Cleveland (80), Dallas (80), Kansas City (80), Minneapolis (80), New York (67), Philadelphia (80), Richmond (80), San Francisco (80), St. Louis (80)
- **U.S. GSE/Housing Finance:** Fannie Mae (120), Freddie Mac (120)
- **U.S. Independent Agencies:** Commodity Futures Trading Commission (93), Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation (93), Federal Energy Regulatory Commission (93), Federal Housing Finance Agency (93), Federal Trade Commission (80), Office of Financial Research (93), Securities and Exchange Commission (93)
- **U.S. Legislative Committees:** Congressional Budget Office (80), Congressional Research Service (107), Joint Committee on Taxation (93), Joint Economic Committee (107)
- **U.S. Science and Research:** National Science Foundation (107)
- **U.S. Statistical Agencies:** Bureau of Economic Analysis (93), Bureau of Labor Statistics (93), Census Bureau (93)

# A1: Academia-Equivalent Rankings (Consulting/Tech/Other)

- **Consulting:** Aecon Consulting (130), AlixPartners (125), Analysis Group (120), Bain & Compnay (120), Bates White (120), Berkeley Research Group (120), Boston Consulting Group (120), Brattle Group (120), Charles River Associates (120), Coleman Research (130), Compass Lexecon (120), Cornerstone Research (120), Deloitte Economic and Financial Advisory (125), Eonic Partners (130), Economists Incorporated (120), Edgeworth Economics (120), Ernst & Young Economic Advisory (125), Frontier Economics (120), FTI Consulting (120), Guidehouse (130), KPMG Economics & Valuation (125), Matrix Economics (130), McKinsey & Company (120), Mercer (135), NERA Economic Consulting (120), Oliver Wyman (120), PwC Economics (125), Roland Berger (125), Willis Towers Watson (135)
- **Tech (Athey & Luca 2019):** Airbnb (107), Alibaba (120), Amazon (93), AppNexus (135), Apple (107), Block/Square (120), ByteDance/TikTok (120), CoreLogic (135), Coursera (120), DStillery (135), Didichuxing (125), Digonex (135), DoorDash (107), eBay (107), ECONorthwest (125), Expedia (120), Forkcast (135), Glassdoor (120), Google (93), Granular (135), Groupon (125), Houzz (130), Huawei (120), IBM (120), Indeed (120), ING (130), Instacart (120), Intel (120), Kensho (125), Lending Club (135), LinkedIn (107), Lyft (120), Meta/Facebook (93), Microsoft (93), Netflix (93), Nuna (135), Nvidia (120), Pandora (135), PayPal (120), Pinterest (120), Prattle (135), Quantco (130), Quora (130), Redfin (120), Ripple (135), Roblox (120), Rover (135), Salesforce (120), Shopify (120), Spotify (120), Stripe (107), Trulia (125), Uber (107), Upwork (135), Visa (125), Walmart (125), Wealthfront (135), Yahoo (125), Yelp (125), Zillow (120)
- **Tech Labs:** Amazon Science (40), Apple Machine Learning Research (80), DeepMind (80), Google Research (40), Meta Research (80), Microsoft Research (40), Netflix Research (93), OpenAI Research (80), Uber Research (93)
- **Other:** AIG (135), Bank of America (125), Bloomberg (125), Boeing (135) Capital One (125), Exelon (135), ExxonMobil (135), Ford (135), General Electric (135), General Motors (135), Goldman Sachs (125), JPMorgan Chase (125), Liberty Mutual (135), Moody's Analytics (125), Morningstar (125), Nielsen (135), PNC (135), Progressive (135), S&P Global (125), Shell (135), Swiss Re (130), Toyota (130), Other (135), No Placement (150)

# A1: Dictionaries

- **Recommendation Letters:** Porter stemmer reduces words to their roots

- **Positive/Negative Words:** Young & Soroka (2012)'s Lexicoder Sentiment Dictionary
- **Standout, Ability, Research, Grindstone, Communal Words:** Bai, Esche, MacLeod & Shi (2022)
- **Agentic Words:** assertive, confident, aggressive, ambitious, dominant, forceful, independent, daring, outspoken, intellectual (Madera, Hebl & Martin 2009); **AND** audacious, bold, command, compete, decisive, determine, drive, enterprise, fearless, influential, leader, pioneer, powerful, proactive, resilient, resourceful, self-assured, strategic, tenacious, vision
- **Teaching Words:** academic, assess, clarity, coach, collaborate, communicate, cultivate, curriculum, demonstrate, develop, educate, encourage, engage, enlighten, evaluate, explain, facilitate, foster, guide, impart, inspire, insight, instruct, knowledge, learn, lesson, mentor, nurture, participate, pedagogy, present, scholar, support, teach, train, tutor, workshop

- **Essays and CVs:**

- **Specific Topic:** applied, asset, behavior, climate, computation, data, development, dynamic programming, economics, education, empirical, environment, experiment, finance, fiscal, game theory, health, immigration, industrial, inequality, international, io, labor, linear programming, macro, math, metrics, micro, monetary, policy, political, poverty, pricing, probability, public, sports, statistic, theory, trade, urban
- **Economics Work Experience:** assistant, fed, imf, international monetary fund, predoc, ra, research, treasury, world bank
- **Working Paper:** arxiv, center for economic policy research, cepr, econpapers, national bureau of economic research, nber, research papers in economics, repec, social science research network, ssrn, working paper
- **Publication:** Journal names from IDEAS/RePEc Aggregate Rankings for Journals
- **Coding:** c/c++, eviews, fortran, java, jax, julia, latex, matlab, python, r, sas, stata, webscrape

# A1: Inference vs. Prediction

- Hard to obtain consistent estimates due to omitted variables
  - **Example:** Don't observe effort (e.g. hours worked). Can bias coefficients upward if predictors correlated with effort and success are independent of effort
  - Existing literature also suffers from this problem, though BEMS (2022) parse recommendation letters for “grindstone terms” (e.g. depend\*, diligen\*)
- Research questions emphasize prediction over inference
  - Mullainathan & Spiess (2017) distinguish  $\hat{\beta}$  vs.  $\hat{y}$  problems
  - If GRE predicts success, committee should use it regardless of why
  - See Reduced-Form Summary for prediction-based methods



# A1: Sample Selection

- Determinants of success conditional on applying vs. matriculating
- BEMS (2022) prove that if  $P(\text{Success}|\text{Skill})$  is an S-curve, then  $\hat{\beta}$  will be smaller for more selected samples. Consistent with empirical results
- If there aren't some types of outcomes data (e.g. grades, passing comps) for all applicants, or such data are too hard to obtain, use Heckman correction
  - Let  $y_n^* = x_n\beta + u_n$ ,  $d_n = \mathbb{1}(z_n\gamma + v_n > 0)$ , and  $y_n = d_n y_n^*$
  - **Step 1:** Run probit of  $d$  on  $z$  and compute inverse Mills  $\hat{\lambda}_n = \frac{\phi(z_n\hat{\gamma})}{\Phi(z_n\hat{\gamma})}$
  - **Step 2:** Run OLS, probit, or ordered probit of  $y$  on  $(x, \hat{\lambda})$  to get  $\hat{\beta}$
  - **Instruments:** Enthusiasm score, average acceptance rate/quality

# A1: Insufficiency of Comparing AMEs

- Cannot test optimality by comparing AMEs across regressions. Suppose:
  - Math skills have large positive effect on success, coding skills smaller positive effect
  - 25% of applicants have both skills, 25% math only, 25% coding only, 25% neither
  - Committee can accept half of applicants, and other half attend different university
- Optimizing committee accepts half with math and ignores coding
  - **Acceptance Regression:**  $AME_{\text{Math}} = 1, AME_{\text{Coding}} = 0$
  - **Success Regression:**  $1 > AME_{\text{Math}} > AME_{\text{Coding}} > 0$
  - Despite optimality, acceptance and success AMEs not equal across regressions
- **Upshot:** Relationship between AMEs must be interpreted through a model

# A1: Wald Tests

- Test if admission and success AMEs are same across programs
  - **Example:** Does elite undergraduate university predict admission and/or success more or less for economics than for other programs?
  - **Data:** Simulated from reduced-form-calibrated data-generating parameters
- Can I test if acceptance AMEs equal success AMEs within programs?
  - Predictors of acceptance only (success only) may be overvalued (undervalued), provided committee wants to select based on a “success” model
  - **Problem:** Not a test if admissions decisions are optimal
  - Need structural model of admissions to conclude about optimality

# A1: Logit Wald Test Across Programs

Assume  $(Y^E \perp\!\!\!\perp Y^{NE})|X$ . Let  $P(Y_n^E = 1|x_n^E; \theta^E) = \frac{\exp(x_{n,0}^E \theta_0^E + x_{n,1}^E \theta_1^E)}{1 + \exp(x_{n,0}^E \theta_0^E + x_{n,1}^E \theta_1^E)}$ ,

and  $P(Y_n^{NE} = 1|x_n^{NE}; \theta^{NE}) = \frac{\exp(x_{n,0}^{NE} \theta_0^{NE} + x_{n,1}^{NE} \theta_1^{NE})}{1 + \exp(x_{n,0}^{NE} \theta_0^{NE} + x_{n,1}^{NE} \theta_1^{NE})}$ . Finally, let  $N = N_E + N_{NE}$ . Then:

$$\mathcal{L}_N^U(y|x; \theta) = \prod_{n=1}^{N_E} P(Y_n^E = 1|x_n^E; \theta^E)^{Y_n^E} [1 - P(Y_n^E = 1|x_n^E; \theta^E)]^{1-Y_n^E} \\ \prod_{n=1}^{N_{NE}} P(Y_n^{NE} = 1|x_n^{NE}; \theta^{NE})^{Y_n^{NE}} [1 - P(Y_n^{NE} = 1|x_n^{NE}; \theta^{NE})]^{1-Y_n^{NE}}.$$

- $Y \in \{1(\text{Accept}), 1(\text{Attend Program}), 1(\text{Complete Program}), 1(\text{Good Placement})\}$
- **Test:** Let  $g(\hat{\theta}) = \frac{1}{N_E} \sum_{n=1}^{N_E} \hat{P}_n^E (1 - \hat{P}_n^E) \hat{\theta}_1^E - \frac{1}{N_{NE}} \sum_{n=1}^{N_{NE}} \hat{P}_n^{NE} (1 - \hat{P}_n^{NE}) \hat{\theta}_1^{NE}$ . Then:  
 $W = g(\hat{\theta})' [\nabla_{\theta} g(\hat{\theta}) \hat{V}(\hat{\theta}) \nabla_{\theta} g(\hat{\theta})']^{-1} g(\hat{\theta}) \sim \chi_Q^2$ . Compare AMEs per Mood (2010)

# A1: Linear Wald Test Across Programs

Assume  $(Y^E \perp\!\!\!\perp Y^{NE})|X$ , i.e. (Economics  $\perp\!\!\!\perp$  Non-Economics) $|$ Predictors.

Let  $f(y_n^E|x_n^E; \beta^E, \sigma_E^2) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi\sigma_E^2}} \exp\left[\frac{-1}{2\sigma_E^2}(y_n^E - x_{n,0}^E\beta_0^E - x_{n,1}^E\beta_1^E)^2\right]$ , and

$f(y_n^{NE}|x_n^{NE}; \beta^{NE}, \sigma_{NE}^2) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi\sigma_{NE}^2}} \exp\left[\frac{-1}{2\sigma_{NE}^2}(y_n^{NE} - x_{n,0}^{NE}\beta_0^{NE} - x_{n,1}^{NE}\beta_1^{NE})^2\right]$ . Then:

$$\mathcal{L}_N^U(y|x; \beta, \sigma^2) = \prod_{n=1}^{N_E} f(y_n^E|x_n^E; \beta^E, \sigma_E^2) \prod_{n=1}^{N_{NE}} f(y_n^{NE}|x_n^{NE}; \beta^{NE}, \sigma_{NE}^2).$$

- $Y \in \{\mathbb{1}(\text{Standardized Committee Score}), \mathbb{1}(\text{Standardized Placement Rank})\}$
- **Test:** Let  $g(\hat{\beta}_1) = \hat{\beta}_1^E - \hat{\beta}_1^{NE}$ . (Can also do likelihood-ratio test.)  
Then  $W = g(\hat{\beta}_1)'[\nabla_{\beta, \sigma^2} g(\hat{\beta}_1) \hat{V}(\hat{\beta}, \hat{\sigma}^2) \nabla_{\beta, \sigma^2} g(\hat{\beta}_1)']^{-1} g(\hat{\beta}_1) \sim \chi_Q^2$
- **Assumption:** Homoskedasticity (i.e.  $\forall n, \sigma_n^2 = \sigma^2$ )

# A1: Additional Questions

- Are there different determinants of different types of success? (AKKLP 2007)
  - Need different skills at different stages in the program, such as grades vs. placement
  - For some programs, initial placement matters less than for economics
- Different determinants for international applicants? (KW 2000)
  - **Admission:** May have different preparation and/or interests
  - **Completion:** Depending on country, may have fewer outside options
  - **Placement:** May return to native country after graduation
- Different determinants over time? (2015 to 2023)
  - COVID-19 and other macro factors; changes in professions (e.g. more empirics)
  - For economics, increased importance of elite predocs and Fed RAships

## A2.1: Portfolio Choice to Cutoff Rule (BEMS 2022)

### Portfolio Choice Problem:

$$\max_{(d_1, \dots, d_N) \in \{A, R\}^N} \sum_{n=1}^N P(y_n = S | x_n, z_n) \mathbb{1}(d_n = A), \text{ such that: } \sum_{n=1}^N \mathbb{1}(d_n = A) \leq N_A$$

$$\mathcal{L}(d_1, \dots, d_N; \lambda) = \sum_{n=1}^N [P(y_n = S | x_n, z_n) - \lambda] \mathbb{1}(d_n = A) + \lambda N_A$$

### Cutoff Rule Solution:

$$\forall n \in \{1, \dots, N\}, d_n(x_n, z_n | \lambda^*) = \begin{cases} A & \text{if } P(y_n = S | x_n, z_n) > \lambda^* \\ \{A, R\} & \text{if } P(y_n = S | x_n, z_n) = \lambda^* \\ R & \text{if } P(y_n = S | x_n, z_n) < \lambda^* \end{cases}$$

**Upshot:**  $\lambda^*$  is cutoff probability. Denote it hereafter as  $P(y^* = S)$

- $P(y^* = S) \in [P(y_{N_A+1} = S | x_{N_A+1}, z_{N_A+1}), P(y_{N_A} = S | x_{N_A}, z_{N_A})]$

## A2.1: Models of Admissions

- 1 **Year-Static Model:** Committee ranks applicants based on objective variables, reads files of applicants above Cutoff 1, re-ranks surviving applicants based on all variables, and accepts surviving applicants above Cutoff 2
- 2 **Year-Dynamic Model:** Committee forms expectation in Round 1 about applicants who survive to Round 2. Favors applicants with objective variables positively correlated with good subjective variables
- 3 **Waitlist-Hybrid/Dynamic Models:** After Round 1, committee accepts or waitlists applicants in Round 2. After accepted applicants matriculate or don't matriculate, committee accepts or rejects waitlisted applicants in Round 3. Favors likely matriculants in Round 2 to increase selectivity in Round 3



## A2.1: Description of Models

- **Round 2:** If accept applicant, get success probability  $P(y = S|x, z)$ , where  $\text{Success} = \mathbb{1}(\text{Complete Program})$  or  $\mathbb{1}(\text{Good Placement})$ . If reject applicant, get  $P(y_2^* = S|t) = P(\text{Success})$  of year  $t$ 's marginal accepted applicant
- **Round 1:** If reject applicant, get  $P(y_1^* = S|t) = P(\text{Success})$  of year  $t$ 's marginal transitioned applicant. Can be less or greater than  $P(y_2^* = S|t)$  depending on value placed on committee's time vs. admitting a successful cohort
  - **Year-Static:** If transition applicant, get  $P(y = S|x)$ , or  $P(\text{Success})$  unconditional on  $z$ . It may differ from  $P(y = S|x, z)$ , though it still accounts for  $x$ 's effect on  $z$
  - **Year-Dynamic:** If transition applicant, get  $\mathbb{E}[v_2(x, z, t, \epsilon_2)|x, t] =$  expected value of Round 2, where  $z$  is integrated out conditional on  $x$  via  $F(z|x)$
  - **Year-Myopic:** In  $\mathbb{E}[v_2(x, z, t, \epsilon_2)|x, t]$ , replace  $F(z|x)$  with  $F(z)$

## A2.1: Year-Static Parameterization

### Unrestricted CCPs:

$$P_{d_1} = P(d_1 = T | x, t; \theta_T) = \frac{\exp(f_T(x, t)\theta_T)}{1 + \exp(f_T(x, t)\theta_T)}$$

$$P_{d_2} = P(d_2 = A | x, z, t; \theta_A) = \frac{\exp(f_A(x, z, t)\theta_A)}{1 + \exp(f_A(x, z, t)\theta_A)}$$

### Success Probabilities:

$$P_{y_1} = P(y = S | x; \theta_{S_1}) = \frac{\exp(f_{S_1}(x)\theta_{S_1})}{1 + \exp(f_{S_1}(x)\theta_{S_1})}$$

$$P_{y_2} = P(y = S | x, z; \theta_{S_2}) = \frac{\exp(f_{S_2}(x, z)\theta_{S_2})}{1 + \exp(f_{S_2}(x, z)\theta_{S_2})}$$

### Cutoff Probabilities:

$$P_{y_1^*} = P(y_1^* = S | t; \theta_{S_1^*}) = \frac{\exp(f_{S_1^*}(t)\theta_{S_1^*})}{1 + \exp(f_{S_1^*}(t)\theta_{S_1^*})}$$

$$P_{y_2^*} = P(y_2^* = S | t; \theta_{S_2^*}) = \frac{\exp(f_{S_2^*}(t)\theta_{S_2^*})}{1 + \exp(f_{S_2^*}(t)\theta_{S_2^*})}$$

## A2.1: Year-Dynamic Parameterization

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbb{E}[v_2(x, z, t, \epsilon_2)|x, t] &= \int_{\tilde{z}} \sigma \log \left( \sum_{\tilde{d}_2 \in \{A, R\}} e^{u_2(x, \tilde{z}, t, \tilde{d}_2)/\sigma} \right) dF(\tilde{z}|x) \\ &= \int_{\tilde{z}_1} \cdots \int_{\tilde{z}_J} \left[ \cdot \right] dF_1(\tilde{z}_1|\tilde{z}_2, \dots, \tilde{z}_J, x) \cdots dF_J(\tilde{z}_J|x)\end{aligned}$$

- **Continuous:**  $f_{z|x}(z_j|x; \beta_{F_{z|x,j}}, \sigma_{F_{z|x,j}}^2) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi\sigma_{F_{z|x,j}}^2}} \exp \left[ \frac{-1}{2\sigma_{F_{z|x,j}}^2} (z_j - g(x)\beta_{F_{z|x,j}})^2 \right]$
- **Binary:**  $P(z_j = 1|x; \theta_{F_{z|x,j}}) = \frac{\exp(g(x)\theta_{F_{z|x,j}})}{1 + \exp(g(x)\theta_{F_{z|x,j}})}$
- **Multinomial:**  $P(z_j = (k \neq K)|x; \theta_{F_{z|x,j}^k}) = \frac{\exp(g(x)\theta_{F_{z|x,j}^k})}{1 + \sum_{\ell=1}^{K-1} \exp(g(x)\theta_{F_{z|x,j}^\ell})}$

## A2.1: Year-Static Likelihood

$$\mathcal{L}_N^U(\theta) = \prod_{n=1}^{N_T} P_{d_{1,n}}(\theta_T) P_{d_{2,n}}(\theta_A)^{\mathbb{1}(d_{2,n}=A)} (1 - P_{d_{2,n}}(\theta_A))^{\mathbb{1}(d_{2,n}=R)} \left[ P_{y_{1,n}}(\theta_{S_1}) P_{y_{2,n}}(\theta_{S_2}) \right]^{\mathbb{1}(y_n=S)} \\ \left[ (1 - P_{y_{1,n}}(\theta_{S_1})) (1 - P_{y_{2,n}}(\theta_{S_2})) \right]^{\mathbb{1}(y_n=F)} \prod_{n=N_T+1}^N (1 - P_{d_{1,n}}(\theta_T)) P_{y_{1,n}}(\theta_{S_1})^{\mathbb{1}(y_n=S)} (1 - P_{y_{1,n}}(\theta_{S_1}))^{\mathbb{1}(y_n=F)}$$

- **Problem:** I don't observe success for recent years
  - **Solution:** Separate block for recent years without success subblocks
  - **Assumption:** Older years representative of recent years
- If years are similar, can make  $(\theta_{S_1^*}, \theta_{S_2^*})$  in  $\mathcal{L}^R$  intercept only

## A2.1: Year-Dynamic Heckman-Corrected Likelihood

$$\mathcal{L}_N^U(\theta) = \prod_{n=1}^{N_T} \Phi(x_n, t_n; \theta_H) f(z_n | x_n, \frac{\phi(x_n, t_n; \theta_H)}{\Phi(x_n, t_n; \theta_H)}; \theta_F) P_{d_{1,n}}(\theta_T) P_{d_{2,n}}(\theta_A)^{\mathbb{1}(d_{2,n}=A)} (1 - P_{d_{2,n}}(\theta_A))^{\mathbb{1}(d_{2,n}=R)}$$
$$P_{y_n}(\theta_S)^{\mathbb{1}(y_n=S)} (1 - P_{y_n}(\theta_S))^{\mathbb{1}(y_n=F)} \prod_{n=N_T+1}^N (1 - \Phi(x_n, t_n; \theta_H)) (1 - P_{d_{1,n}}(\theta_T))$$

- I may not observe  $z$  for applicants who didn't survive Round 1
- Estimate Heckman (1979)-corrected full-information likelihood
- **Heckman Instrument:** Year  $t$  affects  $d_1$  but not  $z$

## A2.1: Conditional Independence Assumption

- Should I assume success is independent of admission conditional on predictors?
  - This university aside, if you don't get into anywhere good, you're unlikely to succeed
  - Can bias  $\hat{\theta}_S$  upward since without loss of generality, a low GRE is correlated with not getting in anywhere good, which itself prevents you from succeeding
- So should I replace  $P(y = S|x; \theta_S)$  with  $P(y = S|d, x; \theta_S)$ ?
  - **Problem 1:** If I condition  $y$  on  $d = \mathbb{1}(\text{Accept})$ , I would be “logistically regressing”  $d$  on  $y$  on  $d$  in restricted likelihood, which will fail
  - **Problem 2:** Because  $d$  is a function of  $x$ , even conditioning  $y$  on  $x$  and  $d = \mathbb{1}(\text{Attend Program})$  will “collapse”  $\hat{\theta}_S$  (except for  $\hat{\theta}_S^d$ )
  - ★ **Example:** In AKKLP (2007), quantitative GRE predicts course grades but not when Committee Score is included; coefficient even goes negative for Metrics Grade
  - **Problem 3:** Committee doesn't know *ex-ante* whether  $d$  will be 1 or 0

## A2.1: Empirical Considerations

- **Selection Effects:** Track success for all applicants, including non-matriculants
  - In selected samples, success parameters are biased down (e.g. quantitative GRE)
- **Potential Outcomes:** Track which graduate program all applicants attended, and add expected program ranking conditional on  $(x, z)$  as control function
  - If a variable only predicts success by helping applicant get into elite graduate program, then committee should not use that variable to rank applicants
- **Unobservables:** I may not observe all information that committee observes
  - **Example:** Recommendation letter has nuances that algorithms can't detect
  - Include subjective committee score in  $z$  as a proxy for this information

## A2.1: Cutoff Rule with Matriculation

### Portfolio Choice Problem:

$$\max_{\delta \in \{\delta | \delta: \mathbb{R}^K \rightarrow [0,1]\}} \int_{w \in \mathbb{R}^K} P(y = S|w) P(m = M|w) \delta(w) f(w) dw,$$

$$\text{such that: } \int_{w \in \mathbb{R}^K} P(m = M|w) \delta(w) f(w) dw \leq N_M$$

$$\mathcal{L}(\delta; \lambda) = \int_{w \in \mathbb{R}^K} [P(y = S|w) - \lambda] P(m = M|w) \delta(w) f(w) dw + \lambda N_M$$

### Cutoff Rule Solution:

$$\forall w \in \mathbb{R}^K, \delta(w|\lambda^*) = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } P(y = S|w) > \lambda^* \\ [0, 1] & \text{if } P(y = S|w) = \lambda^* \\ 0 & \text{if } P(y = S|w) < \lambda^* \end{cases}$$

**Upshot:** Point-identified cutoff probability  $\lambda^*$  is with respect to success probabilities



## A2.1: Waitlist Model 1

### Round 3:

$$v_3(x, z, \overline{m}_{2A}, \epsilon_3) = \max_{d_3 \in \{A, R\}} u_3(x, z, \overline{m}_{2A}, d_3) + \epsilon_3(d_3), \text{ such that:}$$

$$u_3(x, z, \overline{m}_{2A}, d_3) = \underbrace{P(y = S | x, z) \mathbb{1}(d_3 = A)}_{\text{If accept, get } P(\text{Success})} + \underbrace{P(y_3^* = S | \overline{m}_{2A}) \mathbb{1}(d_3 = R)}_{\text{If reject, get } P(\text{Cutoff})}$$

### Round 2:

$$v_2(x, z, \ddot{m}_2, \epsilon_2) = \max_{d_2 \in \{A, W\}} u_2(x, z, \ddot{m}_2, d_2) + \epsilon_2(d_2), \text{ such that:}$$

$$u_2(x, z, \ddot{m}_2, d_2) = \underbrace{P(y = S | x, z) \mathbb{1}(d_2 = A)}_{\text{If accept, get } P(\text{Success})} + \underbrace{\beta \mathbb{E}[v_3(x, z, \overline{m}_{2A}, \epsilon_3) | x, z, \ddot{m}_2] \mathbb{1}(d_2 = W)}_{\text{If waitlist, get discounted } \mathbb{E}[\text{Social Surplus}]}, \text{ such that:}$$

$$\mathbb{E}[v_3(x, z, \overline{m}_{2A}, \epsilon_3) | x, z, \ddot{m}_2] = \int_{\widetilde{\overline{m}_{2A}}} \sigma \log \left( \sum_{\widetilde{d}_3 \in \{A, R\}} e^{u_3(x, z, \widetilde{\overline{m}_{2A}}, \widetilde{d}_3) / \sigma} \right) dF_{\overline{m}_{2A} | \ddot{m}_2}(\widetilde{\overline{m}_{2A}} | \ddot{m}_2)$$

## A2.1: Waitlist Model 2

### Round 1:

$$v_1(x, t, \epsilon_1) = \max_{d_1 \in \{T, R\}} u_1(x, t, d_1) + \epsilon_1(d_1), \text{ such that:}$$

$$u_1(x, t, d_1) = \underbrace{\mathbb{E}[v_2(x, z, \ddot{m}_2, \epsilon_2)|x]\mathbb{1}(d_1 = T)}_{\text{If transition, get } \mathbb{E}[\text{Social Surplus}]} + \underbrace{L(y_1^* = S|t)\mathbb{1}(d_1 = R)}_{\text{If reject, get } L(\text{Cutoff})}, \text{ such that:}$$

$$\mathbb{E}[v_2(x, z, \ddot{m}_2, \epsilon_2)|x] = \int_{\tilde{z}} \int_{\tilde{\ddot{m}}_2} \sigma \log \left( \sum_{\tilde{d}_2 \in \{A, R\}} e^{u_2(x, \tilde{z}, \tilde{\ddot{m}}_2, \tilde{d}_2)/\sigma} \right) dF_{\ddot{m}_2|x, z}(\tilde{\ddot{m}}_2|x, \tilde{z}) dF_{z|x}(\tilde{z}|x)$$

### Conditional Choice Probabilities:

$$P(d_r|\text{states}) = \frac{\exp(u_r(\text{states}, d_r)/\sigma)}{\sum_{\tilde{d}_r \in D_r} \exp(u_r(\text{states}, \tilde{d}_r)/\sigma)}$$

## A2.1: Waitlist Model 2

### Round 1 (Hybrid):

$$v_1(x, t, \epsilon_1) = \max_{d_1 \in \{T, R\}} u_1(x, t, d_1) + \epsilon_1(d_1), \text{ such that:}$$

$$u_1(x, t, d_1) = \underbrace{P(y = S|x)\mathbb{1}(d_1 = T)}_{\text{If transition, get } P(\text{Success})} + \underbrace{P(y_1^* = S|t)\mathbb{1}(d_1 = R)}_{\text{If reject, get } P(\text{Cutoff})}$$

### Conditional Choice Probabilities:

$$P(d_r | \text{states}) = \frac{\exp(u_r(\text{states}, d_r)/\sigma)}{\sum_{\tilde{d}_r \in D_r} \exp(u_r(\text{states}, \tilde{d}_r)/\sigma)}$$

## A2.1: Waitlist-Dynamic Parameterization 1

### Unrestricted CCPs:

$$P_{d_1} = P(d_1 = T | x, t; \theta_T) = \frac{\exp(f_T(x, t)\theta_T)}{1 + \exp(f_T(x, t)\theta_T)}$$

$$P_{d_2} = P(d_2 = A | x, z, \ddot{m}_2; \theta_{A_2}) = \frac{\exp(f_{A_2}(x, z, \ddot{m}_2)\theta_{A_2})}{1 + \exp(f_{A_2}(x, z, \ddot{m}_2)\theta_{A_2})}$$

$$P_{d_3} = P(d_3 = A | x, z, \overline{m_{2A}}; \theta_{A_3}) = \frac{\exp(f_{A_3}(x, z, \overline{m_{2A}})\theta_{A_3})}{1 + \exp(f_{A_3}(x, z, \overline{m_{2A}})\theta_{A_3})}$$

### Success Probability:

$$P_y = P(y = S | x, z; \theta_S) = \frac{\exp(f_S(x, z)\theta_S)}{1 + \exp(f_S(x, z)\theta_S)}$$

### Cutoff Level/Probability:

$$L_{y_1^*} = L(y_1^* = S | t; \theta_{S_1^*}) = \exp(f_{S_1^*}(t)\theta_{S_1^*})$$

$$P_{y_3^*} = P(y_3^* = S | \overline{m_{2A}}; \theta_{S_3^*}) = \frac{\exp(f_{S_3^*}(\overline{m_{2A}})\theta_{S_3^*})}{1 + \exp(f_{S_3^*}(\overline{m_{2A}})\theta_{S_3^*})}$$

## A2.1: Waitlist-Dynamic Parameterization 2

★ Assume  $z$  and  $\ddot{m}_2$  are conditionally independent:

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbb{E}[v_2(x, z, \ddot{m}_2, \epsilon_2)|x] &= \int_{\tilde{z}} \int_{\tilde{\ddot{m}}_2} \sigma \log \left( \sum_{\tilde{d}_2 \in \{A, R\}} e^{u_2(x, \tilde{z}, \tilde{\ddot{m}}_2, \tilde{d}_2)/\sigma} \right) dF_{\ddot{m}_2|x, z}(\tilde{\ddot{m}}_2|x, \tilde{z}) dF_{z|x}(\tilde{z}|x) \\ &= \int_{\tilde{z}_1} \cdots \int_{\tilde{z}_{J_z}} \int_{\tilde{\ddot{m}}_2} \left[ \cdot \right] dF_{\ddot{m}_2|x, z}(\tilde{\ddot{m}}_2|x, \tilde{z}) dF_{z|x, 1}(\tilde{z}_1|\tilde{z}_2, \dots, \tilde{z}_{J_z}, x) \cdots dF_{z|x, J_z}(\tilde{z}_{J_z}|x)\end{aligned}$$

$$\mathbb{E}[v_3(x, z, \overline{m_{2A}}, \epsilon_3)|x, z, \ddot{m}_2] = \int_{\overline{\ddot{m}_{2A}}} \sigma \log \left( \sum_{\tilde{d}_3 \in \{A, R\}} e^{u_3(x, z, \overline{\ddot{m}_{2A}}, \tilde{d}_3)/\sigma} \right) dF_{\overline{m_{2A}}|\ddot{m}_2}(\overline{\ddot{m}_{2A}}|\ddot{m}_2)$$

- **Continuous:**  $f_{z|x}(z_j|x; \beta_{F_{z|x,j}}, \sigma_{F_{z|x,j}}^2) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi\sigma_{F_{z|x,j}}^2}} \exp \left[ \frac{-1}{2\sigma_{F_{z|x,j}}^2} (z_j - g(x)\beta_{F_{z|x,j}})^2 \right]$
- **Binary:**  $P(z_j = 1|x; \theta_{F_{z|x,j}}) = \frac{\exp(g(x)\theta_{F_{z|x,j}})}{1 + \exp(g(x)\theta_{F_{z|x,j}})}$
- **Multinomial:**  $P(z_j = (k \neq K)|x; \theta_{F_{z|x,j}^k}) = \frac{\exp(g(x)\theta_{F_{z|x,j}^k})}{1 + \sum_{\ell=1}^{K-1} \exp(g(x)\theta_{F_{z|x,j}^\ell})}$

## A2.1: Waitlist-Dynamic Likelihood

$$\begin{aligned}
 \mathcal{L}_{N_1}^U(\theta) = & \prod_{n=1}^{N_3} f_{z|x}(z_n|x_n; \theta_{F_{z|x}}) f_{\ddot{m}_2|x,z}(\ddot{m}_{2,n}|x_n, z_n; \theta_{F_{\ddot{m}_2|x,z}}) f_{\overline{m}_{2A}|\ddot{m}_2}(\overline{m}_{2A,n}|\ddot{m}_{2,n}; \theta_{F_{\overline{m}_{2A}|\ddot{m}_2}}) \\
 & P_{d_{1,n}}(\theta_T)(1 - P_{d_{2,n}}(\theta_{A_2}))P_{d_{3,n}}(\theta_{A_3})^{\mathbb{1}(d_{3,n}=A)}(1 - P_{d_{3,n}}(\theta_{A_3}))^{\mathbb{1}(d_{3,n}=R)}P_{y_n}(\theta_S)^{\mathbb{1}(y_n=S)}(1 - P_{y_n}(\theta_S))^{\mathbb{1}(y_n=F)} \\
 & \prod_{n=N_3+1}^{N_2} f_{z|x}(z_n|x_n; \theta_{F_{z|x}}) f_{\ddot{m}_2|x,z}(\ddot{m}_{2,n}|x_n, z_n; \theta_{F_{\ddot{m}_2|x,z}}) f_{\overline{m}_{2A}|\ddot{m}_2}(\overline{m}_{2A,n}|\ddot{m}_{2,n}; \theta_{F_{\overline{m}_{2A}|\ddot{m}_2}}) \\
 & P_{d_{1,n}}(\theta_T)P_{d_{2,n}}(\theta_{A_2})P_{y_n}(\theta_S)^{\mathbb{1}(y_n=S)}(1 - P_{y_n}(\theta_S))^{\mathbb{1}(y_n=F)} \\
 & \prod_{n=N_2+1}^{N_1} f_{z|x}(z_n|x_n; \theta_{F_{z|x}}) f_{\ddot{m}_2|x,z}(\ddot{m}_{2,n}|x_n, z_n; \theta_{F_{\ddot{m}_2|x,z}})(1 - P_{d_{1,n}}(\theta_T))
 \end{aligned}$$

- For  $\mathcal{L}_R$ , use  $(\theta_F^U, \theta_S^U)$  as initial guess of  $(\theta_F^R, \theta_S^R)$
- Heckman corrections may be necessary, such as for  $f_{z|x}$  and  $f_{\ddot{m}_2|x,z}$

# A2.1: Full Waitlist Model 1

## Round 3:

$$v_3(x, z, \overline{m_{2A}}, n_3, \overline{q_3}, \overline{m_3}, \epsilon_3) = \max_{d_3 \in \{A, R\}} u_3(x, z, \overline{m_{2A}}, n_3, \overline{q_3}, \overline{m_3}, d_3) + \epsilon_3(d_3), \text{ such that:}$$

$$u_3(x, z, \overline{m_{2A}}, n_3, \overline{q_3}, \overline{m_3}, d_3) = P(y = S|x, z)\mathbb{1}(d_3 = A) + P(y_3^* = S|\overline{m_{2A}}, n_3, \overline{q_3}, \overline{m_3})\mathbb{1}(d_3 = R)$$

## Round 2:

$$v_2(x, z, \ddot{m}_2, n_2, \overline{q_2}, \overline{m_2}, \epsilon_2) = \max_{d_2 \in \{A, W\}} u_2(x, z, \ddot{m}_2, n_2, \overline{q_2}, \overline{m_2}, d_2) + \epsilon_2(d_2), \text{ such that:}$$

$$u_2(x, z, \ddot{m}_2, n_2, \overline{q_2}, \overline{m_2}, d_2) = P(y = S|x, z)\mathbb{1}(d_2 = A) + \beta \mathbb{E}[v_3(x, z, \overline{m_{2A}}, n_3, \overline{q_3}, \overline{m_3}, \epsilon_3)|x, z, \ddot{m}_2, n_2, \overline{q_2}, \overline{m_2}]\mathbb{1}(d_2 = W), \text{ such that:}$$

$$\begin{aligned} & \mathbb{E}[v_3(x, z, \overline{m_{2A}}, n_3, \overline{q_3}, \overline{m_3}, \epsilon_3)|x, z, \ddot{m}_2, n_2, \overline{q_2}, \overline{m_2}] = \\ & \int_{\widetilde{\overline{m_3}}} \int_{\widetilde{\overline{q_3}}} \int_{\widetilde{n_3}} \int_{\widetilde{\overline{m_{2A}}}} \sigma \log \left( \sum_{\tilde{d}_3 \in \{A, R\}} e^{u_3(x, z, \widetilde{\overline{m_{2A}}}, \tilde{n}_3, \widetilde{\overline{q_3}}, \widetilde{\overline{m_3}}, \tilde{d}_3) / \sigma} \right) dF_{\overline{m_{2A}}|\ddot{m}_2}(\widetilde{\overline{m_{2A}}}|\ddot{m}_2) dF_{n_3|n_2}(\tilde{n}_3|n_2) dF_{\overline{q_3}|\overline{q_2}}(\widetilde{\overline{q_3}}|\overline{q_2}) dF_{\overline{m_3}|\overline{m_2}}(\widetilde{\overline{m_3}}|\overline{m_2}) \end{aligned}$$

# A2.1: Full Waitlist Model 2

## Round 1:

$$v_1(x, t, n_1, \overline{q_1}, \overline{m_1}, \epsilon_1) = \max_{d_1 \in \{T, R\}} u_1(x, t, n_1, \overline{q_1}, \overline{m_1}, d_1) + \epsilon_1(d_1), \text{ such that:}$$

• **Hybrid:**  $u_1(x, t, d_1) = P(y = S|x)\mathbb{1}(d_1 = T) + P(y_1^* = S|t)\mathbb{1}(d_1 = R)$

• **Dynamic:**

$$u_1(x, t, n_1, \overline{q_1}, \overline{m_1}, d_1) = \mathbb{E}[v_2(x, z, \ddot{m}_2, n_2, \overline{q_2}, \overline{m_2}, \epsilon_2)|x, n_1, \overline{q_1}, \overline{m_1}]\mathbb{1}(d_1 = T) + L(y_1^* = S|t)\mathbb{1}(d_1 = R), \text{ such that:}$$

$$\mathbb{E}[v_2(x, z, \ddot{m}_2, n_2, \overline{q_2}, \overline{m_2}, \epsilon_2)|x, n_1, \overline{q_1}, \overline{m_1}] =$$

$$\int_{\widetilde{m_2}} \int_{\widetilde{q_2}} \int_{\widetilde{n_2}} \int_{\widetilde{z}} \int_{\widetilde{m_2}} \sigma \log \left( \sum_{\widetilde{d_2} \in \{A, R\}} e^{u_2(x, \widetilde{z}, \widetilde{m_2}, \widetilde{n_2}, \widetilde{q_2}, \widetilde{m_2}, \widetilde{d_2})/\sigma} \right) dF_{\ddot{m}_2|x, z}(\ddot{m}_2|x, \widetilde{z}) dF_{z|x}(\widetilde{z}|x) dF_{n_2|n_1}(\widetilde{n_2}|n_1) dF_{\overline{q_2}|\overline{q_1}}(\widetilde{q_2}|\overline{q_1}) dF_{\overline{m_2}|\overline{m_1}}(\widetilde{m_2}|\overline{m_1})$$

## Conditional Choice Probabilities:

$$P(d_r|\text{states}) = \frac{\exp(u_r(\text{states}, d_r)/\sigma)}{\sum_{\widetilde{d_r} \in D_r} \exp(u_r(\text{states}, \widetilde{d_r})/\sigma)}$$



# A2.1: Full Waitlist-Dynamic Parameterization 1

## Unrestricted CCPs:

$$P_{d_1} = P(d_1 = T | x, t, n_1, \overline{q_1}, \overline{m_1}; \theta_T) = \frac{\exp(f_T(x, t, n_1, \overline{q_1}, \overline{m_1})\theta_T)}{1 + \exp(f_T(x, t, n_1, \overline{q_1}, \overline{m_1})\theta_T)}$$

$$P_{d_2} = P(d_2 = A | x, z, \ddot{m}_2, n_2, \overline{q_2}, \overline{m_2}; \theta_{A_2}) = \frac{\exp(f_{A_2}(x, z, \ddot{m}_2, n_2, \overline{q_2}, \overline{m_2})\theta_{A_2})}{1 + \exp(f_{A_2}(x, z, \ddot{m}_2, n_2, \overline{q_2}, \overline{m_2})\theta_{A_2})}$$

$$P_{d_3} = P(d_3 = A | x, z, \overline{m_{2A}}, n_3, \overline{q_3}, \overline{m_3}; \theta_{A_3}) = \frac{\exp(f_{A_3}(x, z, \overline{m_{2A}}, n_3, \overline{q_3}, \overline{m_3})\theta_{A_3})}{1 + \exp(f_{A_3}(x, z, \overline{m_{2A}}, n_3, \overline{q_3}, \overline{m_3})\theta_{A_3})}$$

## Success Probability:

$$P_y = P(y = S | x, z; \theta_S) = \frac{\exp(f_S(x, z)\theta_S)}{1 + \exp(f_S(x, z)\theta_S)}$$

## Cutoff Levels/Probabilities:

$$L_{y_1^*} = L(y_1^* = S | t; \theta_{S_1^*}) = \exp(f_{S_1^*}(t)\theta_{S_1^*})$$

$$P_{y_3^*} = P(y_3^* = S | \overline{m_{2A}}, n_3, \overline{q_3}, \overline{m_3}; \theta_{S_3^*}) = \frac{\exp(f_{S_3^*}(\overline{m_{2A}}, n_3, \overline{q_3}, \overline{m_3})\theta_{S_3^*})}{1 + \exp(f_{S_3^*}(\overline{m_{2A}}, n_3, \overline{q_3}, \overline{m_3})\theta_{S_3^*})}$$

## A2.1: Full Waitlist-Dynamic Parameterization 2

★ Assume  $(z, \ddot{m}_2, n_2, \overline{q_2}, \overline{m_2})$  and  $(\overline{m_{2A}}, n_3, \overline{q_3}, \overline{m_3})$  are mutually conditionally independent:

$$\mathbb{E}[v_2(x, z, \ddot{m}_2, n_2, \overline{q_2}, \overline{m_2}, \epsilon_2) | x, n_1, \overline{q_1}, \overline{m_1}] = \int_{\widetilde{\overline{m_2}}} \int_{\widetilde{\overline{q_2}}} \int_{\widetilde{n_2}} \int_{\widetilde{z}} \int_{\widetilde{\ddot{m}_2}} \sigma \log \left( \sum_{\widetilde{d_2} \in \{A, R\}} e^{u_2(x, \widetilde{z}, \widetilde{\ddot{m}_2}, \widetilde{n_2}, \widetilde{\overline{q_2}}, \widetilde{\overline{m_2}}, \widetilde{d_2}) / \sigma} \right)$$

$$dF_{\ddot{m}_2 | x, z}(\widetilde{\ddot{m}_2} | x, \widetilde{z}) dF_{z | x}(\widetilde{z} | x) dF_{n_2 | n_1}(\widetilde{n_2} | n_1) dF_{\overline{q_2} | \overline{q_1}}(\widetilde{\overline{q_2}} | \overline{q_1}) dF_{\overline{m_2} | \overline{m_1}}(\widetilde{\overline{m_2}} | \overline{m_1}) = \int_{\widetilde{\overline{m_2}}} \int_{\widetilde{\overline{q_2}}} \int_{\widetilde{n_2}} \int_{\widetilde{z_1}} \cdots \int_{\widetilde{z_{J_z}}} \int_{\widetilde{\ddot{m}_2}} \left[ \cdot \right]$$

$$dF_{\ddot{m}_2 | x, z}(\widetilde{\ddot{m}_2} | x, \widetilde{z}) dF_{z | x, 1}(\widetilde{z_1} | \widetilde{z_2}, \dots, \widetilde{z_{J_z}}, x) \cdots dF_{z | x, J_z}(\widetilde{z_{J_z}} | x) dF_{n_2 | n_1}(\widetilde{n_2} | n_1) dF_{\overline{q_2} | \overline{q_1}}(\widetilde{\overline{q_2}} | \overline{q_1}) dF_{\overline{m_2} | \overline{m_1}}(\widetilde{\overline{m_2}} | \overline{m_1})$$

$$\mathbb{E}[v_3(x, z, \overline{m_{2A}}, n_3, \overline{q_3}, \overline{m_3}, \epsilon_3) | x, z, \ddot{m}_2, n_2, \overline{q_2}, \overline{m_2}] =$$

$$\int_{\widetilde{\overline{m_3}}} \int_{\widetilde{\overline{q_3}}} \int_{\widetilde{n_3}} \int_{\widetilde{\overline{m_{2A}}}} \sigma \log \left( \sum_{\widetilde{d_3} \in \{A, R\}} e^{u_3(x, z, \widetilde{\overline{m_{2A}}}, \widetilde{n_3}, \widetilde{\overline{q_3}}, \widetilde{\overline{m_3}}, \widetilde{d_3}) / \sigma} \right) dF_{\overline{m_{2A}} | \ddot{m}_2}(\widetilde{\overline{m_{2A}}} | \ddot{m}_2) dF_{n_3 | n_2}(\widetilde{n_3} | n_2) dF_{\overline{q_3} | \overline{q_2}}(\widetilde{\overline{q_3}} | \overline{q_2}) dF_{\overline{m_3} | \overline{m_2}}(\widetilde{\overline{m_3}} | \overline{m_2})$$

- **Continuous:**  $f_{z|x}(z_j | x; \beta_{F_{z|x,j}}, \sigma_{F_{z|x,j}}^2) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi\sigma_{F_{z|x,j}}^2}} \exp \left[ \frac{-1}{2\sigma_{F_{z|x,j}}^2} (z_j - g(x)\beta_{F_{z|x,j}})^2 \right]$

- **Binary:**  $P(z_j = 1 | x; \theta_{F_{z|x,j}}) = \frac{\exp(g(x)\theta_{F_{z|x,j}})}{1 + \exp(g(x)\theta_{F_{z|x,j}})}$

- **Multinomial:**  $P(z_j = (k \neq K) | x; \theta_{F_{z|x,j}}^k) = \frac{\exp(g(x)\theta_{F_{z|x,j}}^k)}{1 + \sum_{\ell=1}^{K-1} \exp(g(x)\theta_{F_{z|x,j}}^\ell)}$

## A2.1: Full Waitlist-Dynamic Likelihood

$$\begin{aligned}
 \mathcal{L}_{N_1}^U(\theta) = & \prod_{n=1}^{N_3} f_{z|x}(z_n|x_n; \theta_{F_{z|x}}) f_{\ddot{m}_2|x,z}(\ddot{m}_{2,n}|x_n, z_n; \theta_{F_{\ddot{m}_2|x,z}}) f_{n_2|n_1}(n_{2,n}|n_{1,n}; \theta_{F_{n_2|n_1}}) f_{\overline{q_2}|\overline{q_1}}(\overline{q_{2,n}}|\overline{q_{1,n}}; \theta_{F_{\overline{q_2}|\overline{q_1}}}) f_{\overline{m_2}|\overline{m_1}}(\overline{m_{2,n}}|\overline{m_{1,n}}; \theta_{F_{\overline{m_2}|\overline{m_1}}}) \\
 & f_{\overline{m_{2A}}|\overline{m_2}}(\overline{m_{2A,n}}|\overline{m_{2,n}}; \theta_{F_{\overline{m_{2A}}|\overline{m_2}}}) f_{n_3|n_2}(n_{3,n}|n_{2,n}; \theta_{F_{n_3|n_2}}) f_{\overline{q_3}|\overline{q_2}}(\overline{q_{3,n}}|\overline{q_{2,n}}; \theta_{F_{\overline{q_3}|\overline{q_2}}}) f_{\overline{m_3}|\overline{m_2}}(\overline{m_{3,n}}|\overline{m_{2,n}}; \theta_{F_{\overline{m_3}|\overline{m_2}}}) \\
 & P_{d_{1,n}}(\theta_T)(1 - P_{d_{2,n}}(\theta_{A_2}))P_{d_{3,n}}(\theta_{A_3})^{\mathbb{1}(d_{3,n}=A)}(1 - P_{d_{3,n}}(\theta_{A_3}))^{\mathbb{1}(d_{3,n}=R)}P_{y_n}(\theta_S)^{\mathbb{1}(y_n=S)}(1 - P_{y_n}(\theta_S))^{\mathbb{1}(y_n=F)} \\
 \prod_{n=N_3+1}^{N_2} & f_{z|x}(z_n|x_n; \theta_{F_{z|x}}) f_{\ddot{m}_2|x,z}(\ddot{m}_{2,n}|x_n, z_n; \theta_{F_{\ddot{m}_2|x,z}}) f_{n_2|n_1}(n_{2,n}|n_{1,n}; \theta_{F_{n_2|n_1}}) f_{\overline{q_2}|\overline{q_1}}(\overline{q_{2,n}}|\overline{q_{1,n}}; \theta_{F_{\overline{q_2}|\overline{q_1}}}) f_{\overline{m_2}|\overline{m_1}}(\overline{m_{2,n}}|\overline{m_{1,n}}; \theta_{F_{\overline{m_2}|\overline{m_1}}}) \\
 & f_{\overline{m_{2A}}|\overline{m_2}}(\overline{m_{2A,n}}|\overline{m_{2,n}}; \theta_{F_{\overline{m_{2A}}|\overline{m_2}}}) f_{n_3|n_2}(n_{3,n}|n_{2,n}; \theta_{F_{n_3|n_2}}) f_{\overline{q_3}|\overline{q_2}}(\overline{q_{3,n}}|\overline{q_{2,n}}; \theta_{F_{\overline{q_3}|\overline{q_2}}}) f_{\overline{m_3}|\overline{m_2}}(\overline{m_{3,n}}|\overline{m_{2,n}}; \theta_{F_{\overline{m_3}|\overline{m_2}}}) \\
 & P_{d_{1,n}}(\theta_T)P_{d_{2,n}}(\theta_{A_2})P_{y_n}(\theta_S)^{\mathbb{1}(y_n=S)}(1 - P_{y_n}(\theta_S))^{\mathbb{1}(y_n=F)} \prod_{n=N_2+1}^{N_1} f_{z|x}(z_n|x_n; \theta_{F_{z|x}}) f_{\ddot{m}_2|x,z}(\ddot{m}_{2,n}|x_n, z_n; \theta_{F_{\ddot{m}_2|x,z}}) \\
 & f_{n_2|n_1}(n_{2,n}|n_{1,n}; \theta_{F_{n_2|n_1}}) f_{\overline{q_2}|\overline{q_1}}(\overline{q_{2,n}}|\overline{q_{1,n}}; \theta_{F_{\overline{q_2}|\overline{q_1}}}) f_{\overline{m_2}|\overline{m_1}}(\overline{m_{2,n}}|\overline{m_{1,n}}; \theta_{F_{\overline{m_2}|\overline{m_1}}})(1 - P_{d_{1,n}}(\theta_T))
 \end{aligned}$$

- For  $\mathcal{L}^R$  and  $\mathcal{L}^U$ , estimate  $\theta_S^U$  with 1st-stage likelihood to get  $\bar{q}$  = current year's  $\overline{P_{y_n}}$ :  
 $\mathcal{L}_{N_2}^P(\theta_S) = \prod_{n=1}^{N_2} P_{y_n}(\theta_S)^{\mathbb{1}(y_n=S)}(1 - P_{y_n}(\theta_S))^{\mathbb{1}(y_n=F)}$

## A2.1: Waitlist Notes: Memory and Dynamics

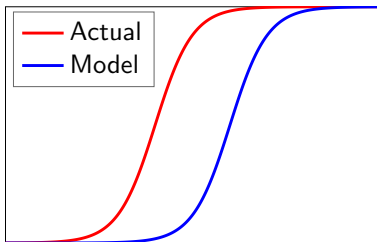
- **Memory:** Need at least 5 years of data to identify all parameters
  - For simplicity with simulated data, suppose committee provides  $m_2$ . But to estimate  $m_2$  with actual data, estimate matriculation parameters in first-stage likelihood
- **Dynamics:** What if committee doesn't think dynamically?
  - If  $\ddot{m}_2$  increasing increases  $\bar{F}_{\overline{m_{2A}}|\ddot{m}_2}$ , which increases  $\mathbb{E}[P(\text{Cutoff})_3]$ , then it should
  - Don't need success data for all years to identify these two effects
- **Over/Undershooting:** Committee may wish to avoid both
  - To Round 3's  $P(\text{Cutoff})$ , add target cohort size minus number of early matriculants
  - Penalty parameter may be unidentifiable, so may have to calibrate it

## A2.1: Optimality Tests Notes

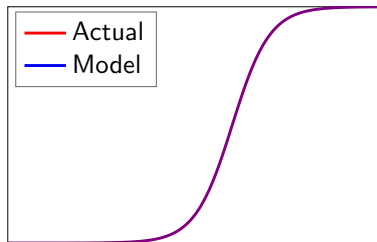
- ❶ **Likelihood-Ratio:** Restricted model not nested in unrestricted model (Vuong 1989)
  - **Program Fit:** Does model fit program's behavior?
    - $d_1 = \mathbb{1}(\text{Transition})$ ,  $d_2 = \mathbb{1}(\text{Accept})$
    - If not, could program be behaving suboptimally (Simon 1956)?
  - **Profession Fit:** Does model fit profession's behavior?
    - $d_2 = \mathbb{1}(\text{AttendProgram})$  but  $d_1$  unobservable, so must estimate one-stage model
- ❷ **Deviation Gains:** Adjust  $\theta_{S^*}$  so transition and acceptance rates are unchanged
  - **Year-Static:** Rank all applicants by  $P(y = S|x)$ , set  $\theta_{S_1^*}$  to match transition rate, rank survivors by  $P(S|x, z)$ , and set  $\theta_{S_2^*}$  to match acceptance rate
  - **Year-Dynamic:** Use MSM to estimate new  $(\theta_{S_1^*}, \theta_{S_2^*})$ ; moments are each year's transition and acceptance rates. But counterfactual does not require  $(\hat{\theta}_{S_1^*}, \hat{\theta}_{S_2^*})$

## A2.1: How Deviation Gains Test Works

- 1 Write Bellman equations for committee's optimization problem
- 2 Estimate parameters. Rationality assumption distorts estimates
- 3 Re-estimate parameters without rationality, and use to solve model
- 4 Compare selections from model's decision rule to actual decision rule
- 5 To prevent overfitting, use perturbations of estimates for comparison



Non-Optimizing Committee



Optimizing Committee

# A2.1: Deviation Gains Algorithm 1

## Year-Static/Dynamic/Myopic:

- 1 Rank applicants in each year by  $P(y = S|x)$  for static, or  $\mathbb{E}[v_2(x, z, \epsilon_2)|x]$  for dynamic and myopic. Transition top  $N_T$  applicants, and reject the rest
- 2 Rank surviving applicants by  $P(y = S|x, z)$ , and accept top  $N_A$  survivors. Compute  $\overline{P(y = S|x, z)}$  of acceptance set, and compare to committee's set

» Deviation Gains Interpretation

## A2.1: Deviation Gains Algorithm 2

### Waitlist-Hybrid/Dynamic:

- 1 Rank applicants in each year by  $P(y = S|x)$  for hybrid, or  $\mathbb{E}[v_2(x, z, \ddot{m}_2, \epsilon_2)|x]$  for dynamic. Transition top  $N_T$  applicants, and reject the rest
- 2 Rank surviving applicants by  $P(y = S|x, z) - \beta \mathbb{E}[v_3(x, z, \overline{m}_{2A}, \epsilon_3)|x, z, \ddot{m}_2]$ . Accept top  $N_{2A}$  survivors, and waitlist the rest
- 3 Rank early acceptances by matriculation score  $m$ . All early acceptances with  $m$  at least as high as committee's marginal early matriculant matriculate
- 4 Rank waitlisted applicants by  $P(y = S|x, z)$ . Increase/decrease  $N_{3A}$  to  $N'_{3A}$  depending on how many spots remain relative to committee
- 5 Rank late acceptances by  $m$ . Top ones matriculate until cohort is filled. Compute  $P(y = S|x, z)$  of matriculation set, and compare to committee's set



## A2.1: Randomization Tests 1

### Theorem 4 (Proof)

Let  $d^R$  be the model's decision rule, and  $d^U$  the actual decision rule. By optimality:

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{1}{N_A} \sum_{n=1}^N P(y_n = S | x_n, z_n; \hat{\theta}_S^U) \mathbb{1} \{ d_{1,n}[P_{y_n}(\hat{\theta}^U)] = T, d_{2,n}^R[P_{y_n}(\hat{\theta}_S^U)] = A \} \\ \geq \frac{1}{N_A} \sum_{n=1}^N P(y_n = S | x_n, z_n; \hat{\theta}_S^U) \mathbb{1} \{ d_{1,n}[P_{y_n}(\hat{\theta}^U)] = T, d_{2,n}^U[P_{y_n}(\hat{\theta}_A^U)] = A \} \end{aligned}$$

- But for perturbation  $\widetilde{\theta_{S,t}^U}$  of  $\hat{\theta}_S^U$ 's asymptotic distribution, can have:

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{1}{N_A} \sum_{n=1}^N P(y_n = S | x_n, z_n; \widetilde{\theta_{S,t}^U}) \mathbb{1} \{ d_{1,n}[P_{y_n}(\hat{\theta}_U)] = T, d_{2,n}^R[P_{y_n}(\hat{\theta}_S^U)] = A \} \\ < \frac{1}{N_A} \sum_{n=1}^N P(y_n = S | x_n, z_n; \widetilde{\theta_{S,t}^U}) \mathbb{1} \{ d_{1,n}[P_{y_n}(\hat{\theta}_U)] = T, d_{2,n}^U[P_{y_n}(\hat{\theta}_A^U)] = A \} \end{aligned}$$

- For waitlist models, compare matriculants, not acceptances

## A2.1: Randomization Tests 2

- **Question:** Are deviation gains robust to estimation error?
- **Test 1:** Across  $T$  perturbations, plot CDFs of  $\overline{P(\text{Success})}$  of both acceptance sets. Does the model's CDF stochastically dominate the actual decision rule's CDF?
- **Test 2:** Two-sample Kolmogorov-Smirnov test of equality of CDFs:
  - Let  $X = \overline{P_y[d(\hat{\theta}^U), \widetilde{\theta}_S^U]}$ , and  $F_T(x)$  be  $X$ 's CDF over  $T$  perturbations
  - Then  $D_T = \sup_x |F_T^R(x) - F_T^U(x)|$ . Reject equality if  $D_T > \sqrt{\frac{-\log(\alpha/2)}{T}}$
- **Open Question:** Would deviation gains be borne out in practice?

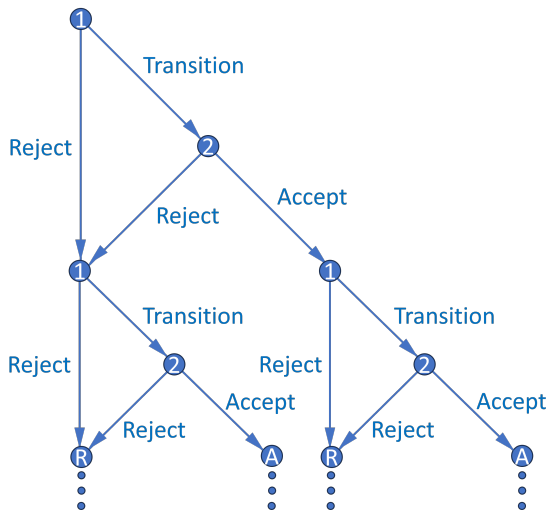
## A2.1: Summary of Results

- **Results:** Estimation results are well behaved
  - **Year-Static:** Likelihood-ratio test rejects and deviation gains statistically significant only for simulated dataset where committee misvalues applicant characteristics
  - **Year-Dynamic:** Likelihood-ratio test always rejects, but gains exist only for non-optimizing dataset. Gains are slightly larger than in year-myopic model
  - **Waitlist-Hybrid/Dynamic:** Matriculation estimates are as expected
- Example of cutoff probability reversal if committee transitions few files in Round 1:
  - Three applicants: A, B, and C. Committee transitions two, accepts one
  - A is best and C is worst overall, but A is worst in objective variables
  - Committee rejects A in Round 1 and accepts B, who is worse than A
  - By assuming  $h$  hours to read application file and  $w$  hourly wage, and calculating model's  $P(\text{Success})$  induced by all possible  $N_T$ , can put dollar value on success

## A2.1: Extensions

- **Extension 1:** Create matriculation score uncorrelated with  $P(\text{Success})$ 
  - For accepted applicants, use matriculation predictors in essays/rec letters
  - Can help committee find “people that we can afford” (*Moneyball*)
- **Extension 2:** Relax assumption that committee maximizes  $P(\text{Success})$ 
  - Instead maximize convex combination of  $P(\text{Success})$  and other objectives
  - **Example:** Committee may want diverse cohort (e.g. across fields):  
 $\alpha P(\text{Success}) + (1 - \alpha)\text{Diversity}$ , where  $\alpha \in [0, 1]$  can be estimated
- **Extension 3:** Multiyear models (see Appendix 2.2)
  - Two-round models repeat over infinite horizon with discounting
  - States contain info about past years/rounds, and committee values future years/rounds (memory includes matriculation score and diversity)

## A2.2: Multiyear Decision Graph



## A2.2: Multiyear Memory (Matriculation)

- Suppose committee maximizes discounted “lifetime” cohort success
- Respecify  $P(y_2^* = S|t)$ , where  $t = \text{year}$ , as  $L(y_2^* = S|\bar{q}, M, c_{-1})$ 
  - $\bar{q}$  = current year’s average surviving applicant quality (i.e. average  $P(\text{Success})$ )
  - $M$  = current year’s number of surviving applicants
  - $c_{-1}$  = previous year’s cohort size
  - $L(\text{Cutoff}_2)$  increases in all three. In particular, in increases in  $c_{-1}$  because committee must keep number of total students in program relatively constant
- What information available at start of Round 2 determines  $c$ ?
  - **Always:**  $\bar{m}$  = average surviving applicant matriculation score
  - **If and only if  $d_2 = A$ :**  $m$  = applicant’s matriculation score

## A2.2: Multiyear Dynamics (Matriculation)

### Theorem 5 (Proof)

*Success probability equal, an applicant's Round 2 acceptance probability is strictly increasing in their matriculation score.*

- With memory, optimal dynamic decision may not equal optimal myopic one
  - May accept applicant with high  $m$  even if  $P(\text{Success}) < L(\text{Cutoff}_2)$
  - High  $m$  means high  $\bar{F}_{c|m}$ , which means high  $\mathbb{E}[L(\text{Cutoff}_2)']$  and future EV
  - Accepting applicants who will matriculate helps avoid future TA shortages, and accepting more applicants next year is undesirable if there's any risk aversion
- Harder to estimate since multiyear problem has no closed-form solution
  - Reduced-form results and factor analysis can help reduce dimensionality

## A2.2: Multiyear Model (Matriculation), Round 2

$$v_2(x, z, m, \bar{m}, \bar{q}, M, c_{-1}, \epsilon_2) = \max_{d_2 \in \{A, R\}} u_2(x, z, m, \bar{m}, \bar{q}, M, c_{-1}, d_2) + \epsilon_2(d_2), \text{ such that:}$$

$$u_2(x, z, m, \bar{m}, \bar{q}, M, c_{-1}, d_2) = \{P(y = S|x, z) + \beta \mathbb{E}[v_1(x', t', c, \epsilon_1')|m, \bar{m}]\} \mathbb{1}(d_2 = A) \\ + \{L(y_2^* = S|\bar{q}, M, c_{-1}) + \beta \mathbb{E}[v_1(x', t', c, \epsilon_1')|\bar{m}]\} \mathbb{1}(d_2 = R), \text{ such that:}$$

$$\mathbb{E}[v_1(x', t', c, \epsilon_1')|(m), \bar{m}] = \int_c \int_{t'} \int_{x'} \sigma \log \left( \sum_{d_1' \in \{T, R\}} e^{u_1(x', t', c, d_1')/\sigma} \right) dF_x(x') dF_t(t') dF_{c|(m), \bar{m}}(c|(m), \bar{m})$$

### Conditional Choice Probabilities:

$$P(d_2|x, z, m, \bar{m}, \bar{q}, M, c_{-1}) = \frac{\exp(u_2(x, z, m, \bar{m}, \bar{q}, M, c_{-1}, d_2)/\sigma)}{\sum_{\tilde{d}_2 \in \{A, R\}} \exp(u_2(x, z, m, \bar{m}, \bar{q}, M, c_{-1}, \tilde{d}_2)/\sigma)}$$



## A2.2: Multiyear Model (Matriculation), Round 1

$$v_1(x, t, c_{-1}, \epsilon_1) = \max_{d_1 \in \{T, R\}} u_1(x, t, c_{-1}, d_1) + \epsilon_1(d_1), \text{ such that:}$$

$$u_1(x, t, c_{-1}, d_1) = \mathbb{E}[v_2(x, z, m, \bar{m}, \bar{q}, M, c_{-1}, \epsilon_2) | x, c_{-1}] \mathbb{1}(d_1 = T) \\ + \{L(y_1^* = S | t) + \beta \mathbb{E}[v_1(x', t', c, \epsilon_1') | \bar{m}]\} \mathbb{1}(d_1 = R), \text{ such that:}$$

$$\mathbb{E}[v_2(x, z, m, \bar{m}, \bar{q}, M, c_{-1}, \epsilon_2) | x, c_{-1}] = \\ \int_{\tilde{M}} \int_{\tilde{q}} \int_{\tilde{m}} \int_{\tilde{m}} \int_{\tilde{z}} \sigma \log \left( \sum_{\tilde{d}_2 \in \{A, R\}} e^{u_2(x, \tilde{z}, \tilde{m}, \tilde{m}, \tilde{q}, \tilde{M}, c_{-1}, \tilde{d}_2) / \sigma} \right) dF_{z|x}(\tilde{z}|x) dF_{m|x}(\tilde{m}|x) dF_{\bar{m}}(\tilde{m}) dF_{\bar{q}}(\tilde{q}) dF_M(\tilde{M})$$

### Conditional Choice Probabilities:

$$P(d_1 | x, t, c_{-1}) = \frac{\exp(u_1(x, t, c_{-1}, d_1) / \sigma)}{\sum_{\tilde{d}_1 \in \{T, R\}} \exp(u_1(x, t, c_{-1}, \tilde{d}_1) / \sigma)}$$

## A2.2: Multiyear (Matriculation) Parameterization 1

### Unrestricted CCPs:

$$P_{d_1} = P(d_1 = T | x, t, c_{-1}; \theta_T) = \frac{\exp(f_T(x, t, c_{-1})\theta_T)}{1 + \exp(f_T(x, t, c_{-1})\theta_T)}$$

$$P_{d_2} = P(d_2 = A | x, z, m, \bar{m}, \bar{q}, M, c_{-1}; \theta_A) = \frac{\exp(f_A(x, z, m, \bar{m}, \bar{q}, M, c_{-1})\theta_A)}{1 + \exp(f_A(x, z, m, \bar{m}, \bar{q}, M, c_{-1})\theta_A)}$$

### Success Probability:

$$P_y = P(y = S | x, z; \theta_S) = \frac{\exp(f_S(x, z)\theta_S)}{1 + \exp(f_S(x, z)\theta_S)}$$

### Cutoff Levels:

$$L_{y_1^*} = L(y_1^* = S | t; \theta_{S_1^*}) = f_{S_1^*}(t)\theta_{S_1^*}$$
$$L_{y_2^*} = L(y_2^* = S | \bar{q}, M, c_{-1}; \theta_{S_2^*}) = f_{S_2^*}(\bar{q}, M, c_{-1})\theta_{S_2^*}$$

## A2.2: Multiyear (Matriculation) Parameterization 2.1

★ Assume  $(x, t)$  mutually independent, and next year independent of current year:

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{E}[v_1(x', t', c, \epsilon_1') | (m), \bar{m}] &= \int_c \int_{t'} \int_{x'} \sigma \log \left( \sum_{d_1' \in \{T, R\}} e^{u_1(x', t', c, d_1') / \sigma} \right) dF_x(x') dF_t(t') dF_{c|(m), \bar{m}}(c | (m), \bar{m}) \\ &= \int_c \int_{t_1'} \cdots \int_{t_{J_t}'} \int_{x_1'} \cdots \int_{x_{J_x}'} \left[ \cdot \right] dF_{x,1}(x_1' | x_2', \dots, x_{J_x}') \cdots dF_{x,J_x}(x_{J_x}') dF_{t,1}(t_1' | t_2', \dots, t_{J_t}') \cdots dF_{t,J_t}(t_{J_t}') dF_{c|(m), \bar{m}}(c | (m), \bar{m}) \end{aligned}$$

- **Continuous:**  $f_x(x_j; \beta_{F_{x,j}}, \sigma_{F_{x,j}}^2) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi\sigma_{F_{x,j}}^2}} \exp \left[ \frac{-1}{2\sigma_{F_{x,j}}^2} (x_j - \beta_{F_{x,j}})^2 \right]$

- **Binary:**  $P(x_j = 1; \theta_{F_{x,j}}) = \frac{\exp(\theta_{F_{x,j}})}{1 + \exp(\theta_{F_{x,j}})}$

- **Multinomial:**  $P(x_j = (k \neq K); \theta_{F_{x,j}}^k) = \frac{\exp(\theta_{F_{x,j}}^k)}{1 + \sum_{\ell=1}^{K-1} \exp(\theta_{F_{x,j}}^\ell)}$

## A2.2: Multiyear (Matriculation) Parameterization 2.2

★ Assume  $(z, m, \bar{m}, \bar{q}, M)$  mutually independent such that  $(z, m)|x$ :

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{E}[v_2(x, z, m, \bar{m}, \bar{q}, M, c_{-1}, \epsilon_2)|x, c_{-1}] &= \\ \int_{\tilde{M}} \int_{\tilde{q}} \int_{\tilde{\bar{m}}} \int_{\tilde{m}} \int_{\tilde{z}} \sigma \log \left( \sum_{\tilde{d}_2 \in \{A, R\}} e^{u_2(x, \tilde{z}, \tilde{m}, \tilde{\bar{m}}, \tilde{\bar{q}}, \tilde{M}, c_{-1}, \tilde{d}_2)/\sigma} \right) dF_{z|x}(\tilde{z}|x) dF_{m|x}(\tilde{m}|x) dF_{\bar{m}}(\tilde{\bar{m}}) dF_{\bar{q}}(\tilde{\bar{q}}) dF_M(\tilde{M}) \\ &= \int_{\tilde{M}} \int_{\tilde{q}} \int_{\tilde{\bar{m}}} \int_{\tilde{m}} \int_{\tilde{z}_1} \cdots \int_{\tilde{z}_Z} \left[ \cdot \right] dF_{z|x,1}(\tilde{z}_1|\tilde{z}_2, \dots, \tilde{z}_Z, x) \cdots dF_{z|x,Z}(\tilde{z}_Z|x) dF_{m|x}(\tilde{m}|x) dF_{\bar{m}}(\tilde{\bar{m}}) dF_{\bar{q}}(\tilde{\bar{q}}) dF_M(\tilde{M}) \end{aligned}$$

- **Continuous:**  $f_{z|x}(z_j|x; \beta_{F_{z|x,j}}, \sigma_{F_{z|x,j}}^2) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi\sigma_{F_{z|x,j}}^2}} \exp \left[ \frac{-1}{2\sigma_{F_{z|x,j}}^2} (z_j - g(x)\beta_{F_{z|x,j}})^2 \right]$
- **Binary:**  $P(z_j = 1|x; \theta_{F_{z|x,j}}) = \frac{\exp(g(x)\theta_{F_{z|x,j}})}{1 + \exp(g(x)\theta_{F_{z|x,j}})}$
- **Multinomial:**  $P(z_j = (k \neq K)|x; \theta_{F_{z|x,j}^k}) = \frac{\exp(g(x)\theta_{F_{z|x,j}^k})}{1 + \sum_{\ell=1}^{K-1} \exp(g(x)\theta_{F_{z|x,j}^\ell})}$

## A2.2: Multiyear (Matriculation) Likelihood

$$\mathcal{L}_N^U(\theta) = \prod_{n=1}^{N_T} f_x(x_n; \theta_{F_x}) f_t(t_n; \theta_{F_t}) f_{z|x}(z_n|x_n; \theta_{F_{z|x}}) f_{m|x}(m_n|x_n; \theta_{F_{m|x}}) f_{\bar{m}}(\bar{m}_n; \theta_{F_{\bar{m}}}) f_{\bar{q}}(\bar{q}_n; \theta_{F_{\bar{q}}}) f_M(M_n; \theta_{F_M})$$

$$f_{c|m, \bar{m}}(c_n|m_n, \bar{m}_n; \theta_{F_{c|m, \bar{m}}}) P_{d_{1,n}}(\theta_T) P_{d_{2,n}}(\theta_A)^{\mathbb{1}(d_{2,n}=A)} (1 - P_{d_{2,n}}(\theta_A))^{\mathbb{1}(d_{2,n}=R)} P_{y_n}(\theta_S)^{\mathbb{1}(y_n=S)} (1 - P_{y_n}(\theta_S))^{\mathbb{1}(y_n=F)}$$

$$\prod_{n=N_T+1}^N f_x(x_n; \theta_{F_x}) f_t(t_n; \theta_{F_t}) f_{z|x}(z_n|x_n; \theta_{F_{z|x}}) f_{m|x}(m_n|x_n; \theta_{F_{m|x}}) (1 - P_{d_{1,n}}(\theta_T))$$

- For  $\mathcal{L}^R$  and  $\mathcal{L}^U$ , estimate  $\theta_S^U$  with 1st-stage likelihood to get  $\bar{q}$  = current year's  $\bar{P}_{y_n}$ :  
 $\mathcal{L}_{N_T}^P(\theta_S) = \prod_{n=1}^{N_T} P_{y_n}(\theta_S)^{\mathbb{1}(y_n=S)} (1 - P_{y_n}(\theta_S))^{\mathbb{1}(y_n=F)}$
- As with year-dynamic model, for  $\mathcal{L}_R$ , use  $(\theta_F^U, \theta_S^U)$  as initial guess of  $(\theta_F^R, \theta_S^R)$

## A2.2: Multiyear Memory and Dynamics (Diversity)

- Let additional state  $a$  = any diversity variable affecting success
  - For example,  $a = \mathbb{1}(\text{TheoryField})$ ; theory is less common than applied
  - Let  $\bar{a}_{-1}$  = percentage of last year's acceptance set that's theory
  - If  $|a - \bar{a}_{-1}|$  is small,  $P(\text{Success})$  may decrease because future advisor may be too busy (effect may be unidentifiable if program never gets too imbalanced)

### Theorem 6 (Proof)

*Consider any two applicants, one with  $a = 1$  and one with  $a = 0$ , but with equal success probabilities and therefore different values of  $x$  or  $z$ . Suppose  $P(a' = 1) = p > 0$ . Then for all sufficiently small  $p$ , the  $a = 1$  applicant has a strictly greater Round 2 acceptance probability.*

- Optimal dynamic decision may not equal optimal myopic one. May accept diverse applicant with  $P(\text{Success}) < L(\text{Cutoff})$  to increase  $P(\text{Success})$  of next year's pool
  - Relative to  $a = 0$ ,  $a = 1 \Rightarrow$  higher  $\bar{F}_{\bar{a}|a} \Rightarrow$  higher  $\mathbb{E}[P(\text{Success})']$  and future EV

## A2.2: Multiyear Model (Diversity), Round 2

$$v_2(x, z, a, \bar{a}_{-1}, t, \epsilon_2) = \max_{d_2 \in \{A, R\}} u_2(x, z, a, \bar{a}_{-1}, t, d_2) + \epsilon_2(d_2), \text{ such that:}$$

$$u_2(x, z, a, \bar{a}_{-1}, t, d_2) = \{P(y = S|x, z, |a - \bar{a}_{-1}|) + \beta \mathbb{E}[v_1(x', \bar{a}, t', \epsilon'_1)|a]\} \mathbb{1}(d_2 = A) \\ + \{L(y_2^* = S|t) + \beta \mathbb{E}[v_1(x', \bar{a}, t', \epsilon'_1)]\} \mathbb{1}(d_2 = R), \text{ such that:}$$

$$\mathbb{E}[v_1(x', \bar{a}, t', \epsilon'_1)|a] = \int_{\tilde{t}'} \int_{\tilde{\bar{a}}} \int_{\tilde{x}'} \sigma \log \left( \sum_{d'_1 \in \{T, R\}} e^{u_1(\tilde{x}', \tilde{\bar{a}}, \tilde{t}', d'_1)/\sigma} \right) dF_{x'}(\tilde{x}') dF_{\bar{a}|a}(\tilde{\bar{a}}|a) dF_{t'}(\tilde{t}')$$

**Conditional Choice Probabilities:**

$$P(d_2|x, z, a, \bar{a}_{-1}, t) = \frac{\exp(u_2(x, z, a, \bar{a}_{-1}, t, d_2)/\sigma)}{\sum_{\tilde{d}_2 \in \{A, R\}} \exp(u_2(x, z, a, \bar{a}_{-1}, t, \tilde{d}_2)/\sigma)}$$

## A2.2: Multiyear Model (Diversity), Round 1

$$v_1(x, \bar{a}_{-1}, t, \epsilon_1) = \max_{d_1 \in \{T, R\}} u_1(x, \bar{a}_{-1}, t, d_1) + \epsilon_1(d_1), \text{ such that:}$$

$$u_1(x, \bar{a}_{-1}, t, d_1) = \mathbb{E}[v_2(x, z, a, \bar{a}_{-1}, t, \epsilon_2) | x, \bar{a}_{-1}, t] \mathbb{1}(d_1 = T) \\ + \{L(y_1^* = S | t) + \beta \mathbb{E}[v_1(x', \bar{a}, t', \epsilon'_1)]\} \mathbb{1}(d_1 = R), \text{ such that:}$$

$$\mathbb{E}[v_2(x, z, a, \bar{a}_{-1}, t, \epsilon_2) | x, \bar{a}_{-1}, t] = \int_{\tilde{a}} \int_{\tilde{z}} \sigma \log \left( \sum_{\tilde{d}_2 \in A, R} e^{u_2(x, \tilde{z}, \tilde{a}, \bar{a}_{-1}, t, \tilde{d}_2) / \sigma} \right) dF_{z|x}(\tilde{z} | x) dF_a(\tilde{a})$$

$$\mathbb{E}[v_1(x', \bar{a}, t', \epsilon'_1)] = \int_{\tilde{t}'} \int_{\tilde{a}} \int_{\tilde{x}'} \sigma \log \left( \sum_{d'_1 \in \{T, R\}} e^{u_1(\tilde{x}', \tilde{a}, \tilde{t}', d'_1) / \sigma} \right) dF_{x'}(\tilde{x}') dF_{\bar{a}}(\tilde{a}) dF_{t'}(\tilde{t}')$$

### Conditional Choice Probabilities:

$$P(d_1 | x, \bar{a}_{-1}, t) = \frac{\exp(u_1(x, \bar{a}_{-1}, t, d_1) / \sigma)}{\sum_{\tilde{d}_1 \in \{T, R\}} \exp(u_1(x, \bar{a}_{-1}, t, \tilde{d}_1) / \sigma)}$$



## A2.2: Multiyears (Diversity) Parameterization 1

### Unrestricted CCPs:

$$P_{d_1} = P(d_1 = T | x, \bar{a}_{-1}, t; \theta_T) = \frac{\exp(f_T(x, \bar{a}_{-1}, t)\theta_T)}{1 + \exp(f_T(x, \bar{a}_{-1}, t)\theta_T)}$$

$$P_{d_2} = P(d_2 = A | x, z, a, \bar{a}_{-1}, t; \theta_A) = \frac{\exp(f_A(x, z, a, \bar{a}_{-1}, t)\theta_A)}{1 + \exp(f_A(x, z, a, \bar{a}_{-1}, t)\theta_A)}$$

### Success Probability:

$$P_y = P(y = S | x, z, |a - \bar{a}_{-1}|; \theta_S) = \frac{\exp(f_S(x, z, |a - \bar{a}_{-1}|)\theta_S)}{1 + \exp(f_S(x, z, |a - \bar{a}_{-1}|)\theta_S)}$$

### Cutoff Levels:

$$L_{y_1^*} = L(y_1^* = S | t; \theta_{S_1^*}) = f_{S_1^*}(t)\theta_{S_1^*}$$

$$L_{y_2^*} = L(y_2^* = S | t; \theta_{S_2^*}) = f_{S_2^*}(t)\theta_{S_2^*}$$

## A2.2: Multiyear (Diversity) Parameterization 2.1

★ Assume  $(x, \bar{a}, t)$  mutually independent such that  $\bar{a}|a$ , and  $t'$  independent of  $t$ :

$$\mathbb{E}[v_1(x', \bar{a}, t', \epsilon'_1)|a] = \int_{\tilde{t}'} \int_{\tilde{\bar{a}}} \int_{\tilde{x}'} \sigma \log \left( \sum_{d'_1 \in \{T, R\}} e^{u_1(\tilde{x}', \tilde{\bar{a}}, \tilde{t}', d'_1)/\sigma} \right) dF_{x'}(\tilde{x}') dF_{\bar{a}|a}(\tilde{\bar{a}}|a) dF_{t'}(\tilde{t}') =$$

$$\int_{\tilde{t}'_1} \cdots \int_{\tilde{t}'_{J_t}} \int_{\tilde{\bar{a}}} \int_{\tilde{x}'_1} \cdots \int_{\tilde{x}'_{J_x}} \left[ \cdot \right] F_{x,1}(x'_1|x'_2, \dots, x'_{J_x}) \cdots dF_{x,J_x}(x'_{J_x}) dF_{\bar{a}|a}(\tilde{\bar{a}}|a) dF_{t,1}(t'_1|t'_2, \dots, t'_{J_t}) \cdots dF_{t,J_t}(t'_{J_t})$$

- **Continuous:**  $f_x(x_j; \beta_{F_{x,j}}, \sigma_{F_{x,j}}^2) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi\sigma_{F_{x,j}}^2}} \exp \left[ \frac{-1}{2\sigma_{F_{x,j}}^2} (x_j - \beta_{F_{x,j}})^2 \right]$

- **Binary:**  $P(x_j = 1; \theta_{F_{x,j}}) = \frac{\exp(\theta_{F_{x,j}})}{1 + \exp(\theta_{F_{x,j}})}$

- **Multinomial:**  $P(x_j = (k \neq K); \theta_{F_{x,j}}^k) = \frac{\exp(\theta_{F_{x,j}}^k)}{1 + \sum_{\ell=1}^{K-1} \exp(\theta_{F_{x,j}}^\ell)}$

## A2.2: Multiyear (Diversity) Parameterization 2.2

★ Assume  $(z, a)$  independent, such that  $z|x$ :

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbb{E}[v_2(x, z, a, \bar{a}_{-1}, t, \epsilon_2)|x, \bar{a}_{-1}, t] &= \int_{\tilde{a}} \int_{\tilde{z}} \sigma \log \left( \sum_{\tilde{d}_2 \in A, R} e^{u_2(x, \tilde{z}, \tilde{a}, \bar{a}_{-1}, t, \tilde{d}_2)/\sigma} \right) dF_{z|x}(\tilde{z}|x) dF_a(\tilde{a}) \\ &= \int_{\tilde{a}} \int_{\tilde{z}_1} \cdots \int_{\tilde{z}_J} \left[ \cdot \right] dF_1(\tilde{z}_1|\tilde{z}_2, \dots, \tilde{z}_J, x) \cdots dF_J(\tilde{z}_J|x) dF_a(\tilde{a})\end{aligned}$$

- **Continuous:**  $f_{z|x}(z_j|x; \beta_{F_{z|x,j}}, \sigma_{F_{z|x,j}}^2) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi\sigma_{F_{z|x,j}}^2}} \exp \left[ \frac{-1}{2\sigma_{F_{z|x,j}}^2} (z_j - g(x)\beta_{F_{z|x,j}})^2 \right]$
- **Binary:**  $P(z_j = 1|x; \theta_{F_{z|x,j}}) = \frac{\exp(g(x)\theta_{F_{z|x,j}})}{1 + \exp(g(x)\theta_{F_{z|x,j}})}$
- **Multinomial:**  $P(z_j = (k \neq K)|x; \theta_{F_{z|x,j}}^k) = \frac{\exp(g(x)\theta_{F_{z|x,j}}^k)}{1 + \sum_{\ell=1}^{K-1} \exp(g(x)\theta_{F_{z|x,j}}^\ell)}$

## A2.2: Multiyear (Diversity) Likelihood

$$\mathcal{L}_N^U(\theta) = \prod_{n=1}^{N_A} f_x(x_n; \theta_{F_x}) f_t(t_n; \theta_{F_t}) f_{z|x}(z_n|x_n; \theta_{F_{z|x}}) f_a(a) f_{\bar{a}}(\bar{a}) f_{\bar{a}|a}(\bar{a}|a) P_{d_{2,n}} P_{y_n}^{\mathbb{1}(y_n=S)} (1 - P_{y_n})^{\mathbb{1}(y_n=F)}$$

$$\prod_{n=N_A+1}^{N_{T,R}} f_x(x_n; \theta_{F_x}) f_t(t_n; \theta_{F_t}) f_{z|x}(z_n|x_n; \theta_{F_{z|x}}) f_a(a) f_{\bar{a}}(\bar{a}) (1 - P_{d_{2,n}}) P_{y_n}^{\mathbb{1}(y_n=S)} (1 - P_{y_n})^{\mathbb{1}(y_n=F)}$$

$$\prod_{n=N_{T,R}+1}^N f_x(x_n; \theta_{F_x}) f_t(t_n; \theta_{F_t}) f_{z|x}(z_n|x_n; \theta_{F_{z|x}}) f_a(a) f_{\bar{a}}(\bar{a}) (1 - P_{d_{1,n}})$$

- Estimate  $f_{\bar{a}|a}(\bar{a}|a)$  on  $N_A$  accepted applicants only
- As with year-dynamic model, for  $\mathcal{L}_R$ , use  $(\theta_F^U, \theta_S^U)$  as initial guess of  $(\theta_F^R, \theta_S^R)$

# A3: Means by Program

Table 2a: Means by Program

|                    | Economics | Government | History | Linguistics | Psychology |
|--------------------|-----------|------------|---------|-------------|------------|
| Accept             | 0.1121    | 0.0430     | 0.0986  | 0.0678      | 0.0535     |
| CovidYear          | 0.2478    | 0.2792     | 0.3029  | 0.3460      | 0.3004     |
| WinsorAge          | 26.2782   | 27.9633    | 26.8478 | 28.0692     | 25.8230    |
| Female             | 0.4201    | 0.4182     | 0.4232  | 0.6133      | 0.7490     |
| US AfrHisNat       | 0.0289    | 0.0766     | 0.1159  | 0.0665      | 0.1728     |
| US Asian           | 0.0313    | 0.0421     | 0.0304  | 0.0353      | 0.0576     |
| IntAsian           | 0.5322    | 0.2510     | 0.1058  | 0.2714      | 0.1523     |
| IntOther           | 0.2517    | 0.2967     | 0.2203  | 0.3256      | 0.1584     |
| GREVerbalPct       | 71.8677   | 81.3486    | 82.6054 | 73.5451     | 75.6192    |
| GREQuantPct        | 86.2163   | 63.3428    | 49.3295 | 57.8455     | 58.0000    |
| GREAnalyticPct     | 52.6351   | 72.1905    | 75.0460 | 63.6824     | 69.2077    |
| UgradGPA           | 3.6534    | 3.5675     | 3.6531  | 3.6567      | 3.5695     |
| TOEFL/IELTS        | 7.5232    | 7.5422     | 7.4252  | 7.5444      | 7.3158     |
| EliteUSUni         | 0.1516    | 0.1847     | 0.2565  | 0.1954      | 0.2840     |
| EliteUSLA          | 0.0423    | 0.0672     | 0.0696  | 0.0231      | 0.0535     |
| EliteForeign       | 0.0717    | 0.0578     | 0.0478  | 0.0488      | 0.0206     |
| OtherForeign       | 0.5736    | 0.3953     | 0.2333  | 0.5102      | 0.1852     |
| GradDegree         | 0.7478    | 0.7553     | 0.6652  | 0.7544      | 0.4259     |
| WorkExper          | 0.5938    | 0.7463     | 0.6638  | 0.7544      | 0.7593     |
| #ProfRecom         | 2.5173    | 2.3469     | 2.6261  | 2.4355      | 2.1831     |
| #ProlificRecom     | 1.0760    | 0.6912     | 0.5043  | 0.7069      | 0.3128     |
| #MathCourses       | 6.6396    |            |         |             |            |
| AdvMath            | 0.4827    |            |         |             |            |
| MissingGRE         | 0.0255    | 0.4612     | 0.6217  | 0.6839      | 0.4650     |
| MissingUgradGPA    | 0.6607    | 0.4827     | 0.3072  | 0.5726      | 0.2490     |
| MissingTOEFL/IELTS | 0.5958    | 0.7714     | 0.8449  | 0.7707      | 0.8827     |
| Observations       | 2078      | 2231       | 690     | 737         | 486        |

- **Economics Highest:** Accept, IntAsian, GREQuantPct, EliteForeign, OtherForeign, #ProlificRecom, MissingUgradGPA
- **Economics Lowest:** CovidYear, USAfrHisNat, GREVerbalPct, GREAnalyticPct, EliteUSUni, WorkExper, MissingGRE, MissingTOEFL/IELTS

# A3: Means by Program, Accept = 1

Table 2b: Means by Program, Accept = 1

|                    | Economics | Government | History | Linguistics | Psychology |
|--------------------|-----------|------------|---------|-------------|------------|
| CovidYear          | 0.1888    | 0.2188     | 0.2059  | 0.2200      | 0.2308     |
| WinsorAge          | 25.0815   | 27.7292    | 27.2794 | 27.1000     | 25.7692    |
| Female             | 0.4850    | 0.5000     | 0.5588  | 0.5800      | 0.6154     |
| USAFrHisNat        | 0.0386    | 0.1458     | 0.1765  | 0.0400      | 0.0769     |
| USAsian            | 0.0429    | 0.0312     | 0.0147  | 0.0600      | 0.1154     |
| IntAsian           | 0.4163    | 0.1667     | 0.0882  | 0.3600      | 0.0769     |
| IntOther           | 0.2575    | 0.2292     | 0.3235  | 0.2000      | 0.1538     |
| GREVerbalPct       | 84.3980   | 88.8725    | 86.6328 | 77.9161     | 85.7729    |
| GREQuantPct        | 91.9289   | 68.3708    | 54.8113 | 64.5504     | 62.3462    |
| GREAnalyticPct     | 69.0355   | 82.7222    | 78.0879 | 68.8958     | 74.6169    |
| UgradGPA           | 3.7336    | 3.6404     | 3.7204  | 3.7004      | 3.6341     |
| TOEFL/IELTS        | 7.6419    | 7.6050     | 7.4730  | 7.6237      | 7.3178     |
| EliteUSUni         | 0.2833    | 0.3125     | 0.3382  | 0.2200      | 0.5385     |
| EliteUSLA          | 0.1030    | 0.1458     | 0.1176  | 0.0200      | 0.1154     |
| EliteForeign       | 0.1030    | 0.0521     | 0.0588  | 0.1000      | 0.0385     |
| OtherForeign       | 0.3863    | 0.2396     | 0.2647  | 0.4000      | 0.1154     |
| GradDegree         | 0.5837    | 0.6771     | 0.7206  | 0.7400      | 0.4615     |
| WorkExper          | 0.6309    | 0.8125     | 0.7647  | 0.7000      | 0.9231     |
| #ProfRecom         | 2.5494    | 2.3750     | 2.8235  | 2.7200      | 2.2308     |
| #ProlificRecom     | 1.2833    | 0.9167     | 0.6765  | 1.0800      | 0.4615     |
| #MathCourses       | 7.2575    |            |         |             |            |
| AdvMath            | 0.6781    |            |         |             |            |
| MissingGRE         | 0.0086    | 0.2917     | 0.6324  | 0.5800      | 0.1923     |
| MissingUgradGPA    | 0.4893    | 0.3125     | 0.3088  | 0.4800      | 0.1923     |
| MissingTOEFL/IELTS | 0.6567    | 0.8854     | 0.8529  | 0.7600      | 0.8846     |
| Observations       | 233       | 96         | 68      | 50          | 26         |

- **Economics Highest:** IntAsian, GREQuantPct, UGradGPA, TOEFL/IELTS, EliteForeign, #ProlificRecom, MissingUgradGPA
- **Economics Lowest:** CovidYear, WinsorAge, Female, USAfrHisNat, WorkExper, MissingGRE, MissingTOEFL/IELTS

# A3: Correlation Matrix

Table 3: Correlation Matrix

|                    | Covid | Age   | Fem   | USAHN | USAsn | IntAsn | IntOth | GREV  | GREQ  | GREA  | GPA   | T/I   | EUSUni | EUSLA | EFor  | OthFor | Grad  | Work  | Prof  | Pro   | MGRE  | MGPA  | MT/I |
|--------------------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|--------|--------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|--------|-------|-------|--------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|------|
| CovidYear          | 1.00  |       |       |       |       |        |        |       |       |       |       |       |        |       |       |        |       |       |       |       |       |       |      |
| WinsorAge          | 0.01  | 1.00  |       |       |       |        |        |       |       |       |       |       |        |       |       |        |       |       |       |       |       |       |      |
| Female             | 0.02  | -0.13 | 1.00  |       |       |        |        |       |       |       |       |       |        |       |       |        |       |       |       |       |       |       |      |
| USAFrHisNat        | 0.00  | -0.04 | 0.04  | 1.00  |       |        |        |       |       |       |       |       |        |       |       |        |       |       |       |       |       |       |      |
| USAsian            | -0.00 | -0.06 | 0.05  | -0.05 | 1.00  |        |        |       |       |       |       |       |        |       |       |        |       |       |       |       |       |       |      |
| IntAsian           | -0.05 | -0.07 | 0.02  | -0.19 | -0.14 | 1.00   |        |       |       |       |       |       |        |       |       |        |       |       |       |       |       |       |      |
| IntOther           | 0.01  | 0.18  | -0.06 | -0.17 | -0.12 | -0.42  | 1.00   |       |       |       |       |       |        |       |       |        |       |       |       |       |       |       |      |
| GREVerbalPct       | 0.03  | -0.06 | -0.04 | 0.00  | 0.04  | -0.12  | -0.15  | 1.00  |       |       |       |       |        |       |       |        |       |       |       |       |       |       |      |
| GREQuantPct        | -0.02 | -0.16 | -0.10 | -0.18 | 0.00  | 0.44   | -0.10  | 0.16  | 1.00  |       |       |       |        |       |       |        |       |       |       |       |       |       |      |
| GREAnalyticPct     | 0.05  | -0.06 | 0.03  | 0.08  | 0.08  | -0.37  | -0.08  | 0.60  | -0.20 | 1.00  |       |       |        |       |       |        |       |       |       |       |       |       |      |
| UgradGPA           | -0.02 | -0.29 | 0.07  | -0.13 | -0.02 | 0.02   | 0.00   | 0.06  | 0.12  | 0.05  | 1.00  |       |        |       |       |        |       |       |       |       |       |       |      |
| TOEFL/IELTS        | -0.01 | -0.07 | 0.01  | -0.02 | 0.01  | 0.04   | 0.00   | 0.24  | 0.12  | 0.19  | 0.00  | 1.00  |        |       |       |        |       |       |       |       |       |       |      |
| EliteUSUni         | 0.01  | -0.12 | 0.02  | 0.12  | 0.14  | -0.12  | -0.22  | 0.16  | -0.00 | 0.19  | -0.01 | -0.02 | 1.00   |       |       |        |       |       |       |       |       |       |      |
| EliteUSLA          | -0.02 | -0.02 | 0.04  | 0.04  | 0.04  | -0.08  | -0.09  | 0.12  | -0.01 | 0.13  | -0.02 | -0.00 | -0.11  | 1.00  |       |        |       |       |       |       |       |       |      |
| EliteForeign       | -0.00 | -0.04 | -0.00 | -0.06 | -0.04 | 0.09   | 0.09   | 0.02  | 0.08  | -0.02 | 0.01  | 0.04  | -0.12  | -0.06 | 1.00  |        |       |       |       |       |       |       |      |
| OtherForeign       | -0.02 | 0.20  | -0.04 | -0.23 | -0.14 | 0.34   | 0.39   | -0.26 | 0.20  | -0.39 | 0.02  | 0.02  | -0.43  | -0.21 | -0.22 | 1.00   |       |       |       |       |       |       |      |
| GradDegree         | 0.00  | 0.41  | -0.08 | -0.13 | -0.09 | 0.21   | 0.15   | -0.14 | 0.05  | -0.20 | -0.22 | 0.03  | -0.21  | -0.10 | 0.05  | 0.37   | 1.00  |       |       |       |       |       |      |
| WorkExper          | 0.01  | 0.33  | 0.05  | 0.05  | 0.01  | -0.18  | 0.11   | 0.01  | -0.15 | 0.11  | -0.08 | -0.03 | -0.02  | 0.03  | -0.03 | -0.01  | 0.10  | 1.00  |       |       |       |       |      |
| #ProfRecom         | -0.02 | -0.19 | -0.04 | -0.04 | 0.01  | 0.11   | -0.09  | 0.01  | 0.09  | -0.04 | 0.14  | 0.03  | -0.02  | 0.02  | -0.00 | -0.02  | -0.03 | -0.18 | 1.00  |       |       |       |      |
| #ProlificRecom     | 0.01  | -0.06 | -0.02 | -0.07 | -0.01 | 0.24   | -0.10  | -0.01 | 0.25  | -0.11 | 0.04  | 0.10  | -0.01  | -0.01 | 0.06  | 0.08   | 0.17  | -0.09 | 0.19  | 1.00  |       |       |      |
| MissingGRE         | 0.09  | 0.15  | 0.05  | 0.11  | -0.01 | -0.22  | 0.17   | 0.09  | -0.33 | 0.17  | -0.09 | -0.10 | -0.03  | -0.04 | -0.03 | -0.01  | 0.02  | 0.10  | -0.08 | -0.20 | 1.00  |       |      |
| MissingUgradGPA    | -0.01 | 0.18  | -0.04 | -0.24 | -0.15 | 0.36   | 0.42   | -0.24 | 0.21  | -0.38 | 0.02  | 0.04  | -0.46  | -0.23 | 0.23  | 0.83   | 0.37  | -0.02 | -0.03 | 0.10  | -0.01 | 1.00  |      |
| MissingTOEFL/IELTS | 0.05  | -0.07 | 0.03  | 0.16  | 0.11  | -0.32  | -0.22  | 0.16  | -0.24 | 0.32  | -0.02 | -0.02 | 0.29   | 0.14  | -0.04 | -0.58  | -0.20 | 0.05  | -0.07 | -0.05 | 0.12  | -0.58 | 1.00 |
| Observations       | 6222  |       |       |       |       |        |        |       |       |       |       |       |        |       |       |        |       |       |       |       |       |       |      |

» Reduced-Form Summary

# A3: Logistic Regression Results

Table 4a: Logistic Regression Results

| DV = Accept              | (1)<br>Economics       | (2)<br>Government     | (3)<br>History        | (4)<br>Linguistics   | (5)<br>Psychology     |
|--------------------------|------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|----------------------|-----------------------|
| CovidYear                | -0.3969**<br>(0.2010)  | -0.4332*<br>(0.2612)  | -0.5732*<br>(0.3470)  | -0.5501<br>(0.4129)  | -0.1766<br>(0.5545)   |
| WinsorAge                | -0.0995***<br>(0.0358) | 0.0454*<br>(0.0271)   | 0.0380<br>(0.0327)    | 0.0222<br>(0.0532)   | 0.0320<br>(0.0890)    |
| Female                   | 0.4079**<br>(0.1681)   | 0.6723***<br>(0.2290) | 0.6536**<br>(0.2071)  | 0.1311<br>(0.3452)   | -0.5060<br>(0.5656)   |
| USAirHspIst              | 0.4221<br>(0.5258)     | 1.0061***<br>(0.3545) | 1.9601***<br>(0.4426) | 0.0120<br>(0.8411)   | -0.8263<br>(1.1611)   |
| USAsian                  | -0.5394<br>(0.4199)    | -0.5660<br>(0.6504)   | -0.3260<br>(1.2512)   | 0.8638<br>(0.7201)   | 1.1711<br>(0.7276)    |
| IntAsian                 | -0.8445***<br>(0.2945) | -0.3813<br>(0.4146)   | 0.9405<br>(0.7233)    | 0.4889<br>(0.6729)   | -0.7827<br>(0.9121)   |
| IntOther                 | 0.5034<br>(0.3172)     | 0.3781<br>(0.4131)    | 1.3923***<br>(0.5686) | -0.1061<br>(0.7465)  | 0.6239<br>(1.1095)    |
| GREVerbalPct             | 0.0235***<br>(0.0090)  | 0.0281*<br>(0.0160)   | 0.0753**<br>(0.0344)  | -0.0092<br>(0.0154)  | 0.0607***<br>(0.0218) |
| GREQuantPct              | 0.1547***<br>(0.0186)  | 0.0161*<br>(0.0066)   | 0.0210*<br>(0.0116)   | 0.0211<br>(0.0150)   | -0.0138<br>(0.0199)   |
| GREAnalyticPct           | 0.0179***<br>(0.0042)  | 0.0190**<br>(0.0084)  | 0.0030<br>(0.0134)    | 0.0175<br>(0.0127)   | -0.0202<br>(0.0218)   |
| UgradGPA                 | 2.2212***<br>(0.7219)  | 0.6968<br>(0.5476)    | 1.3648**<br>(0.5613)  | 1.2566<br>(0.6703)   | 1.7772*<br>(0.9467)   |
| TOEFL/IELTS              | 0.3878<br>(0.2883)     | 0.6456<br>(0.4708)    | 1.0663**<br>(0.3526)  | 0.9655*<br>(0.5456)  | -0.4656<br>(0.6112)   |
| EliteUSUni               | 0.8859***<br>(0.2960)  | 0.3943<br>(0.3135)    | -0.6047*<br>(0.3802)  | -0.6057<br>(0.4905)  | 1.4392**<br>(0.6182)  |
| EliteUSLA                | 1.1173***<br>(0.3013)  | 0.6270*<br>(0.3754)   | 1.0668**<br>(0.5396)  | -0.6088<br>(1.4106)  | 2.3151**<br>(1.0642)  |
| EliteForeign             | 1.0051*<br>(0.6080)    | 0.4790<br>(0.8224)    | 1.7711**<br>(0.7938)  | 1.6195*<br>(0.8587)  | 0.3388<br>(1.9889)    |
| OtherForeign             | 0.5442<br>(0.5786)     | 0.5777<br>(0.7940)    | 1.3733**<br>(0.6922)  | 0.4188<br>(0.7157)   | -1.0737<br>(1.3524)   |
| GradDegree               | 0.0467<br>(0.7238)     | 0.0733<br>(0.2583)    | 0.3128<br>(0.3280)    | 0.4049<br>(0.4896)   | 0.4882<br>(0.6399)    |
| WorkExper                | 0.3632**<br>(0.1889)   | 0.4027<br>(0.2943)    | 0.4072<br>(0.3296)    | 0.1495<br>(0.3778)   | 1.8203**<br>(0.8594)  |
| #ProlifRecom             | 0.0340<br>(0.1317)     | -0.0179<br>(0.1139)   | 0.5511**<br>(0.2554)  | 0.4781*<br>(0.2662)  | -0.0981<br>(0.2660)   |
| #ProlifRecom             | 0.2635***<br>(0.0804)  | 0.3025**<br>(0.1262)  | 0.1880<br>(0.1576)    | 0.3029**<br>(0.1544) | 0.5001*<br>(0.3145)   |
| #MathCourses             | 0.1689***<br>(0.0596)  |                       |                       |                      |                       |
| AdvMath                  | 0.2319<br>(0.1790)     |                       |                       |                      |                       |
| MiningGRE                | 0.1899<br>(0.7046)     | -0.3259<br>(0.3300)   | 0.6282<br>(0.4275)    | -0.0831<br>(0.3761)  | -1.1514**<br>(0.5702) |
| MiningUgradGPA           | -0.4746<br>(0.4801)    | -0.4817<br>(0.5440)   | -1.5402**<br>(0.6893) | -1.1201*<br>(0.6481) | 0.4660<br>(1.1811)    |
| MiningTOEFL/IELTS        | -0.3786<br>(0.2432)    | 0.6188<br>(0.5657)    | 0.6745<br>(0.5100)    | -0.0440<br>(0.5099)  | -1.7224*<br>(0.9273)  |
| Concentration FEs        | No                     | Yes                   | No                    | Yes                  | Yes                   |
| Observations             | 2078                   | 2231                  | 660                   | 727                  | 486                   |
| Pseudo R <sup>2</sup>    | 0.2677                 | 0.1525                | 0.1982                | 0.1871               | 0.2475                |
| CV Pseudo R <sup>2</sup> | 0.2102                 | 0.0720                | 0.0604                | -0.0265              | -0.2787               |

Robust standard errors in parentheses. \*p<0.10, \*\*p<0.05, \*\*\*p<0.01.

- **Economics Positive ( $p < .05$ ):**  
Female, GREVerbalPct, GREQuantPct, GREAnalyticPct, UgradGPA, EliteUSUni, EliteUSLA, WorkExper, #ProlifRecom, #MathCourses
- **Economics Negative ( $p < .05$ ):**  
CovidYear, WinsorAge, IntAsian



# A3: Logistic Regression AMEs

Table 4b: Logistic Regression AMEs

| DV = Accept            | (1)<br>Economics       | (2)<br>Government     | (3)<br>History        | (4)<br>Linguistics   | (5)<br>Psychology     | (6)<br>Non-Economics   |
|------------------------|------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|----------------------|-----------------------|------------------------|
| CovidYear              | -0.0303**<br>(0.0153)  | -0.0164<br>(0.0100)   | -0.0431*<br>(0.0261)  | -0.0208<br>(0.0224)  | -0.0075<br>(0.0238)   | -0.0218***<br>(0.0084) |
| WinsorAge              | -0.0076***<br>(0.0027) | 0.0057*<br>(0.0028)   | 0.0028<br>(0.0025)    | 0.0012<br>(0.0029)   | -0.0022<br>(0.0030)   | 0.0016*<br>(0.0060)    |
| Female                 | 0.0312**<br>(0.0129)   | 0.0254***<br>(0.0088) | 0.0490**<br>(0.0220)  | 0.0071<br>(0.0187)   | -0.0216<br>(0.0239)   | 0.0207***<br>(0.0075)  |
| USAFrHisLat            | 0.0323<br>(0.0402)     | 0.0395***<br>(0.0137) | 0.0569***<br>(0.0332) | 0.0007<br>(0.0455)   | -0.0352<br>(0.0487)   | 0.0394***<br>(0.0119)  |
| USAsian                | -0.0413<br>(0.0322)    | -0.0215<br>(0.0247)   | -0.0244<br>(0.0936)   | 0.0468<br>(0.0391)   | 0.0499<br>(0.0313)    | 0.0062<br>(0.0185)     |
| IntAsian               | -0.0648***<br>(0.0224) | -0.0070<br>(0.0157)   | 0.0205<br>(0.0543)    | 0.0265<br>(0.0363)   | 0.0124<br>(0.0303)    | 0.0069<br>(0.0112)     |
| IntOther               | 0.0385<br>(0.0243)     | 0.0143<br>(0.0157)    | 0.1013***<br>(0.0385) | -0.0057<br>(0.0406)  | 0.0266<br>(0.0471)    | 0.0258*<br>(0.0112)    |
| GREVerbalPct           | 0.0012***<br>(0.0005)  | 0.0011*<br>(0.0006)   | 0.0056**<br>(0.0025)  | -0.0005<br>(0.0008)  | 0.0026***<br>(0.0010) | 0.0015***<br>(0.0005)  |
| GREQuantPct            | 0.0118***<br>(0.0014)  | 0.0006*<br>(0.0003)   | 0.0016*<br>(0.0009)   | 0.0011<br>(0.0008)   | -0.0006<br>(0.0007)   | 0.0006**<br>(0.0003)   |
| GREAnalyticPct         | 0.0014***<br>(0.0003)  | 0.0009**<br>(0.0004)  | 0.0002<br>(0.0010)    | 0.0009<br>(0.0007)   | -0.0009<br>(0.0009)   | 0.0001**<br>(0.0003)   |
| UgradGPA               | 0.1699***<br>(0.0551)  | 0.0264<br>(0.0208)    | 0.1022**<br>(0.0423)  | 0.0684<br>(0.0522)   | 0.0757*<br>(0.0418)   | 0.0488***<br>(0.0176)  |
| TOEFL_iELTS            | 0.0207<br>(0.0219)     | 0.0284<br>(0.0179)    | 0.0621**<br>(0.0417)  | 0.0523**<br>(0.0301) | -0.0198<br>(0.0259)   | 0.0526***<br>(0.0123)  |
| EliteUSUni             | 0.0677***<br>(0.0226)  | 0.0149<br>(0.0110)    | 0.0490*<br>(0.0261)   | -0.0328<br>(0.0264)  | 0.0610**<br>(0.0261)  | 0.0233**<br>(0.0096)   |
| EliteUSLA              | 0.0855***<br>(0.0288)  | 0.0238*<br>(0.0143)   | 0.0801**<br>(0.0402)  | -0.0330<br>(0.0761)  | 0.0603**<br>(0.0480)  | 0.0420***<br>(0.0136)  |
| EliteForeign           | 0.0770*<br>(0.0463)    | 0.0180<br>(0.0111)    | 0.1227**<br>(0.0591)  | 0.0877**<br>(0.0481) | 0.0166<br>(0.0865)    | 0.0479**<br>(0.0241)   |
| OtherForeign           | 0.0416<br>(0.0441)     | 0.0219<br>(0.0291)    | 0.1028*<br>(0.0527)   | 0.0227<br>(0.0391)   | -0.0458<br>(0.0556)   | 0.0273<br>(0.0221)     |
| GradDegree             | 0.0036<br>(0.0171)     | 0.0028<br>(0.0048)    | 0.0234<br>(0.0247)    | 0.0219<br>(0.0262)   | 0.0208<br>(0.0273)    | 0.0106<br>(0.0089)     |
| WorkExper              | 0.0301**<br>(0.0144)   | 0.0152<br>(0.0113)    | 0.0372<br>(0.0248)    | 0.0081<br>(0.0205)   | 0.0776**<br>(0.0368)  | 0.0221**<br>(0.0089)   |
| #ProfRecom             | 0.0026<br>(0.0101)     | -0.0007<br>(0.0051)   | 0.0439**<br>(0.0190)  | 0.0259*<br>(0.0142)  | -0.0042<br>(0.0113)   | 0.0063<br>(0.0047)     |
| #ProlificRecom         | 0.0202***<br>(0.0065)  | 0.0114**<br>(0.0048)  | 0.0141<br>(0.0118)    | 0.0178**<br>(0.0082) | 0.0251*<br>(0.0130)   | 0.0533***<br>(0.0038)  |
| #MathCourses           | 0.0126***<br>(0.0045)  |                       |                       |                      |                       |                        |
| AdvMath                | 0.0177<br>(0.0137)     |                       |                       |                      |                       |                        |
| MissingGRE             | 0.0145<br>(0.0585)     | -0.0123<br>(0.0118)   | 0.0470<br>(0.0319)    | -0.0045<br>(0.0204)  | -0.0401*<br>(0.0252)  | -0.0952<br>(0.0088)    |
| MissingUgradGPA        | -0.0363<br>(0.0375)    | -0.0186<br>(0.0208)   | -0.1160**<br>(0.0524) | -0.0601*<br>(0.0355) | 0.0200<br>(0.0505)    | -0.0291<br>(0.0179)    |
| MissingTOEFL_iELTS     | -0.0290<br>(0.0188)    | -0.0234<br>(0.0215)   | -0.0505<br>(0.0388)   | -0.0024<br>(0.0276)  | -0.0719**<br>(0.0417) | -0.0108<br>(0.0135)    |
| Concentration FEs      | No                     | Yes                   | Yes                   | Yes                  | Yes                   | Yes                    |
| Observations           | 2078                   | 2251                  | 690                   | 737                  | 486                   | 4144                   |
| Wald Stat   DF   P-Val | 115.8837               | 23                    | 0.0000                |                      |                       |                        |

Robust standard errors in parentheses: \*p<0.10, \*\*p<0.05, \*\*\*p<0.01.

- **Economics Positive ( $p < .05$ ):**  
Female, GREVerbalPct, GREQuantPct, GREAnalyticPct, UgradGPA, EliteUSUni, EliteUSLA, WorkExper, #ProlificRecom, #MathCourses
- **Economics Negative ( $p < .05$ ):**  
CovidYear, WinsorAge, IntAsian

# A3: Logistic Regression Results (Synthetic)

Table 5a: Logistic Regression Results (Synthetic)

| DV = Accept              | (1)<br>Economics      | (2)<br>Government     | (3)<br>History       | (4)<br>Linguistics     | (5)<br>Psychology      |
|--------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|----------------------|------------------------|------------------------|
| ContYear                 | -0.1967<br>(0.1633)   | -0.0323<br>(0.2215)   | 0.2028<br>(0.3078)   | -0.4701<br>(0.3477)    | -0.5946<br>(0.4520)    |
| WinsorAge                | -0.0509**<br>(0.0201) | -0.0196<br>(0.0174)   | 0.0267**<br>(0.0307) | -0.0164<br>(0.0357)    | -0.0237**<br>(0.0400)  |
| Female                   | 0.1941<br>(0.1402)    | 0.0923<br>(0.2004)    | 0.1389<br>(0.2526)   | 0.2595<br>(0.3255)     | 0.2119<br>(0.4310)     |
| USAFtingNat              | 0.3063<br>(0.3724)    | -0.1457<br>(0.4305)   | -0.2379<br>(0.4670)  | -1.0401<br>(1.0720)    | 0.5413<br>(0.5306)     |
| USAsian                  | 0.5663<br>(0.3642)    | 0.6016<br>(0.4452)    | -0.7934<br>(1.1675)  | -0.4305<br>(0.7036)    | 0.7122<br>(0.8953)     |
| IntAsian                 | -0.1458<br>(0.2169)   | 0.3830<br>(0.2805)    | 0.5780<br>(0.3740)   | -0.4666<br>(0.4275)    | 0.1868<br>(0.6866)     |
| IntOther                 | -0.1251<br>(0.2111)   | 0.1395<br>(0.3846)    | 0.1097<br>(0.3237)   | -0.1602<br>(0.3852)    | -1.0807<br>(0.7563)    |
| GREVerbalPct             | 0.0167***<br>(0.0048) | 0.0247***<br>(0.0117) | 0.0164<br>(0.0127)   | -0.0020<br>(0.0105)    | 0.0132<br>(0.0184)     |
| GREQuantPct              | 0.0233***<br>(0.0060) | -0.0027<br>(0.0851)   | 0.0026<br>(0.0388)   | 0.0304**<br>(0.0137)   | 0.0097<br>(0.0096)     |
| GREAnalyticPct           | 0.0042<br>(0.0031)    | 0.0004<br>(0.0059)    | -0.0073<br>(0.0092)  | -0.0042<br>(0.0101)    | 0.0069<br>(0.0103)     |
| UGradGPA                 | 0.2292<br>(0.4745)    | 0.6327<br>(0.4985)    | 1.3054**<br>(0.5796) | -1.3171**<br>(0.5584)  | -0.1002<br>(0.6152)    |
| TOEFL/IELTS              | -0.4673**<br>(0.2157) | 0.5541<br>(0.4105)    | -0.7948<br>(0.6814)  | 0.2446<br>(0.7408)     | -0.7354<br>(0.8025)    |
| EliteUSUni               | -0.4089*<br>(0.2560)  | -0.2243<br>(0.3258)   | 0.0572<br>(0.3421)   | 0.4764<br>(0.4788)     | 0.5941<br>(0.4782)     |
| EliteUSLA                | 0.2429<br>(0.3049)    | 0.1759<br>(0.4542)    | 0.2358<br>(0.4964)   | 0.4860<br>(0.6511)     | 0.8952<br>(0.7261)     |
| EliteForeign             | -0.1622<br>(0.3025)   | -1.1920<br>(0.7484)   | 0.1404<br>(0.5668)   | 0.4801<br>(0.7841)     | 3.0535***<br>(0.8673)  |
| OtherForeign             | -0.1087<br>(0.1079)   | 0.2043<br>(0.2732)    | 0.2721<br>(0.3381)   | 0.1731<br>(0.5026)     | 0.3023<br>(0.4292)     |
| GradDegree               | -0.0198<br>(0.1624)   | 0.1770<br>(0.2439)    | -0.1601<br>(0.2765)  | -0.8698***<br>(0.3320) | -0.2769<br>(0.3814)    |
| WorkExper                | 0.2525*<br>(0.1441)   | -0.0391<br>(0.2166)   | -0.0736<br>(0.2629)  | -0.2650<br>(0.3417)    | -1.1936**<br>(0.4809)  |
| #PostBac                 | -0.1059<br>(0.0909)   | 0.0911<br>(0.1138)    | -0.1828<br>(0.1473)  | 0.2181<br>(0.1817)     | -0.4623**<br>(0.1956)  |
| #PostBacRecom            | 0.0039<br>(0.0656)    | 0.2188**<br>(0.1108)  | -0.1743<br>(0.1723)  | 0.1873<br>(0.1842)     | 0.1347**<br>(0.2213)   |
| #MathCourses             | 0.0366<br>(0.0421)    |                       |                      |                        |                        |
| AdvMath                  | 0.1961<br>(0.1416)    |                       |                      |                        |                        |
| MissingGRE               | -0.1993<br>(0.4328)   | -0.2029<br>(0.2195)   | -0.0011<br>(0.2689)  | -0.0433<br>(0.3521)    | -0.6940<br>(0.4017)    |
| MissingUGradGPA          | 0.1531<br>(0.1548)    | 0.0895<br>(0.2291)    | -0.2450<br>(0.3025)  | 0.6596**<br>(0.3125)   | -0.3574<br>(0.4342)    |
| MissingTOEFL/IELTS       | -0.2050*<br>(0.1640)  | 0.4898<br>(0.3480)    | 0.5752<br>(0.5466)   | 0.1346<br>(0.5455)     | -2.0781***<br>(0.7653) |
| Concentration FEs        | No                    | Yes                   | Yes                  | Yes                    | Yes                    |
| Observations             | 2078                  | 2231                  | 680                  | 737                    | 486                    |
| Pseudo R <sup>2</sup>    | 0.0524                | 0.0366                | 0.0753               | 0.1046                 | 0.2230                 |
| CV Pseudo R <sup>2</sup> | 0.0139                | -0.0189               | -0.0887              | 0.0005                 | -0.0014                |

Robust standard errors in parentheses: \*p<0.10, \*\*p<0.05, \*\*\*p<0.01.

- **Economics Positive ( $p < .05$ ):**  
GREVerbalPct, GREQuantPct
- **Economics Negative ( $p < .05$ ):**  
WinsorAge, TOEFL/IELTS

# A3: Logistic Regression AMEs (Synthetic)

Table 5b: Logistic Regression AMEs (Synthetic)

| DV = Accept            | (1)<br>Economics       | (2)<br>Government    | (3)<br>History       | (4)<br>Linguistics     | (5)<br>Psychology      | (6)<br>Non-Economics  |
|------------------------|------------------------|----------------------|----------------------|------------------------|------------------------|-----------------------|
| CovidYear              | -0.0204<br>(0.0167)    | -0.0014<br>(0.0090)  | 0.0102<br>(0.0291)   | -0.0208<br>(0.0216)    | -0.0345<br>(0.0262)    | -0.0089<br>(0.0086)   |
| WinsorAge              | -0.0052***<br>(0.0021) | -0.0030<br>(0.0068)  | 0.0054*<br>(0.0029)  | -0.0010<br>(0.0020)    | 0.0070***<br>(0.0023)  | 0.0004<br>(0.0008)    |
| Female                 | 0.0168<br>(0.0143)     | 0.0041<br>(0.0089)   | 0.0131<br>(0.0239)   | 0.0162<br>(0.0204)     | 0.0123<br>(0.0251)     | 0.0099<br>(0.0078)    |
| USAffHspHst            | 0.0312<br>(0.0361)     | -0.0095<br>(0.0192)  | -0.0225<br>(0.0441)  | -0.0101<br>(0.0673)    | 0.0314<br>(0.0306)     | -0.0137<br>(0.0147)   |
| USAsian                | 0.0579<br>(0.0372)     | 0.0288<br>(0.0190)   | -0.0750<br>(0.1101)  | -0.0268<br>(0.0495)    | 0.0413<br>(0.0516)     | 0.0241<br>(0.0179)    |
| IntAsian               | -0.0146<br>(0.0222)    | 0.0073<br>(0.0125)   | 0.0146<br>(0.0353)   | -0.0260<br>(0.0263)    | 0.0075<br>(0.0399)     | 0.0075<br>(0.0112)    |
| IntOther               | -0.0126<br>(0.0236)    | 0.0062<br>(0.0136)   | 0.0104<br>(0.0306)   | -0.0100<br>(0.0237)    | -0.0627<br>(0.0443)    | -0.0014<br>(0.0106)   |
| GREVerbalPct           | 0.0017***<br>(0.0005)  | 0.0011**<br>(0.0005) | 0.0015<br>(0.0012)   | -0.0002<br>(0.0006)    | 0.0008<br>(0.0010)     | -0.0008**<br>(0.0004) |
| GREQuantPct            | 0.0024***<br>(0.0009)  | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)  | 0.0003<br>(0.0008)   | 0.0019**<br>(0.0009)   | 0.0006<br>(0.0006)     | 0.0003<br>(0.0002)    |
| GREAnalyticPct         | 0.0004<br>(0.0003)     | 0.0000<br>(0.0003)   | -0.0007<br>(0.0000)  | -0.0001<br>(0.0006)    | 0.0004<br>(0.0006)     | 0.0000<br>(0.0002)    |
| UgradGPA               | 0.0234<br>(0.0465)     | 0.0282<br>(0.0223)   | 0.1281**<br>(0.0553) | -0.0820**<br>(0.0358)  | -0.0058<br>(0.0357)    | 0.0130<br>(0.0158)    |
| TOEFL/IELTS            | -0.0478***<br>(0.0221) | 0.0229<br>(0.0187)   | -0.0723<br>(0.0645)  | 0.0532<br>(0.0466)     | -0.0427<br>(0.0469)    | 0.0050<br>(0.0187)    |
| EliteUSUni             | -0.0496*<br>(0.0243)   | -0.0100<br>(0.0145)  | 0.0054<br>(0.0247)   | 0.0207<br>(0.0214)     | 0.0229<br>(0.0188)     | 0.0036<br>(0.0179)    |
| EliteUSLA              | 0.0248<br>(0.0312)     | 0.0078<br>(0.0180)   | 0.0223<br>(0.0469)   | 0.0303<br>(0.0602)     | 0.0502<br>(0.0418)     | 0.0217<br>(0.0160)    |
| EliteForeign           | -0.0166<br>(0.0306)    | -0.0512<br>(0.0137)  | 0.0700<br>(0.0337)   | 0.0299<br>(0.0444)     | 0.1771***<br>(0.0401)  | 0.0158<br>(0.0179)    |
| OtherForeign           | -0.0111<br>(0.0202)    | 0.0091<br>(0.0122)   | 0.0257<br>(0.0321)   | 0.0108<br>(0.0267)     | 0.0175<br>(0.0344)     | 0.0116<br>(0.0103)    |
| GradDegree             | -0.0020<br>(0.0166)    | 0.0079<br>(0.0109)   | -0.0151<br>(0.0261)  | -0.0542***<br>(0.0206) | -0.0161<br>(0.0220)    | -0.0093<br>(0.0086)   |
| WorkExper              | 0.0258*<br>(0.0148)    | -0.0017<br>(0.0107)  | -0.0070<br>(0.0248)  | -0.0165<br>(0.0213)    | -0.0692***<br>(0.0275) | -0.0093<br>(0.0086)   |
| #ProfRecm              | -0.0108<br>(0.0001)    | 0.0041<br>(0.0051)   | -0.0173<br>(0.0140)  | 0.0136<br>(0.0114)     | -0.0305***<br>(0.0110) | -0.0027<br>(0.0042)   |
| #ProfRecm              | 0.0004<br>(0.0067)     | 0.0096*<br>(0.0050)  | -0.0165<br>(0.0164)  | 0.0042<br>(0.0102)     | 0.0298**<br>(0.0128)   | 0.0083*<br>(0.0045)   |
| #MathCourses           | 0.0037<br>(0.0043)     |                      |                      |                        |                        |                       |
| AdvMath                | 0.0201<br>(0.0145)     |                      |                      |                        |                        |                       |
| MissingGRE             | -0.0204<br>(0.0443)    | -0.0090<br>(0.0098)  | -0.0001<br>(0.0254)  | -0.0027<br>(0.0218)    | -0.0350<br>(0.0230)    | -0.0098<br>(0.0079)   |
| MissingUgradGPA        | 0.0157<br>(0.0156)     | 0.0040<br>(0.0102)   | -0.0232<br>(0.0285)  | 0.0392**<br>(0.0201)   | -0.0207<br>(0.0254)    | 0.0019<br>(0.0083)    |
| MissingTOEFL/IELTS     | -0.0302*<br>(0.0168)   | 0.0218<br>(0.0156)   | 0.0544<br>(0.0517)   | 0.0094<br>(0.0272)     | -0.1266***<br>(0.0434) | 0.0063<br>(0.0130)    |
| Concentration FEs      | No                     | Yes                  | Yes                  | Yes                    | Yes                    | Yes                   |
| Observations           | 2078                   | 2251                 | 690                  | 737                    | 486                    | 4144                  |
| Wald Stat / DF / P-Val | 37.4769                | 25                   | 0.0290               |                        |                        |                       |

Robust standard errors in parentheses: \*p<0.10, \*\*p<0.05, \*\*\*p<0.01.

• **Economics Positive ( $p < .05$ ):**  
GREVerbalPct, GREQuantPct

• **Economics Negative ( $p < .05$ ):**  
WinsorAge, TOEFL/IELTS

# A3: Lasso Logistic Regression Results

Table 6: Lasso Logistic Regression Results

| DV = Accept              | (1)<br>Economics | (2)<br>Government | (3)<br>History | (4)<br>Linguistics | (5)<br>Psychology |
|--------------------------|------------------|-------------------|----------------|--------------------|-------------------|
| CovidYear                | -0.3330          | -0.3123           | -0.3498        | -0.2378            |                   |
| WinsorAge                | -0.0788          | 0.0266            | 0.0200         |                    |                   |
| Female                   | 0.3352           | 0.5096            | 0.5068         |                    | -0.0654           |
| USAFrHispNat             | 0.2638           | 0.8041            | 0.7157         |                    |                   |
| USAsian                  | -0.2802          | -0.2918           |                | 0.0413             | 0.1155            |
| IntAsian                 | -0.6744          | -0.0726           |                | 0.0465             |                   |
| IntOther                 | 0.4729           | 0.1946            | 0.7240         | -0.1087            |                   |
| GREVerbalPct             | 0.0139           | 0.0252            | 0.0272         |                    | 0.0343            |
| GREQuantPct              | 0.1349           | 0.0119            | 0.0187         | 0.0154             |                   |
| GREAnalyticPct           | 0.0166           | 0.0208            |                | 0.0080             |                   |
| UgradGPA                 | 1.9977           | 0.4621            | 0.7414         | 0.1714             |                   |
| TOEFL/IELTS              | 0.4009           | 0.3295            | 0.5199         | 0.5151             |                   |
| EliteUSUni               | 0.6886           | 0.2709            | 0.3267         |                    | 0.4606            |
| EliteUSLA                | 0.8956           | 0.5199            | 0.5985         |                    | 0.4470            |
| EliteForeign             | 0.3724           |                   | 0.0414         | 0.4343             |                   |
| OtherForeign             |                  |                   |                |                    |                   |
| GradDegree               |                  |                   | 0.0978         |                    |                   |
| WorkExper                | 0.2835           | 0.3447            | 0.3273         |                    | 0.5559            |
| #ProfRecom               |                  |                   | 0.3739         | 0.2322             |                   |
| #ProlificRecom           | 0.2243           | 0.2362            | 0.1651         | 0.2213             | 0.0632            |
| #MathCourses             | 0.1493           |                   |                |                    |                   |
| AdvMath                  | 0.2272           |                   |                |                    |                   |
| MissingGRE               |                  | -0.2304           |                | -0.0527            | -0.5416           |
| MissingUgradGPA          |                  |                   |                |                    |                   |
| MissingTOEFL/IELTS       | -0.2364          | 0.2852            | 0.0796         |                    |                   |
| Concentration FEs        | No               | Yes               | Yes            | Yes                | Yes               |
| Observations             | 2078             | 2231              | 690            | 737                | 486               |
| Pseudo-R <sup>2</sup>    | 0.2642           | 0.1456            | 0.1589         | 0.1486             | 0.1362            |
| CV Pseudo-R <sup>2</sup> | 0.2297           | 0.0912            | 0.0592         | 0.0850             | 0.0537            |

# A3: Full Post-Lasso Logistic Regression Results

Table 7a: Post-Lasso Logistic Regression Results

| DV = Accept              | (1)<br>Economics       | (2)<br>Government     | (3)<br>History        | (4)<br>Linguistics   | (5)<br>Psychology     |
|--------------------------|------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|----------------------|-----------------------|
| CovidYear                | -0.3069***<br>(0.1996) | -0.4101<br>(0.2609)   | -0.5330<br>(0.3435)   | -0.5737<br>(0.3824)  |                       |
| WinsorAge                | -0.0977***<br>(0.0333) | 0.0473*<br>(0.0248)   | 0.0440<br>(0.0325)    |                      |                       |
| Female                   | 0.4106**<br>(0.1670)   | 0.6570***<br>(0.2281) | 0.6797**<br>(0.2932)  |                      | -0.3204<br>(0.4008)   |
| USAFHingNat              | 0.4355<br>(0.5232)     | 0.9687***<br>(0.3521) | 1.1594***<br>(0.4187) |                      |                       |
| USAsian                  | -0.5139<br>(0.4149)    | -0.5533<br>(0.6435)   |                       | 0.6970<br>(0.6006)   | 0.7934<br>(0.6164)    |
| IntAsian                 | -0.7960***<br>(0.2665) | -0.0979<br>(0.3808)   |                       | 0.3796<br>(0.4458)   |                       |
| IntOther                 | 0.5400*<br>(0.2838)    | 0.3749<br>(0.3238)    | 1.1102**<br>(0.4378)  | -0.2936<br>(0.4436)  |                       |
| GREVerbalPct             | 0.0155***<br>(0.0059)  | 0.0335*<br>(0.0180)   | 0.0423**<br>(0.0188)  |                      | 0.0498***<br>(0.0185) |
| GREQuantPct              | 0.1540***<br>(0.0184)  | 0.0156*<br>(0.0091)   | 0.0255**<br>(0.0106)  | 0.0157<br>(0.0120)   |                       |
| GREAnalyticPct           | 0.0177***<br>(0.0041)  | 0.0232**<br>(0.0101)  |                       | 0.0159<br>(0.0121)   |                       |
| UgradGPA                 | 2.2336***<br>(0.4626)  | 0.7028<br>(0.5465)    | 1.3004***<br>(0.5080) | 0.9096<br>(0.9656)   |                       |
| TOEFL/IELTS              | 0.3900<br>(0.2878)     | 0.6701<br>(0.4545)    | 1.0010*<br>(0.5503)   | 0.8655*<br>(0.5186)  |                       |
| EliteUSUni               | 0.8292***<br>(0.2312)  | 0.3801<br>(0.2728)    | 0.5964*<br>(0.3481)   |                      | 0.7688<br>(0.4721)    |
| EliteUSLA                | 1.0523***<br>(0.3373)  | 0.6501*<br>(0.3553)   | 1.0178**<br>(0.5124)  |                      | 1.3415<br>(0.8540)    |
| EliteForeign             | 0.4772*<br>(0.2702)    |                       | 0.5710<br>(0.5770)    | 0.9748<br>(0.5963)   |                       |
| GradDegree               |                        |                       | 0.2774<br>(0.3193)    |                      |                       |
| WorkExper                | 0.3826**<br>(0.1881)   | 0.4139<br>(0.2987)    | 0.5055<br>(0.3290)    |                      | 1.6031**<br>(0.6902)  |
| #ProlfRecom              |                        |                       | 0.5752***<br>(0.2597) | 0.4712*<br>(0.2697)  |                       |
| #ProlfRecom              | 0.2727***<br>(0.0840)  | 0.3028**<br>(0.1220)  | 0.2113<br>(0.1577)    | 0.3359**<br>(0.1456) | 0.4341<br>(0.2885)    |
| #MathCourses             | 0.1715***<br>(0.0593)  |                       |                       |                      |                       |
| AdvMath                  | 0.2350<br>(0.1777)     |                       |                       |                      |                       |
| MissingGRE               | 0.1827<br>(0.7660)     |                       |                       | -0.0900<br>(0.3941)  | -0.8085<br>(0.5569)   |
| MissingTOEFL/IELTS       | -0.3983*<br>(0.2266)   | 0.5313<br>(0.4700)    | 0.5689<br>(0.5289)    |                      |                       |
| Concentration FEs        | No                     | Yes                   | Yes                   | Yes                  | Yes                   |
| Observations             | 2078                   | 2231                  | 690                   | 737                  | 486                   |
| Pseudo-R <sup>2</sup>    | 0.2671                 | 0.1500                | 0.1847                | 0.1722               | 0.1844                |
| CV Pseudo-R <sup>2</sup> | 0.2168                 | 0.0865                | 0.0715                | 0.0104               | 0.0445                |

Robust standard errors in parentheses: \*p<0.10, \*\*p<0.05, \*\*\*p<0.01.

- **Economics Positive ( $p < .05$ ):**  
Female, GREVerbalPct, GREQuantPct, GREAnalyticPct, UgradGPA, EliteUSUni, EliteUSLA, WorkExper, #ProlfRecom, #MathCourses
- **Economics Negative ( $p < .05$ ):**  
CovidYear, WinsorAge, IntAsian

# A3: Full Post-Lasso Logistic Regression AMEs

Table 7b: Post-Lasso Logistic Regression AMEs

| DV = Accept        | (1)<br>Economics       | (2)<br>Government     | (3)<br>History        | (4)<br>Linguistics   | (5)<br>Psychology    |
|--------------------|------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|
| CovidYear          | -0.0303**<br>(0.0152)  | -0.0159<br>(0.0100)   | -0.0404<br>(0.0261)   | -0.0315<br>(0.0212)  |                      |
| WinsorAge          | -0.0075***<br>(0.0025) | 0.0018*<br>(0.0010)   | 0.0033<br>(0.0025)    |                      |                      |
| Female             | 0.0314**<br>(0.0126)   | 0.0240***<br>(0.0087) | 0.0515**<br>(0.0220)  |                      | -0.0144<br>(0.0222)  |
| USAFHispNat        | 0.0333<br>(0.0400)     | 0.0367***<br>(0.0136) | 0.0878***<br>(0.0318) |                      |                      |
| USAsian            | -0.0394<br>(0.0318)    | -0.0210<br>(0.0245)   |                       | 0.0383<br>(0.0382)   | 0.0357<br>(0.0270)   |
| IntAsian           | -0.0610***<br>(0.0203) | -0.0037<br>(0.0144)   |                       | 0.0208<br>(0.0245)   |                      |
| IntOther           | 0.0420*<br>(0.0217)    | 0.0142<br>(0.0123)    | 0.0841**<br>(0.0333)  | -0.0112<br>(0.0245)  |                      |
| GREVerbalPct       | 0.0012***<br>(0.0005)  | 0.0013*<br>(0.0007)   | 0.0035**<br>(0.0015)  |                      | 0.0022**<br>(0.0009) |
| GREQuantPct        | 0.0119***<br>(0.0014)  | 0.0006*<br>(0.0004)   | 0.0019**<br>(0.0008)  | 0.0009<br>(0.0007)   |                      |
| GREAnalyticPct     | 0.0014***<br>(0.0003)  | 0.0009**<br>(0.0004)  |                       | 0.0009<br>(0.0007)   |                      |
| UgradGPA           | 0.1710***<br>(0.0506)  | 0.0267<br>(0.0208)    | 0.0985**<br>(0.0397)  | 0.0499<br>(0.0542)   |                      |
| TOEFL/IELTS        | 0.0290<br>(0.0219)     | 0.0254<br>(0.0173)    | 0.0758*<br>(0.0420)   | 0.0474<br>(0.0290)   |                      |
| EliteUSUni         | 0.0635***<br>(0.0176)  | 0.0144<br>(0.0104)    | 0.0452*<br>(0.0262)   |                      | 0.0346<br>(0.0214)   |
| EliteUSLA          | 0.0806***<br>(0.0255)  | 0.0247*<br>(0.0136)   | 0.0771**<br>(0.0387)  |                      | 0.0604<br>(0.0398)   |
| EliteForeign       | 0.0365*<br>(0.0207)    |                       | 0.0432<br>(0.0434)    | 0.0535<br>(0.0331)   |                      |
| GradDegree         |                        |                       | 0.0210<br>(0.0243)    |                      |                      |
| WorkExper          | 0.0293**<br>(0.0143)   | 0.0157<br>(0.0113)    | 0.0383<br>(0.0250)    | 0.0722**<br>(0.0335) |                      |
| #ProfRecom         |                        |                       | 0.0436**<br>(0.0195)  | 0.0250*<br>(0.0147)  |                      |
| #ProfRecom         | 0.0200***<br>(0.0064)  | 0.0115**<br>(0.0047)  | 0.0160<br>(0.0119)    | 0.0184**<br>(0.0080) | 0.0195<br>(0.0127)   |
| #MathCourses       | 0.0131***<br>(0.0045)  |                       |                       |                      |                      |
| AdvMath            | 0.0180<br>(0.0136)     |                       |                       |                      |                      |
| MissingGRE         | 0.0140<br>(0.0587)     |                       |                       | -0.0050<br>(0.0216)  | -0.0404<br>(0.0253)  |
| MissingTOEFL/IELTS | -0.0305*<br>(0.0175)   | 0.0202<br>(0.0179)    | 0.0431<br>(0.0396)    |                      |                      |
| Concentration FEs  | No                     | Yes                   | Yes                   | Yes                  | Yes                  |
| Observations       | 2078                   | 2231                  | 690                   | 737                  | 486                  |

Robust standard errors in parentheses. \*p<0.10, \*\*p<0.05, \*\*\*p<0.01.

- **Economics Positive ( $p < .05$ ):**  
Female, GREVerbalPct, GREQuantPct, GREAnalyticPct, UgradGPA, EliteUSUni, EliteUSLA, WorkExper, #ProlificRecom, #MathCourses
- **Economics Negative ( $p < .05$ ):**  
CovidYear, WinsorAge, IntAsian

# A3: Elastic-Net Logistic Regression Results

Table 8: Elastic-Net Logistic Regression Results

| DV = Accept              | (1)<br>Economics | (2)<br>Government | (3)<br>History | (4)<br>Linguistics | (5)<br>Psychology |
|--------------------------|------------------|-------------------|----------------|--------------------|-------------------|
| CovidYear                | -0.3323          | -0.3013           | -0.3652        | -0.2642            | -0.0428           |
| WinsorAge                | -0.0786          | 0.0231            | 0.0235         |                    |                   |
| Female                   | 0.3316           | 0.4214            | 0.4373         |                    | -0.2716           |
| USAfrHisNat              | 0.2622           | 0.7009            | 0.6038         |                    | -0.2580           |
| USAsian                  | -0.2741          | -0.4137           | -0.3622        | 0.1731             | 0.4670            |
| IntAsian                 | -0.6634          | -0.1850           | 0.1309         | 0.1086             | -0.2639           |
| IntOther                 | 0.4732           | 0.1832            | 0.5739         | -0.1280            | 0.0824            |
| GREVerbalPct             | 0.0140           | 0.0187            | 0.0188         |                    | 0.0236            |
| GREQuantPct              | 0.1324           | 0.0117            | 0.0166         | 0.0136             |                   |
| GREAnalyticPct           | 0.0165           | 0.0157            | 0.0055         | 0.0089             |                   |
| UgradGPA                 | 1.9971           | 0.5294            | 0.7165         | 0.3104             | 0.3833            |
| TOEFL/IELTS              | 0.4029           | 0.4179            | 0.6717         | 0.5298             |                   |
| EliteUSUni               | 0.6894           | 0.3109            | 0.3740         |                    | 0.5669            |
| EliteUSLA                | 0.8906           | 0.5376            | 0.6277         |                    | 0.7887            |
| EliteForeign             | 0.3738           | 0.0332            | 0.3675         | 0.5020             | 0.3558            |
| OtherForeign             |                  | 0.0233            | 0.1382         |                    |                   |
| GradDegree               |                  | 0.0315            | 0.1873         |                    | 0.1018            |
| WorkExper                | 0.2822           | 0.3230            | 0.3192         |                    | 0.5851            |
| #ProfRecom               |                  | -0.0179           | 0.3250         | 0.2333             |                   |
| #ProlificRecom           | 0.2238           | 0.2164            | 0.1665         | 0.2212             | 0.1970            |
| #MathCourses             | 0.1489           |                   |                |                    |                   |
| AdvMath                  | 0.2309           |                   |                |                    |                   |
| MissingGRE               |                  | -0.3089           | 0.1123         | -0.0864            | -0.5616           |
| MissingUgradGPA          |                  | -0.1040           | -0.1046        |                    |                   |
| MissingTOEFL/IELTS       | -0.2369          | 0.2950            | 0.2603         |                    | -0.1782           |
| Concentration FEs        | No               | Yes               | Yes            | Yes                | Yes               |
| Observations             | 2078             | 2231              | 690            | 737                | 486               |
| Pseudo-R <sup>2</sup>    | 0.2640           | 0.1422            | 0.1626         | 0.1519             | 0.1653            |
| CV Pseudo-R <sup>2</sup> | 0.2297           | 0.0999            | 0.0786         | 0.0859             | 0.0582            |
| $\alpha^*$               | 0.9              | 0.0               | 0.0            | 0.4                | 0.1               |

# A3: Economics Means (Matriculation)

Table 9: Economics Means (Matriculation)

| Mean               | All Observations | Matriculate = 1 |
|--------------------|------------------|-----------------|
| Matriculate        | 0.2814           |                 |
| CovidYear          | 0.1905           | 0.2000          |
| WinsorAge          | 25.0303          | 25.1692         |
| Female             | 0.4848           | 0.4154          |
| International      | 0.6710           | 0.7385          |
| GREVerbalPct       | 84.5065          | 79.7385         |
| GREQuantPct        | 91.9784          | 91.2308         |
| GREAnalyticPct     | 69.1775          | 65.4615         |
| UgradGPA           | 3.7160           | 3.6868          |
| TOEFL/IELTS        | 7.6394           | 7.5953          |
| EliteUgrad         | 0.4892           | 0.4000          |
| GradDegree         | 0.5801           | 0.6308          |
| WorkExper          | 0.6320           | 0.5231          |
| #ProfRecom         | 2.5498           | 2.5846          |
| #ProlificRecom     | 1.2727           | 1.1692          |
| AdvMath            | 0.6753           | 0.5077          |
| MissingUgradGPA    | 0.4892           | 0.5077          |
| MissingTOEFL/IELTS | 0.6537           | 0.6000          |
| Observations       | 231              | 65              |



# A3: Correlation Matrix (Matriculation)

Table 10: Correlation Matrix (Matriculation)

|                    | Covid | Age   | Fem   | USAHN | USAsn | IntAsn | IntOth | GREV  | GREQ  | GREA  | GPA   | T/I   | EUSUni | EUSLA | EFor  | OthFor | Grad  | Work  | Prof  | Pro   | MGRE  | MGPA  | MT/I |
|--------------------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|--------|--------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|--------|-------|-------|--------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|------|
| CovidYear          | 1.00  |       |       |       |       |        |        |       |       |       |       |       |        |       |       |        |       |       |       |       |       |       |      |
| WinsorAge          | 0.01  | 1.00  |       |       |       |        |        |       |       |       |       |       |        |       |       |        |       |       |       |       |       |       |      |
| Female             | 0.02  | -0.13 | 1.00  |       |       |        |        |       |       |       |       |       |        |       |       |        |       |       |       |       |       |       |      |
| USAFrHisNat        | 0.00  | -0.04 | 0.04  | 1.00  |       |        |        |       |       |       |       |       |        |       |       |        |       |       |       |       |       |       |      |
| USAsian            | -0.00 | -0.06 | 0.05  | -0.05 | 1.00  |        |        |       |       |       |       |       |        |       |       |        |       |       |       |       |       |       |      |
| IntAsian           | -0.05 | -0.07 | 0.02  | -0.19 | -0.14 | 1.00   |        |       |       |       |       |       |        |       |       |        |       |       |       |       |       |       |      |
| IntOther           | 0.01  | 0.18  | -0.06 | -0.17 | -0.12 | -0.42  | 1.00   |       |       |       |       |       |        |       |       |        |       |       |       |       |       |       |      |
| GREVerbalPct       | 0.03  | -0.06 | -0.04 | 0.00  | 0.04  | -0.12  | -0.15  | 1.00  |       |       |       |       |        |       |       |        |       |       |       |       |       |       |      |
| GREQuantPct        | -0.02 | -0.16 | -0.10 | -0.18 | 0.00  | 0.44   | -0.10  | 0.16  | 1.00  |       |       |       |        |       |       |        |       |       |       |       |       |       |      |
| GREAnalyticPct     | 0.05  | -0.06 | 0.03  | 0.08  | 0.08  | -0.37  | -0.08  | 0.60  | -0.20 | 1.00  |       |       |        |       |       |        |       |       |       |       |       |       |      |
| UgradGPA           | -0.02 | -0.29 | 0.07  | -0.13 | -0.02 | 0.02   | 0.00   | 0.06  | 0.12  | 0.05  | 1.00  |       |        |       |       |        |       |       |       |       |       |       |      |
| TOEFL/IELTS        | -0.01 | -0.07 | 0.01  | -0.02 | 0.01  | 0.04   | 0.00   | 0.24  | 0.12  | 0.19  | 0.00  | 1.00  |        |       |       |        |       |       |       |       |       |       |      |
| EliteUSUni         | 0.01  | -0.12 | 0.02  | 0.12  | 0.14  | -0.12  | -0.22  | 0.16  | -0.00 | 0.19  | -0.01 | -0.02 | 1.00   |       |       |        |       |       |       |       |       |       |      |
| EliteUSLA          | -0.02 | -0.02 | 0.04  | 0.04  | 0.04  | -0.08  | -0.09  | 0.12  | -0.01 | 0.13  | -0.02 | -0.00 | -0.11  | 1.00  |       |        |       |       |       |       |       |       |      |
| EliteForeign       | -0.00 | -0.04 | -0.00 | -0.06 | -0.04 | 0.09   | 0.09   | 0.02  | 0.08  | -0.02 | 0.01  | 0.04  | -0.12  | -0.06 | 1.00  |        |       |       |       |       |       |       |      |
| OtherForeign       | -0.02 | 0.20  | -0.04 | -0.23 | -0.14 | 0.34   | 0.39   | -0.26 | 0.20  | -0.39 | 0.02  | 0.02  | -0.43  | -0.21 | -0.22 | 1.00   |       |       |       |       |       |       |      |
| GradDegree         | 0.00  | 0.41  | -0.08 | -0.13 | -0.09 | 0.21   | 0.15   | -0.14 | 0.05  | -0.20 | -0.22 | 0.03  | -0.21  | -0.10 | 0.05  | 0.37   | 1.00  |       |       |       |       |       |      |
| WorkExper          | 0.01  | 0.33  | 0.05  | 0.05  | 0.01  | -0.18  | 0.11   | 0.01  | -0.15 | 0.11  | -0.08 | -0.03 | -0.02  | 0.03  | -0.03 | -0.01  | 0.10  | 1.00  |       |       |       |       |      |
| #ProfRecom         | -0.02 | -0.19 | -0.04 | -0.04 | 0.01  | 0.11   | -0.09  | 0.01  | 0.09  | -0.04 | 0.14  | 0.03  | -0.02  | 0.02  | -0.00 | -0.02  | -0.03 | -0.18 | 1.00  |       |       |       |      |
| #ProlificRecom     | 0.01  | -0.06 | -0.02 | -0.07 | -0.01 | 0.24   | -0.10  | -0.01 | 0.25  | -0.11 | 0.04  | 0.10  | -0.01  | -0.01 | 0.06  | 0.08   | 0.17  | -0.09 | 0.19  | 1.00  |       |       |      |
| MissingGRE         | 0.09  | 0.15  | 0.05  | 0.11  | -0.01 | -0.22  | 0.17   | 0.09  | -0.33 | 0.17  | -0.09 | -0.10 | -0.03  | -0.04 | -0.03 | -0.01  | 0.02  | 0.10  | -0.08 | -0.20 | 1.00  |       |      |
| MissingUgradGPA    | -0.01 | 0.18  | -0.04 | -0.24 | -0.15 | 0.36   | 0.42   | -0.24 | 0.21  | -0.38 | 0.02  | 0.04  | -0.46  | -0.23 | 0.23  | 0.83   | 0.37  | -0.02 | -0.03 | 0.10  | -0.01 | 1.00  |      |
| MissingTOEFL/IELTS | 0.05  | -0.07 | 0.03  | 0.16  | 0.11  | -0.32  | -0.22  | 0.16  | -0.24 | 0.32  | -0.02 | -0.02 | 0.29   | 0.14  | -0.04 | -0.58  | -0.20 | 0.05  | -0.07 | -0.05 | 0.12  | -0.58 | 1.00 |
| Observations       | 6222  |       |       |       |       |        |        |       |       |       |       |       |        |       |       |        |       |       |       |       |       |       |      |

# A3: Logistic Regression Results (Matriculation)

Table 11a: Logistic Regression Results (Matriculation)

| Matriculate              | (1)<br>Pre Coefs       | (2)<br>Pre AMEs        | (3)<br>Lasso | (4)<br>Post Coefs      | (5)<br>Post AMEs       |
|--------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|--------------|------------------------|------------------------|
| CovidYear                | 0.1384<br>(0.4306)     | 0.0232<br>(0.0724)     |              |                        |                        |
| WinsorAge                | 0.0261<br>(0.0900)     | 0.0044<br>(0.0152)     |              |                        |                        |
| Female                   | -0.6244*<br>(0.3570)   | -0.1049*<br>(0.0589)   | -0.3914      | -0.6158*<br>(0.3471)   | -0.1037*<br>(0.0573)   |
| International            | 0.7372<br>(0.5175)     | 0.1239<br>(0.0856)     | 0.1687       | 0.6690<br>(0.4693)     | 0.1127<br>(0.0779)     |
| GREVerbalPct             | -0.0224*<br>(0.0130)   | -0.0038*<br>(0.0021)   | -0.0194      | -0.0215*<br>(0.0123)   | -0.0036*<br>(0.0020)   |
| GREQuantPct              | -0.0609*<br>(0.0348)   | -0.0102*<br>(0.0058)   | -0.0425      | -0.0631*<br>(0.0341)   | -0.0106*<br>(0.0056)   |
| GREAnalyticPct           | 0.0034<br>(0.0091)     | 0.0006<br>(0.0015)     |              |                        |                        |
| UgradGPA                 | -4.1670***<br>(1.6083) | -0.7001***<br>(0.2570) | -2.2674      | -4.1144***<br>(1.4501) | -0.6932***<br>(0.2319) |
| TOEFL/IELTS              | -0.3597<br>(0.5858)    | -0.0604<br>(0.0984)    | -0.1628      | -0.2931<br>(0.5263)    | -0.0494<br>(0.0887)    |
| EliteUgrad               | -0.9465*<br>(0.4954)   | -0.1590*<br>(0.0827)   | -0.3943      | -0.9245*<br>(0.4844)   | -0.1558*<br>(0.0816)   |
| GradDegree               | -0.2158<br>(0.4760)    | -0.0363<br>(0.0799)    |              |                        |                        |
| WorkExper                | -0.8483**<br>(0.4006)  | -0.1425**<br>(0.0666)  | -0.6164      | -0.7994**<br>(0.3458)  | -0.1347**<br>(0.0572)  |
| #ProfRecom               | 0.0296<br>(0.2316)     | 0.0050<br>(0.0389)     |              |                        |                        |
| #ProlificRecom           | 0.0268<br>(0.1948)     | 0.0045<br>(0.0328)     |              |                        |                        |
| AdvMath                  | -1.0856***<br>(0.3627) | -0.1824***<br>(0.0574) | -0.8427      | -1.0371***<br>(0.3463) | -0.1747***<br>(0.0548) |
| MissingUgradGPA          | -2.1263***<br>(0.8113) | -0.3573***<br>(0.1304) | -0.9377      | -2.0496***<br>(0.7114) | -0.3453***<br>(0.1135) |
| MissingTOEFL/IELTS       | -0.1722<br>(0.6110)    | -0.0289<br>(0.1026)    |              |                        |                        |
| Observations             | 231                    | 231                    | 231          | 231                    | 231                    |
| Pseudo-R <sup>2</sup>    | 0.1469                 |                        | 0.1288       | 0.1445                 |                        |
| CV Pseudo-R <sup>2</sup> | -0.0928                |                        | 0.0112       | 0.0485                 |                        |

Robust standard errors in parentheses: \*p<0.10, \*\*p<0.05, \*\*\*p<0.01.

- **Positive ( $p < .05$ ):** None
- **Negative ( $p < .05$ ):** UgradGPA, WorkExper, AdvMath, MissingUgradGPA

# A3: Different Determinants: Reject

Table 12a: Wald Test Results (Different)

|                             | DV = Accept            |                       | DV = Success          |                       |
|-----------------------------|------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|
|                             | Economics              | Non-Economics         | Economics             | Non-Economics         |
| GREQuantPct                 | 0.0145***<br>(0.0012)  | 0.0017***<br>(0.0006) | 0.0193***<br>(0.0014) | 0.0006<br>(0.0012)    |
| Gender                      | 0.0454***<br>(0.0140)  | 0.0255***<br>(0.0079) | -0.0251<br>(0.0200)   | 0.0070<br>(0.0161)    |
| Demographic1                | -0.0604***<br>(0.0200) | -0.0109<br>(0.0103)   | -0.0647**<br>(0.0267) | -0.0214<br>(0.0205)   |
| Demographic2                | 0.0150<br>(0.0200)     | 0.0003<br>(0.0091)    | 0.0313<br>(0.0284)    | -0.0105<br>(0.0192)   |
| AdvMath                     | 0.0279*<br>(0.0156)    |                       | 0.0600***<br>(0.0202) |                       |
| ComScore                    | 0.0217***<br>(0.0039)  | 0.0164***<br>(0.0025) | 0.0187***<br>(0.0052) | 0.0336***<br>(0.0041) |
| NonEconomics1               |                        | -0.0019<br>(0.0086)   |                       | 0.2120***<br>(0.0219) |
| Obs   Pseudo-R <sup>2</sup> | 5000                   | 0.1488                | 5000                  | 0.0758                |
| Wald Stat   P-Val           | 112.5897               | 0.0000                | 124.7379              | 0.0000                |

Robust standard errors in parentheses: \*p<0.10, \*\*p<0.05, \*\*\*p<0.01.

# A3: Same Determinants: Don't Reject

Table 12b: Wald Test Results (Same)

|                             | DV = Accept            |                        | DV = Success          |                        |
|-----------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|-----------------------|------------------------|
|                             | Economics              | Non-Economics          | Economics             | Non-Economics          |
| GREQuantPct                 | 0.0146***<br>(0.0012)  | 0.0155***<br>(0.0007)  | 0.0193***<br>(0.0014) | 0.0208***<br>(0.0011)  |
| Gender                      | 0.0455***<br>(0.0140)  | 0.0377***<br>(0.0081)  | -0.0253<br>(0.0200)   | -0.0090<br>(0.0161)    |
| Demographic1                | -0.0607***<br>(0.0200) | -0.0886***<br>(0.0115) | -0.0637**<br>(0.0267) | -0.0556***<br>(0.0202) |
| Demographic2                | 0.0148<br>(0.0200)     | 0.0177*<br>(0.0091)    | 0.0321<br>(0.0284)    | 0.0051<br>(0.0193)     |
| AdvMath                     | 0.0279*<br>(0.0156)    |                        | 0.0597***<br>(0.0202) |                        |
| ComScore                    | 0.0216***<br>(0.0039)  | 0.0191***<br>(0.0023)  | 0.0187***<br>(0.0052) | 0.0137***<br>(0.0041)  |
| NonEconomics1               |                        | 0.0401***<br>(0.0107)  |                       | 0.3515***<br>(0.0205)  |
| Obs   Pseudo-R <sup>2</sup> | 5000                   | 0.3251                 | 5000                  | 0.1431                 |
| Wald Stat   P-Val           | 3.1018                 | 0.6843                 | 3.0042                | 0.6993                 |

Robust standard errors in parentheses: \*p<0.10, \*\*p<0.05, \*\*\*p<0.01.

# A3: Full Wald Test Results (Different)

Table 13a: Wald Test Results (Different)

|                             | DV = Accept             |                        |                        |                        | DV = Success            |                        |                        |                        |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|-------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|
|                             | Economics               |                        | Non-Economics          |                        | Economics               |                        | Non-Economics          |                        |
|                             | Coef                    | AME                    | Coef                   | AME                    | Coef                    | AME                    | Coef                   | AME                    |
| Intercept                   | -16.3291***<br>(1.1274) | -1.5784***<br>(0.0955) | -8.4753***<br>(0.8673) | -0.3642***<br>(0.0412) | -10.4581***<br>(0.7237) | -1.9104***<br>(0.1070) | -3.2236***<br>(0.4018) | -0.5997***<br>(0.0728) |
| GREQuantPct                 | 0.1502***<br>(0.0131)   | 0.0145***<br>(0.0012)  | 0.0402***<br>(0.0128)  | 0.0017***<br>(0.0006)  | 0.1058***<br>(0.0088)   | 0.0193***<br>(0.0014)  | 0.0034<br>(0.0062)     | 0.0006<br>(0.0012)     |
| Gender                      | 0.4702***<br>(0.1473)   | 0.0454***<br>(0.0140)  | 0.5942***<br>(0.1820)  | 0.0255***<br>(0.0079)  | -0.1372<br>(0.1095)     | -0.0251<br>(0.0200)    | 0.0375<br>(0.0868)     | 0.0070<br>(0.0161)     |
| Demographic1                | -0.6246***<br>(0.2085)  | -0.0604***<br>(0.0200) | -0.2541<br>(0.2393)    | -0.0109<br>(0.0103)    | -0.3544**<br>(0.1467)   | -0.0647**<br>(0.0267)  | -0.1152<br>(0.1103)    | -0.0214<br>(0.0205)    |
| Demographic2                | 0.1555<br>(0.2070)      | 0.0150<br>(0.0200)     | 0.0081<br>(0.2109)     | 0.0003<br>(0.0091)     | 0.1713<br>(0.1557)      | 0.0313<br>(0.0284)     | -0.0562<br>(0.1030)    | -0.0105<br>(0.0192)    |
| AdvMath                     | 0.2886*<br>(0.1611)     | 0.0279*<br>(0.0156)    |                        |                        | 0.3284***<br>(0.1112)   | 0.0600***<br>(0.0202)  |                        |                        |
| ComScore                    | 0.2241***<br>(0.0413)   | 0.0217***<br>(0.0039)  | 0.3817***<br>(0.0528)  | 0.0164***<br>(0.0025)  | 0.1026***<br>(0.0287)   | 0.0187***<br>(0.0052)  | 0.1808***<br>(0.0228)  | 0.0336***<br>(0.0041)  |
| NonEconomics1               |                         |                        | -0.0452<br>(0.1995)    | -0.0019<br>(0.0086)    |                         |                        | 1.1393***<br>(0.1219)  | 0.2120***<br>(0.0219)  |
| Obs   Pseudo-R <sup>2</sup> | 5000                    | 0.1488                 |                        |                        | 5000                    | 0.0758                 |                        |                        |
| LL   Param   AIC            | -1155.7                 | 14                     | 2339.5                 |                        | -2747.2                 | 14                     | 5522.4                 |                        |
| Wald Stat   DF   P-Val      | 112.5897                | 5                      | 0.0000                 |                        | 124.7379                | 5                      | 0.0000                 |                        |

Robust standard errors in parentheses: \*p<0.10, \*\*p<0.05, \*\*\*p<0.01.

# A3: Full Wald Test Results (Same)

Table 13b: Wald Test Results (Same)

|                             | DV = Accept             |                        |                         |                        | DV = Success            |                        |                         |                        |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------|------------------------|-------------------------|------------------------|-------------------------|------------------------|-------------------------|------------------------|
|                             | Economics               |                        | Non-Economics           |                        | Economics               |                        | Non-Economics           |                        |
|                             | Coef                    | AME                    | Coef                    | AME                    | Coef                    | AME                    | Coef                    | AME                    |
| Intercept                   | -16.3848***<br>(1.1315) | -1.5822***<br>(0.0956) | -28.5524***<br>(1.4963) | -1.3677***<br>(0.0500) | -10.4586***<br>(0.7236) | -1.9105***<br>(0.1070) | -10.2610***<br>(0.4815) | -1.8514***<br>(0.0628) |
| GREQuantPct                 | 0.1509***<br>(0.0131)   | 0.0146***<br>(0.0012)  | 0.3245***<br>(0.0179)   | 0.0155***<br>(0.0007)  | 0.1058***<br>(0.0088)   | 0.0193***<br>(0.0014)  | 0.1154***<br>(0.0070)   | 0.0208***<br>(0.0011)  |
| Gender                      | 0.4714***<br>(0.1475)   | 0.0455***<br>(0.0140)  | 0.7880***<br>(0.1696)   | 0.0377***<br>(0.0081)  | -0.1384<br>(0.1095)     | -0.0253<br>(0.0200)    | -0.0497<br>(0.0895)     | -0.0090<br>(0.0161)    |
| Demographic1                | -0.6287***<br>(0.2088)  | -0.0607***<br>(0.0200) | -1.8488***<br>(0.2445)  | -0.0886***<br>(0.0115) | -0.3486**<br>(0.1467)   | -0.0637**<br>(0.0267)  | -0.3079***<br>(0.1123)  | -0.0556***<br>(0.0202) |
| Demographic2                | 0.1531<br>(0.2072)      | 0.0148<br>(0.0200)     | 0.3703*<br>(0.1929)     | 0.0177*<br>(0.0091)    | 0.1756<br>(0.1558)      | 0.0321<br>(0.0284)     | 0.0282<br>(0.1069)      | 0.0051<br>(0.0193)     |
| AdvMath                     | 0.2889*<br>(0.1612)     | 0.0279*<br>(0.0156)    |                         |                        | 0.3267***<br>(0.1112)   | 0.0597***<br>(0.0202)  |                         |                        |
| ComScore                    | 0.2241***<br>(0.0413)   | 0.0216***<br>(0.0039)  | 0.3994***<br>(0.0506)   | 0.0191***<br>(0.0023)  | 0.1026***<br>(0.0287)   | 0.0187***<br>(0.0052)  | 0.0757***<br>(0.0228)   | 0.0137***<br>(0.0041)  |
| NonEconomics1               |                         |                        | 0.8376***<br>(0.2297)   | 0.0401***<br>(0.0107)  |                         |                        | 1.9483***<br>(0.1236)   | 0.3515***<br>(0.0205)  |
| Obs   Pseudo-R <sup>2</sup> | 5000                    | 0.3251                 |                         |                        | 5000                    | 0.1431                 |                         |                        |
| LL   Param   AIC            | -1130.4                 | 14                     | 2288.8                  |                        | -2691.4                 | 14                     | 5410.8                  |                        |
| Wald Stat   DF   P-Val      | 3.1018                  | 5                      | 0.6843                  |                        | 3.0042                  | 5                      | 0.6993                  |                        |

Robust standard errors in parentheses: \*p<0.10, \*\*p<0.05, \*\*\*p<0.01.

# A3: Wald Test Summary Statistics (Different)

Table 14a: Wald Test Summary Statistics (Different)

|              | Economics |        | Non-Economics 1 |        | Non-Economics 2 |        |
|--------------|-----------|--------|-----------------|--------|-----------------|--------|
|              | Mean      | SD     | Mean            | SD     | Mean            | SD     |
| Accept       | 0.1335    | 0.3401 | 0.0452          | 0.2078 | 0.0543          | 0.2266 |
| Success      | 0.3000    | 0.4583 | 0.3126          | 0.4636 | 0.1314          | 0.3379 |
| GREQuantPct  | 84.8390   | 7.5405 | 65.1343         | 7.4495 | 65.6114         | 7.6706 |
| Gender       | 0.3935    | 0.4885 | 0.3952          | 0.4889 | 0.5914          | 0.4916 |
| Demographic1 | 0.5005    | 0.5000 | 0.3091          | 0.4621 | 0.2600          | 0.4386 |
| Demographic2 | 0.2505    | 0.4333 | 0.2957          | 0.4563 | 0.3414          | 0.4742 |
| AdvMath      | 0.5095    | 0.4999 |                 |        |                 |        |
| ComScore     | 4.9325    | 1.9877 | 6.0191          | 2.0205 | 6.0243          | 2.0038 |
| Observations | 2000      |        | 2300            |        | 700             |        |

## A3: Wald Test Summary Statistics (Same)

Table 14b: Wald Test Summary Statistics (Same)

|              | Economics |        | Non-Economics 1 |        | Non-Economics 2 |        |
|--------------|-----------|--------|-----------------|--------|-----------------|--------|
|              | Mean      | SD     | Mean            | SD     | Mean            | SD     |
| Accept       | 0.1335    | 0.3401 | 0.0900          | 0.2862 | 0.0786          | 0.2691 |
| Success      | 0.3000    | 0.4583 | 0.4057          | 0.4910 | 0.1157          | 0.3199 |
| GREQuantPct  | 84.8390   | 7.5405 | 65.1343         | 7.4495 | 65.6114         | 7.6706 |
| Gender       | 0.3935    | 0.4885 | 0.3952          | 0.4889 | 0.5914          | 0.4916 |
| Demographic1 | 0.5005    | 0.5000 | 0.3091          | 0.4621 | 0.2600          | 0.4386 |
| Demographic2 | 0.2505    | 0.4333 | 0.2957          | 0.4563 | 0.3414          | 0.4742 |
| AdvMath      | 0.5095    | 0.4999 |                 |        |                 |        |
| ComScore     | 4.9325    | 1.9877 | 6.0191          | 2.0205 | 6.0243          | 2.0038 |
| Observations | 2000      |        | 2300            |        | 700             |        |



## A3: Wald Test Correlation Matrix (Different)

Table 15a: Wald Test Correlation Matrix (Different)

|               | Acc     | Suc     | GRE     | Gen     | Dem1    | Dem2    | Com    | NEcon1  | NEcon2 |
|---------------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|--------|---------|--------|
| Accept        | 1       |         |         |         |         |         |        |         |        |
| Success       | 0.0885  | 1       |         |         |         |         |        |         |        |
| GREQuantPct   | 0.2376  | 0.1167  | 1       |         |         |         |        |         |        |
| Gender        | 0.0582  | -0.0220 | -0.0795 | 1       |         |         |        |         |        |
| Demographic1  | 0.0152  | -0.0004 | 0.3377  | -0.0136 | 1       |         |        |         |        |
| Demographic2  | 0.0078  | 0.0003  | -0.0876 | -0.0209 | -0.4918 | 1       |        |         |        |
| ComScore      | 0.1437  | 0.1500  | -0.0770 | 0.0980  | -0.1567 | -0.0359 | 1      |         |        |
| NonEconomics1 | -0.1232 | 0.0624  | -0.6017 | -0.0501 | -0.1326 | 0.0238  | 0.1930 | 1       |        |
| NonEconomics2 | -0.0405 | -0.1352 | -0.2472 | 0.1384  | -0.0988 | 0.0514  | 0.0854 | -0.3724 | 1      |
| Observations  | 5000    |         |         |         |         |         |        |         |        |

## A3: Wald Test Correlation Matrix (Same)

Table 15b: Wald Test Correlation Matrix (Same)

|               | Acc     | Suc     | GRE     | Gen     | Dem1    | Dem2    | Com    | NEcon1  | NEcon2 |
|---------------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|--------|---------|--------|
| Accept        | 1       |         |         |         |         |         |        |         |        |
| Success       | 0.1603  | 1       |         |         |         |         |        |         |        |
| GREQuantPct   | 0.2772  | 0.1665  | 1       |         |         |         |        |         |        |
| Gender        | 0.0484  | -0.0581 | -0.0795 | 1       |         |         |        |         |        |
| Demographic1  | -0.0233 | 0.0199  | 0.3377  | -0.0136 | 1       |         |        |         |        |
| Demographic2  | 0.0487  | 0.0148  | -0.0876 | -0.0209 | -0.4918 | 1       |        |         |        |
| ComScore      | 0.2045  | 0.1486  | -0.0770 | 0.0980  | -0.1567 | -0.0359 | 1      |         |        |
| NonEconomics1 | -0.0474 | 0.1636  | -0.6017 | -0.0501 | -0.1326 | 0.0238  | 0.1930 | 1       |        |
| NonEconomics2 | -0.0357 | -0.1787 | -0.2472 | 0.1384  | -0.0988 | 0.0514  | 0.0854 | -0.3724 | 1      |
| Observations  | 5000    |         |         |         |         |         |        |         |        |

## A4: Simulated Summary Statistics (Suboptimal)

Table 16a: Simulated Summary Statistics (Suboptimal)

|               | Mean    | SD     |
|---------------|---------|--------|
| Transition    | 0.3910  | 0.4880 |
| Accept        | 0.1350  | 0.3417 |
| Success       | 0.3040  | 0.4600 |
| GREQuantPct   | 84.9310 | 7.5286 |
| Gender        | 0.3970  | 0.4893 |
| Demographic1  | 0.5410  | 0.4983 |
| Demographic2  | 0.2600  | 0.4386 |
| AdvMath       | 0.5300  | 0.4991 |
| ComScore      | 5.1470  | 2.0277 |
| YearTransMore | 0.5000  | 0.5000 |
| Observations  | 1000    |        |

## A4: Simulated Summary Statistics (Optimal)

Table 16b: Simulated Summary Statistics (Optimal)

|               | Mean    | SD     |
|---------------|---------|--------|
| Transition    | 0.3940  | 0.4886 |
| Accept        | 0.1400  | 0.3470 |
| Success       | 0.3040  | 0.4600 |
| GREQuantPct   | 84.9310 | 7.5286 |
| Gender        | 0.3970  | 0.4893 |
| Demographic1  | 0.5410  | 0.4983 |
| Demographic2  | 0.2600  | 0.4386 |
| AdvMath       | 0.5300  | 0.4991 |
| ComScore      | 5.1470  | 2.0277 |
| YearTransMore | 0.5000  | 0.5000 |
| Observations  | 1000    |        |

# A4: Simulated Correlation Matrix (Suboptimal)

Table 17a: Simulated Correlation Matrix (Suboptimal)

|               | Trans   | Acc     | Suc     | GRE     | Fem     | Asn     | Oth     | Math   | Com    | Year |
|---------------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|--------|--------|------|
| Transition    | 1       |         |         |         |         |         |         |        |        |      |
| Accept        | 0.4930  | 1       |         |         |         |         |         |        |        |      |
| Success       | 0.1164  | 0.0379  | 1       |         |         |         |         |        |        |      |
| GREQuantPct   | 0.2550  | 0.2081  | 0.3225  | 1       |         |         |         |        |        |      |
| Gender        | 0.0200  | 0.0503  | -0.0164 | -0.0398 | 1       |         |         |        |        |      |
| Demographic1  | -0.0351 | -0.0472 | 0.0023  | 0.2688  | -0.0032 | 1       |         |        |        |      |
| Demographic2  | 0.0670  | 0.0394  | 0.0642  | -0.0579 | -0.0476 | -0.6435 | 1       |        |        |      |
| AdvMath       | 0.0894  | 0.1140  | 0.1868  | 0.2799  | -0.0181 | 0.1941  | -0.0996 | 1      |        |      |
| ComScore      | 0.0915  | 0.1662  | 0.1204  | 0.2029  | 0.0783  | -0.0827 | -0.0396 | 0.2372 | 1      |      |
| YearTransMore | 0.1865  | -0.0497 | 0.0217  | -0.0410 | -0.0225 | -0.0341 | 0.0593  | 0.0521 | 0.0192 | 1    |
| Observations  | 1000    |         |         |         |         |         |         |        |        |      |

# A4: Simulated Correlation Matrix (Optimal)

Table 17b: Simulated Correlation Matrix (Optimal)

|               | Trans   | Acc     | Suc     | GRE     | Fem     | Asn     | Oth     | Math   | Com    | Year |
|---------------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|--------|--------|------|
| Transition    | 1       |         |         |         |         |         |         |        |        |      |
| Accept        | 0.5004  | 1       |         |         |         |         |         |        |        |      |
| Success       | 0.1300  | 0.0905  | 1       |         |         |         |         |        |        |      |
| GREQuantPct   | 0.2876  | 0.3038  | 0.3225  | 1       |         |         |         |        |        |      |
| Gender        | -0.0185 | 0.0084  | -0.0164 | -0.0398 | 1       |         |         |        |        |      |
| Demographic1  | -0.0006 | 0.0189  | 0.0023  | 0.2688  | -0.0032 | 1       |         |        |        |      |
| Demographic2  | 0.0493  | 0.0105  | 0.0642  | -0.0579 | -0.0476 | -0.6435 | 1       |        |        |      |
| AdvMath       | 0.0991  | 0.1605  | 0.1868  | 0.2799  | -0.0181 | 0.1941  | -0.0996 | 1      |        |      |
| ComScore      | 0.0980  | 0.1271  | 0.1204  | 0.2029  | 0.0783  | -0.0827 | -0.0396 | 0.2372 | 1      |      |
| YearTransMore | 0.1678  | -0.0692 | 0.0217  | -0.0410 | -0.0225 | -0.0341 | 0.0593  | 0.0521 | 0.0192 | 1    |
| Observations  | 1000    |         |         |         |         |         |         |        |        |      |

# A4: Full Year-Dynamic Unrestricted Estimates (Suboptimal)

Table 18a: Year-Dynamic Unrestricted Estimates (Suboptimal)

|                             | FAdvMath               |                        | FComScore              | Transition             |                        | Accept                 |                        | Success                |                        |
|-----------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|
|                             | Coef                   | AME                    |                        | Coef                   | AME                    | Coef                   | AME                    | Coef                   | AME                    |
| Intercept                   | -6.1586***<br>(0.8297) | -1.3913***<br>(0.1654) | 0.5480<br>(0.7283)     | -8.6113***<br>(0.9390) | -1.8072***<br>(0.1610) | -4.6409***<br>(1.6387) | -0.8906***<br>(0.2989) | -8.4142***<br>(1.7756) | -1.7374***<br>(0.3129) |
| GREQuantPct                 | 0.0710***<br>(0.0099)  | 0.0160***<br>(0.0020)  | 0.0581***<br>(0.0088)  | 0.0923***<br>(0.0110)  | 0.0194***<br>(0.0020)  | 0.0386**<br>(0.0191)   | 0.0074**<br>(0.0036)   | 0.0846***<br>(0.0211)  | 0.0175***<br>(0.0039)  |
| Gender                      | -0.0381<br>(0.1363)    | -0.0086<br>(0.0308)    | 0.3310***<br>(0.1204)  | 0.1796<br>(0.1418)     | 0.0377<br>(0.0297)     | 0.3556<br>(0.2307)     | 0.0682<br>(0.0441)     | -0.0468<br>(0.2303)    | -0.0097<br>(0.0475)    |
| Demographic1                | 0.5198***<br>(0.1800)  | 0.1174***<br>(0.0400)  | -1.2830***<br>(0.1529) | -0.4878**<br>(0.1990)  | -0.1024**<br>(0.0412)  | -0.5489<br>(0.3363)    | -0.1053*<br>(0.0638)   | -0.2506<br>(0.3422)    | -0.0517<br>(0.0700)    |
| Demographic2                | -0.0415<br>(0.2000)    | -0.0094<br>(0.0452)    | -0.9475***<br>(0.1759) | 0.0313<br>(0.2102)     | 0.0066<br>(0.0441)     | -0.0869<br>(0.3517)    | -0.0167<br>(0.0675)    | 0.5529*<br>(0.3207)    | 0.1142*<br>(0.0659)    |
| AdvMath                     |                        |                        | 0.8895***<br>(0.1239)  |                        |                        | 0.4169<br>(0.2549)     | 0.0800*<br>(0.0482)    | 0.6588***<br>(0.2507)  | 0.1360***<br>(0.0504)  |
| ComScore                    |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        | 0.2201***<br>(0.0666)  | 0.0422***<br>(0.0120)  | 0.0048<br>(0.0584)     | 0.0010<br>(0.0121)     |
| YearTransMore               |                        |                        |                        | 0.8992***<br>(0.1418)  | 0.1887***<br>(0.0273)  | -1.1992***<br>(0.2380) | -0.2301***<br>(0.0398) |                        |                        |
| $\sqrt{\text{MeanSqError}}$ |                        |                        | 1.8844***<br>(0.0398)  |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |
| Obs   Pseudo-R <sup>2</sup> | 1000                   | 0.0596                 |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |
| LL   Param   AIC            | -3758.1                | 33                     | 7582.1                 |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |

Robust standard errors in parentheses: \*p<0.10, \*\*p<0.05, \*\*\*p<0.01.

# A4: Full Year-Dynamic Unrestricted Estimates (Optimal)

Table 18b: Year-Dynamic Unrestricted Estimates (Optimal)

|                             | FAdvMath               |                        | FComScore              | Transition             |                        | Accept                 |                        | Success                |                        |
|-----------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|
|                             | Coef                   | AME                    |                        | Coef                   | AME                    | Coef                   | AME                    | Coef                   | AME                    |
| Intercept                   | -6.1391***<br>(0.8288) | -1.3875***<br>(0.1654) | 0.5474<br>(0.7284)     | -9.2064***<br>(0.9500) | -1.9245***<br>(0.1576) | -8.8857***<br>(1.7825) | -1.6359***<br>(0.2813) | -8.7036***<br>(1.8073) | -1.8098***<br>(0.3173) |
| GREQuantPct                 | 0.0708***<br>(0.0099)  | 0.0160***<br>(0.0020)  | 0.0581***<br>(0.0088)  | 0.0998***<br>(0.0112)  | 0.0209***<br>(0.0019)  | 0.0937***<br>(0.0204)  | 0.0173***<br>(0.0033)  | 0.0879***<br>(0.0213)  | 0.0183***<br>(0.0039)  |
| Gender                      | -0.0384<br>(0.1363)    | -0.0087<br>(0.0308)    | 0.3312***<br>(0.1204)  | 0.0009<br>(0.1424)     | 0.0002<br>(0.0298)     | 0.1963<br>(0.2429)     | 0.0361<br>(0.0448)     | -0.0426<br>(0.2313)    | -0.0089<br>(0.0481)    |
| Demographic1                | 0.5189***<br>(0.1800)  | 0.1173***<br>(0.0400)  | -1.2807***<br>(0.1529) | -0.3536*<br>(0.2007)   | -0.0739*<br>(0.0416)   | -0.4632<br>(0.3599)    | -0.0853<br>(0.0659)    | -0.3130<br>(0.3443)    | -0.0651<br>(0.0707)    |
| Demographic2                | -0.0429<br>(0.1999)    | -0.0097<br>(0.0452)    | -0.9447***<br>(0.1759) | 0.0434<br>(0.2140)     | 0.0091<br>(0.0447)     | -0.1716<br>(0.3749)    | -0.0316<br>(0.0691)    | 0.5339<br>(0.3263)     | 0.1110<br>(0.0676)     |
| AdvMath                     |                        |                        | 0.8894***<br>(0.1239)  |                        |                        | 0.7280***<br>(0.2611)  | 0.1340***<br>(0.0463)  | 0.5854**<br>(0.2519)   | 0.1217**<br>(0.0512)   |
| ComScore                    |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        | 0.0908<br>(0.0623)     | 0.0167<br>(0.0113)     | 0.0227<br>(0.0574)     | 0.0047<br>(0.0119)     |
| YearTransMore               |                        |                        |                        | 0.8263***<br>(0.1421)  | 0.1727***<br>(0.0276)  | -1.2645***<br>(0.2443) | -0.2328***<br>(0.0379) |                        |                        |
| $\sqrt{\text{MeanSqError}}$ |                        |                        | 1.8844***<br>(0.0398)  |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |
| Obs   Pseudo-R <sup>2</sup> | 1000                   | 0.0628                 |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |
| LL   Param   AIC            | -3753.7                | 33                     | 7573.4                 |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |

Robust standard errors in parentheses: \*p<0.10, \*\*p<0.05, \*\*\*p<0.01.



# A4: Full Year-Static Restricted Estimates (Suboptimal)

Table 19a: Year-Static Restricted Estimates (Suboptimal)

|                      | Cutoff1                | $P(\text{Cutoff})_1$       | Cutoff2               | $P(\text{Cutoff})_2$       | Success1                | Success2               | Sigma                 |
|----------------------|------------------------|----------------------------|-----------------------|----------------------------|-------------------------|------------------------|-----------------------|
| Intercept            | 0.1539<br>(0.2749)     | 53.84%<br>(40.49%, 66.66%) | -0.5306**<br>(0.2154) | 37.04%<br>(27.83%, 47.29%) | -10.3327***<br>(1.9333) | -7.2584***<br>(2.2514) |                       |
| GREQuantPct          |                        |                            |                       |                            | 0.1123***<br>(0.0227)   | 0.0663**<br>(0.0260)   |                       |
| Gender               |                        |                            |                       |                            | 0.1010<br>(0.1144)      | 0.0839<br>(0.1650)     |                       |
| Demographic1         |                        |                            |                       |                            | -0.4233**<br>(0.1783)   | -0.3725<br>(0.2547)    |                       |
| Demographic2         |                        |                            |                       |                            | 0.1588<br>(0.1773)      | 0.2935<br>(0.2525)     |                       |
| AdvMath              |                        |                            |                       |                            |                         | 0.5525***<br>(0.1957)  |                       |
| ComScore             |                        |                            |                       |                            |                         | 0.1161***<br>(0.0447)  |                       |
| YearTransMore        | -0.9253***<br>(0.2622) | 31.62%<br>(26.62%, 37.07%) | 1.2103***<br>(0.4178) | 66.37%<br>(47.08%, 81.40%) |                         |                        |                       |
| Sigma                |                        |                            |                       |                            |                         |                        | 0.2473***<br>(0.0680) |
| Observations         | 1000                   |                            |                       |                            |                         |                        |                       |
| LL   Param   AIC     | -1625.8                | 17                         | 3285.6                |                            |                         |                        |                       |
| LR Stat   DF   P-Val | 19.2965                | 9                          | 0.0228                |                            |                         |                        |                       |

Robust standard errors in parentheses: \* $p < 0.10$ , \*\* $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\* $p < 0.01$ . Confidence intervals are 95%.

# A4: Full Year-Static Restricted Estimates (Optimal)

Table 19b: Year-Static Restricted Estimates (Optimal)

|                      | Cutoff1                | $P(\text{Cutoff})_1$       | Cutoff2                | $P(\text{Cutoff})_2$       | Success1                | Success2               | Sigma                 |
|----------------------|------------------------|----------------------------|------------------------|----------------------------|-------------------------|------------------------|-----------------------|
| Intercept            | -0.0094<br>(0.2357)    | 49.77%<br>(38.43%, 61.13%) | -0.5492***<br>(0.1882) | 36.60%<br>(28.53%, 45.50%) | -10.0587***<br>(2.2082) | -8.9338***<br>(2.4363) |                       |
| GREQuantPct          |                        |                            |                        |                            | 0.1090***<br>(0.0259)   | 0.0882***<br>(0.0275)  |                       |
| Gender               |                        |                            |                        |                            | 0.0070<br>(0.1080)      | 0.0220<br>(0.1620)     |                       |
| Demographic1         |                        |                            |                        |                            | -0.3346*<br>(0.1803)    | -0.2945<br>(0.2626)    |                       |
| Demographic2         |                        |                            |                        |                            | 0.1444<br>(0.1702)      | 0.2881<br>(0.2608)     |                       |
| AdvMath              |                        |                            |                        |                            |                         | 0.6055***<br>(0.1854)  |                       |
| ComScore             |                        |                            |                        |                            |                         | 0.0657<br>(0.0419)     |                       |
| YearTransMore        | -0.7509***<br>(0.2200) | 31.86%<br>(27.27%, 36.83%) | 1.1488***<br>(0.3847)  | 64.56%<br>(47.28%, 78.72%) |                         |                        |                       |
| Sigma                |                        |                            |                        |                            |                         |                        | 0.2149***<br>(0.0597) |
| Observations         | 1000                   |                            |                        |                            |                         |                        |                       |
| LL   Param   AIC     | -1615.9                | 17                         | 3265.9                 |                            |                         |                        |                       |
| LR Stat   DF   P-Val | 8.4729                 | 9                          | 0.4873                 |                            |                         |                        |                       |

Robust standard errors in parentheses: \* $p < 0.10$ , \*\* $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\* $p < 0.01$ . Confidence intervals are 95%.

# A4: Year-Static Unrestricted Estimates (Suboptimal)

Table 20a: Year-Static Unrestricted Estimates (Suboptimal)

|                             | Transition             |                        | Accept                 |                        | Success1                |                        | Success2               |                        |
|-----------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|-------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|
|                             | Coef                   | AME                    | Coef                   | AME                    | Coef                    | AME                    | Coef                   | AME                    |
| Intercept                   | -8.5777***<br>(0.9369) | -1.8014***<br>(0.1610) | -4.7849***<br>(1.6496) | -0.9157***<br>(0.2990) | -10.5425***<br>(1.0566) | -1.9666***<br>(0.1529) | -8.3580***<br>(1.7683) | -1.7285***<br>(0.3127) |
| GREQuantPct                 | 0.0919***<br>(0.0110)  | 0.0193***<br>(0.0020)  | 0.0401**<br>(0.0193)   | 0.0077**<br>(0.0036)   | 0.1140***<br>(0.0125)   | 0.0213***<br>(0.0019)  | 0.0839***<br>(0.0210)  | 0.0173***<br>(0.0039)  |
| Gender                      | 0.1789<br>(0.1417)     | 0.0376<br>(0.0297)     | 0.3374<br>(0.2315)     | 0.0646<br>(0.0442)     | 0.0044<br>(0.1509)      | 0.0008<br>(0.0281)     | -0.0594<br>(0.2300)    | -0.0123<br>(0.0476)    |
| Demographic1                | -0.4843**<br>(0.1988)  | -0.1017**<br>(0.0412)  | -0.5416<br>(0.3380)    | -0.1036<br>(0.0639)    | -0.2944<br>(0.2115)     | -0.0549<br>(0.0392)    | -0.2355<br>(0.3420)    | -0.0487<br>(0.0701)    |
| Demographic2                | 0.0338<br>(0.2101)     | 0.0071<br>(0.0441)     | -0.0696<br>(0.3531)    | -0.0133<br>(0.0676)    | 0.2505<br>(0.2214)      | 0.0467<br>(0.0413)     | 0.5612*<br>(0.3209)    | 0.1161*<br>(0.0661)    |
| AdvMath                     |                        |                        | 0.4165<br>(0.2555)     | 0.0797*<br>(0.0482)    |                         |                        | 0.6465***<br>(0.2502)  | 0.1337***<br>(0.0504)  |
| ComScore                    |                        |                        | 0.2219***<br>(0.0668)  | 0.0425***<br>(0.0120)  |                         |                        | 0.0059<br>(0.0583)     | 0.0012<br>(0.0121)     |
| YearTransMore               | 0.8980***<br>(0.1416)  | 0.1886***<br>(0.0273)  | -1.2106***<br>(0.2388) | -0.2317***<br>(0.0397) |                         |                        |                        |                        |
| Obs   Pseudo-R <sup>2</sup> | 1000                   | 0.0988                 |                        |                        |                         |                        |                        |                        |
| LL   Param   AIC            | -1616.1                | 26                     | 3284.3                 |                        |                         |                        |                        |                        |

Robust standard errors in parentheses: \*p<0.10, \*\*p<0.05, \*\*\*p<0.01.

# A4: Year-Static Unrestricted Estimates (Optimal)

Table 20b: Year-Static Unrestricted Estimates (Optimal)

|                             | Transition             |                        | Accept                 |                        | Success1                |                        | Success2               |                        |
|-----------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|-------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|
|                             | Coef                   | AME                    | Coef                   | AME                    | Coef                    | AME                    | Coef                   | AME                    |
| Intercept                   | -9.1577***<br>(0.9469) | -1.9164***<br>(0.1576) | -9.2245***<br>(1.8167) | -1.6855***<br>(0.2808) | -10.5425***<br>(1.0566) | -1.9666***<br>(0.1529) | -8.4374***<br>(1.7772) | -1.7657***<br>(0.3171) |
| GREQuantPct                 | 0.0992***<br>(0.0111)  | 0.0208***<br>(0.0019)  | 0.0971***<br>(0.0207)  | 0.0177***<br>(0.0033)  | 0.1140***<br>(0.0125)   | 0.0213***<br>(0.0019)  | 0.0847***<br>(0.0210)  | 0.0177***<br>(0.0039)  |
| Gender                      | 0.0002<br>(0.1422)     | 0.0000<br>(0.0298)     | 0.1897<br>(0.2448)     | 0.0347<br>(0.0448)     | 0.0044<br>(0.1509)      | 0.0008<br>(0.0281)     | -0.0412<br>(0.2299)    | -0.0086<br>(0.0481)    |
| Demographic1                | -0.3518*<br>(0.2004)   | -0.0736*<br>(0.0416)   | -0.4248<br>(0.3637)    | -0.0776<br>(0.0662)    | -0.2944<br>(0.2115)     | -0.0549<br>(0.0392)    | -0.2785<br>(0.3423)    | -0.0583<br>(0.0709)    |
| Demographic2                | 0.0435<br>(0.2137)     | 0.0091<br>(0.0447)     | -0.1174<br>(0.3788)    | -0.0215<br>(0.0693)    | 0.2505<br>(0.2214)      | 0.0467<br>(0.0413)     | 0.5504*<br>(0.3256)    | 0.1152*<br>(0.0678)    |
| AdvMath                     |                        |                        | 0.7137***<br>(0.2626)  | 0.1304***<br>(0.0463)  |                         |                        | 0.5665**<br>(0.2501)   | 0.1185**<br>(0.0513)   |
| ComScore                    |                        |                        | 0.0952<br>(0.0628)     | 0.0174<br>(0.0113)     |                         |                        | 0.0237<br>(0.0572)     | 0.0050<br>(0.0119)     |
| YearTransMore               | 0.8248***<br>(0.1419)  | 0.1726***<br>(0.0276)  | -1.2833***<br>(0.2467) | -0.2345***<br>(0.0378) |                         |                        |                        |                        |
| Obs   Pseudo-R <sup>2</sup> | 1000                   | 0.1058                 |                        |                        |                         |                        |                        |                        |
| LL   Param   AIC            | -1611.7                | 26                     | 3275.4                 |                        |                         |                        |                        |                        |

Robust standard errors in parentheses: \*p<0.10, \*\*p<0.05, \*\*\*p<0.01.

# A4: Year-Dynamic Restricted Estimates (Suboptimal)

Table 21a: Year-Dynamic Restricted Estimates (Suboptimal)

|                             | FAdvMath               | FComScore              | Cutoff1             | $L(\text{Cutoff})_1$       | Cutoff2                | $P(\text{Cutoff})_2$       | Success              | Sigma              |
|-----------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|---------------------|----------------------------|------------------------|----------------------------|----------------------|--------------------|
| Intercept                   | -6.1931***<br>(0.8371) | 0.5166<br>(0.7436)     | -0.4477<br>(0.6919) | 0.6391<br>(0.1647, 2.4802) | -0.6118***<br>(0.1802) | 35.17%<br>(27.59%, 43.57%) | -8.4870<br>(12.5846) |                    |
| GREQuantPct                 | 0.0715***<br>(0.0100)  | 0.0586***<br>(0.0090)  |                     |                            |                        |                            | 0.0799<br>(0.1379)   |                    |
| Gender                      | -0.0410<br>(0.1361)    | 0.3267***<br>(0.1202)  |                     |                            |                        |                            | 0.1457<br>(0.1426)   |                    |
| Demographic1                | 0.5215***<br>(0.1802)  | -1.2825***<br>(0.1530) |                     |                            |                        |                            | -0.3775<br>(0.5271)  |                    |
| Demographic2                | -0.0349<br>(0.1999)    | -0.9447***<br>(0.1760) |                     |                            |                        |                            | 0.2483<br>(0.5059)   |                    |
| AdvMath                     |                        | 0.8948***<br>(0.1239)  |                     |                            |                        |                            | 0.4141<br>(0.4431)   |                    |
| ComScore                    |                        |                        |                     |                            |                        |                            | 0.1340**<br>(0.0628) |                    |
| YearTransMore               |                        |                        | -0.0096<br>(0.0626) | 0.6330<br>(0.1709, 2.3444) | 0.8913<br>(1.3618)     | 56.94%<br>(9.04%, 94.62%)  |                      |                    |
| $\sqrt{\text{MeanSqError}}$ |                        | 1.8840***<br>(0.0399)  |                     |                            |                        |                            |                      |                    |
| Sigma                       |                        |                        |                     |                            |                        |                            |                      | 0.1819<br>(0.2909) |
| Observations                | 1000                   |                        |                     |                            |                        |                            |                      |                    |
| LL   Param   AIC            | -3785.0                | 24                     | 7618.0              |                            |                        |                            |                      |                    |
| LR Stat   DF   P-Val        | 53.8131                | 9                      | 0.0000              |                            |                        |                            |                      |                    |

Robust standard errors in parentheses: \*p<0.10, \*\*p<0.05, \*\*\*p<0.01. Confidence intervals are 95%.

# A4: Year-Dynamic Restricted Estimates (Optimal)

Table 21b: Year-Dynamic Restricted Estimates (Optimal)

|                             | FAdvMath               | FComScore              | Cutoff1                | $L(\text{Cutoff})_1$       | Cutoff2                | $P(\text{Cutoff})_2$       | Success                | Sigma                 |
|-----------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|----------------------------|------------------------|----------------------------|------------------------|-----------------------|
| Intercept                   | -6.1768***<br>(0.8229) | 0.5240<br>(0.7313)     | -0.5344***<br>(0.1440) | 0.5860<br>(0.4419, 0.7771) | -0.5960***<br>(0.1541) | 35.52%<br>(28.94%, 42.70%) | -8.7931***<br>(3.0648) |                       |
| GREQuantPct                 | 0.0713***<br>(0.0099)  | 0.0584***<br>(0.0089)  |                        |                            |                        |                            | 0.0876***<br>(0.0334)  |                       |
| Gender                      | -0.0391<br>(0.1359)    | 0.3305***<br>(0.1204)  |                        |                            |                        |                            | 0.0238<br>(0.1132)     |                       |
| Demographic1                | 0.5230***<br>(0.1803)  | -1.2810***<br>(0.1531) |                        |                            |                        |                            | -0.2855<br>(0.2036)    |                       |
| Demographic2                | -0.0371<br>(0.1999)    | -0.9441***<br>(0.1760) |                        |                            |                        |                            | 0.1727<br>(0.1999)     |                       |
| AdvMath                     |                        | 0.8913***<br>(0.1239)  |                        |                            |                        |                            | 0.5028**<br>(0.1953)   |                       |
| ComScore                    |                        |                        |                        |                            |                        |                            | 0.0659*<br>(0.0384)    |                       |
| YearTransMore               |                        |                        | 0.0245<br>(0.0515)     | 0.6006<br>(0.4481, 0.8049) | 0.7803**<br>(0.3189)   | 54.59%<br>(40.35%, 68.12%) |                        |                       |
| $\sqrt{\text{MeanSqError}}$ |                        | 1.8849***<br>(0.0398)  |                        |                            |                        |                            |                        |                       |
| Sigma                       |                        |                        |                        |                            |                        |                            |                        | 0.1473***<br>(0.0541) |
| Observations                | 1000                   |                        |                        |                            |                        |                            |                        |                       |
| LL   Param   AIC            | -3773.5                | 24                     | 7595.0                 |                            |                        |                            |                        |                       |
| LR Stat   DF   P-Val        | 39.6494                | 9                      | 0.0000                 |                            |                        |                            |                        |                       |

Robust standard errors in parentheses: \* $p < 0.10$ , \*\* $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\* $p < 0.01$ . Confidence intervals are 95%.

# A4: Year-Dynamic Unrestricted Missing (Suboptimal)

Table 22a: Year-Dynamic Unrestricted Missing (Suboptimal)

|                             | FStage1                |                        | FAdvMath             |                      | FComScore              | Transition             |                        | Accept                 |                        | Success                |                        |
|-----------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|----------------------|----------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|
|                             | Coef                   | AME                    | Coef                 | AME                  |                        | Coef                   | AME                    | Coef                   | AME                    | Coef                   | AME                    |
| Intercept                   | -5.1788***<br>(0.5553) | -1.7932***<br>(0.1624) | -2.9927*<br>(1.7053) | -1.0548*<br>(0.5911) | 2.7507<br>(2.3336)     | -8.5772***<br>(0.9369) | -1.8014***<br>(0.1610) | -4.8978***<br>(1.6572) | -0.9362***<br>(0.2992) | -8.2901***<br>(1.7618) | -1.7168***<br>(0.3127) |
| GREQuantPct                 | 0.0554***<br>(0.0066)  | 0.0192***<br>(0.0020)  | 0.0409**<br>(0.0167) | 0.0144**<br>(0.0057) | 0.0355<br>(0.0226)     | 0.0918***<br>(0.0110)  | 0.0193***<br>(0.0020)  | 0.0415**<br>(0.0193)   | 0.0079**<br>(0.0036)   | 0.0832***<br>(0.0209)  | 0.0172***<br>(0.0039)  |
| Gender                      | 0.1094<br>(0.0858)     | 0.0379<br>(0.0296)     | -0.1976<br>(0.1380)  | -0.0696<br>(0.0482)  | 0.1937<br>(0.1947)     | 0.1789<br>(0.1417)     | 0.0376<br>(0.0297)     | 0.3418<br>(0.2318)     | 0.0653<br>(0.0441)     | -0.0589<br>(0.2296)    | -0.0122<br>(0.0475)    |
| Demographic1                | -0.2859**<br>(0.1186)  | -0.0990**<br>(0.0406)  | 0.2982<br>(0.1976)   | 0.1051<br>(0.0691)   | -1.1999***<br>(0.2734) | -0.4842**<br>(0.1988)  | -0.1017**<br>(0.0412)  | -0.5561<br>(0.3383)    | -0.1063*<br>(0.0638)   | -0.2415<br>(0.3411)    | -0.0500<br>(0.0700)    |
| Demographic2                | 0.0241<br>(0.1266)     | 0.0083<br>(0.0438)     | -0.1464<br>(0.2000)  | -0.0516<br>(0.0703)  | -0.9202***<br>(0.2915) | 0.0339<br>(0.2101)     | 0.0071<br>(0.0441)     | -0.0826<br>(0.3531)    | -0.0158<br>(0.0675)    | 0.5526*<br>(0.3201)    | 0.1144*<br>(0.0660)    |
| AdvMath                     |                        |                        |                      |                      | 0.8786***<br>(0.2057)  |                        |                        | 0.4132<br>(0.2558)     | 0.0790<br>(0.0482)     | 0.6481***<br>(0.2499)  | 0.1342***<br>(0.0504)  |
| ComScore                    |                        |                        |                      |                      |                        |                        |                        | 0.2220***<br>(0.0668)  | 0.0424***<br>(0.0120)  | 0.0053<br>(0.0582)     | 0.0011<br>(0.0121)     |
| YearTransMore               | 0.5446***<br>(0.0850)  | 0.1886***<br>(0.0274)  |                      |                      |                        | 0.8980***<br>(0.1416)  | 0.1886***<br>(0.0273)  | -1.2072***<br>(0.2391) | -0.2307***<br>(0.0397) |                        |                        |
| InvMills                    |                        |                        | -0.4189<br>(0.3872)  | -0.1476<br>(0.1361)  | -0.1894<br>(0.5612)    |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |
| $\sqrt{\text{MeanSqError}}$ |                        |                        |                      |                      | 1.8925***<br>(0.0662)  |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |
| Obs   Pseudo R <sup>2</sup> | 1000                   | 0.0760                 |                      |                      |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |
| LL   Param   AIC            | -2715.9                | 41                     | 5513.9               |                      |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |

Robust standard errors in parentheses: \*p<0.10, \*\*p<0.05, \*\*\*p<0.01.

# A4: Year-Dynamic Unrestricted Missing (Optimal)

Table 22b: Year-Dynamic Unrestricted Missing (Optimal)

|                             | FStage1                |                        | FAdvMath             |                      | FComScore              | Transition             |                        | Accept                 |                        | Success                |                        |
|-----------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|----------------------|----------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|
|                             | Coef                   | AME                    | Coef                 | AME                  | Coef                   | Coef                   | AME                    | Coef                   | AME                    | Coef                   | AME                    |
| Intercept                   | -5.5333***<br>(0.5668) | -1.9103***<br>(0.1614) | -2.6740<br>(1.9361)  | -0.9412<br>(0.6738)  | 2.9426<br>(2.6765)     | -9.1587***<br>(0.9470) | -1.9166***<br>(0.1576) | -9.4836***<br>(1.8420) | -1.7254***<br>(0.2807) | -8.2448***<br>(1.7584) | -1.7310***<br>(0.3170) |
| GREQuantPct                 | 0.0599***<br>(0.0067)  | 0.0207***<br>(0.0020)  | 0.0373**<br>(0.0188) | 0.0131**<br>(0.0065) | 0.0342<br>(0.0258)     | 0.0992***<br>(0.0111)  | 0.0208***<br>(0.0019)  | 0.0998***<br>(0.0210)  | 0.0182***<br>(0.0033)  | 0.0824***<br>(0.0208)  | 0.0173***<br>(0.0039)  |
| Gender                      | 0.0025<br>(0.0860)     | 0.0009<br>(0.0297)     | -0.1822<br>(0.1380)  | -0.0641<br>(0.0482)  | 0.1863<br>(0.1918)     | 0.0002<br>(0.1422)     | 0.0000<br>(0.0298)     | 0.1969<br>(0.2459)     | 0.0358<br>(0.0448)     | -0.0434<br>(0.2292)    | -0.0091<br>(0.0481)    |
| Demographic1                | -0.2056*<br>(0.1193)   | -0.0710*<br>(0.0409)   | 0.2973<br>(0.1954)   | 0.1047<br>(0.0683)   | -1.2445***<br>(0.2697) | -0.3519*<br>(0.2004)   | -0.0736*<br>(0.0416)   | -0.4210<br>(0.3655)    | -0.0766<br>(0.0662)    | -0.2654<br>(0.3411)    | -0.0557<br>(0.0709)    |
| Demographic2                | 0.0312<br>(0.1280)     | 0.0108<br>(0.0442)     | -0.1242<br>(0.2051)  | -0.0437<br>(0.0721)  | -1.0245***<br>(0.2997) | 0.0433<br>(0.2137)     | 0.0091<br>(0.0447)     | -0.1066<br>(0.3807)    | -0.0194<br>(0.0693)    | 0.5579*<br>(0.3250)    | 0.1171*<br>(0.0679)    |
| AdvMath                     |                        |                        |                      |                      | 0.8964***<br>(0.2088)  |                        |                        | 0.7077***<br>(0.2634)  | 0.1288***<br>(0.0463)  | 0.5718**<br>(0.2495)   | 0.1200**<br>(0.0513)   |
| ComScore                    |                        |                        |                      |                      |                        |                        |                        | 0.0968<br>(0.0631)     | 0.0176<br>(0.0113)     | 0.0233<br>(0.0570)     | 0.0049<br>(0.0120)     |
| YearTransMore               | 0.4989***<br>(0.0852)  | 0.1722***<br>(0.0277)  |                      |                      |                        | 0.8249***<br>(0.1419)  | 0.1726***<br>(0.0276)  | -1.2813***<br>(0.2479) | -0.2331***<br>(0.0378) |                        |                        |
| InvMills                    |                        |                        | -0.4587<br>(0.4255)  | -0.1615<br>(0.1495)  | -0.2035<br>(0.6179)    |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |
| √MeanSqError                |                        |                        |                      |                      | 1.9059***<br>(0.0667)  |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |
| Obs   Pseudo R <sup>2</sup> | 1000                   | 0.0811                 |                      |                      |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |
| LL   Param   AIC            | -2720.3                | 41                     | 5522.6               |                      |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |

Robust standard errors in parentheses: \*p<0.10, \*\*p<0.05, \*\*\*p<0.01.



# A4: Year-Dynamic Restricted Missing (Suboptimal)

Table 23a: Year-Dynamic Restricted Missing (Suboptimal)

|                             | FStage1                | FAdvMath             | FComScore              | Cutoff1             | $L(\text{Cutoff})_1$       | Cutoff2                | $P(\text{Cutoff})_2$       | Success              | Sigma              |
|-----------------------------|------------------------|----------------------|------------------------|---------------------|----------------------------|------------------------|----------------------------|----------------------|--------------------|
| Intercept                   | -5.1849***<br>(0.5600) | -3.0077*<br>(1.7125) | 2.7390<br>(2.3203)     | -0.4529<br>(0.6380) | 0.6358<br>(0.1821, 2.2201) | -0.6156***<br>(0.1808) | 35.08%<br>(27.49%, 43.51%) | -8.3629<br>(11.5276) |                    |
| GREQuantPct                 | 0.0554***<br>(0.0066)  | 0.0418**<br>(0.0168) | 0.0363<br>(0.0226)     |                     |                            |                        |                            | 0.0786<br>(0.1266)   |                    |
| Gender                      | 0.1106<br>(0.0858)     | -0.1963<br>(0.1363)  | 0.1960<br>(0.1938)     |                     |                            |                        |                            | 0.1511<br>(0.1374)   |                    |
| Demographic1                | -0.2846**<br>(0.1188)  | 0.2917<br>(0.1960)   | -1.2040***<br>(0.2717) |                     |                            |                        |                            | -0.3901<br>(0.5285)  |                    |
| Demographic2                | 0.0225<br>(0.1268)     | -0.1595<br>(0.1973)  | -0.9260***<br>(0.2899) |                     |                            |                        |                            | 0.2394<br>(0.4445)   |                    |
| AdvMath                     |                        |                      | 0.8890***<br>(0.2057)  |                     |                            |                        |                            | 0.4501<br>(0.4458)   |                    |
| ComScore                    |                        |                      |                        |                     |                            |                        |                            | 0.1300**<br>(0.0579) |                    |
| YearTransMore               | 0.5474***<br>(0.0861)  |                      |                        | -0.0042<br>(0.0616) | 0.6331<br>(0.1890, 2.1209) | 0.8901<br>(1.2635)     | 56.82%<br>(10.79%, 93.47%) |                      |                    |
| InvMills                    |                        | -0.4754<br>(0.3913)  | -0.2427<br>(0.5594)    |                     |                            |                        |                            |                      |                    |
| $\sqrt{\text{MeanSqError}}$ |                        |                      | 1.8935***<br>(0.0666)  |                     |                            |                        |                            |                      |                    |
| Sigma                       |                        |                      |                        |                     |                            |                        |                            |                      | 0.1805<br>(0.2674) |
| Observations                | 1000                   |                      |                        |                     |                            |                        |                            |                      |                    |
| LL   Param   AIC            | -2742.5                | 32                   | 5549.0                 |                     |                            |                        |                            |                      |                    |
| LR Stat   DF   P-Val        | 53.1755                | 9                    | 0.0000                 |                     |                            |                        |                            |                      |                    |

Robust standard errors in parentheses: \*p<0.10, \*\*p<0.05, \*\*\*p<0.01. Confidence intervals are 95%.

# A4: Year-Dynamic Restricted Missing (Optimal)

Table 23b: Year-Dynamic Restricted Missing (Optimal)

|                      | FStage1                | FAdvMath             | FComScore              | Cutoff1                | L(Cutoff) <sub>1</sub>     | Cutoff2                | P(Cutoff) <sub>2</sub>     | Success                | Sigma                 |
|----------------------|------------------------|----------------------|------------------------|------------------------|----------------------------|------------------------|----------------------------|------------------------|-----------------------|
| Intercept            | -5.5371***<br>(0.5732) | -2.6870<br>(1.9557)  | 2.9441<br>(2.6682)     | -0.5459***<br>(0.1161) | 0.5793<br>(0.4615, 0.7273) | -0.5863***<br>(0.1500) | 35.75%<br>(29.31%, 42.74%) | -8.3634***<br>(2.3193) |                       |
| GREQuantPct          | 0.0599***<br>(0.0068)  | 0.0382**<br>(0.0190) | 0.0345<br>(0.0257)     |                        |                            |                        |                            | 0.0826***<br>(0.0250)  |                       |
| Gender               | 0.0032<br>(0.0860)     | -0.1802<br>(0.1357)  | 0.1850<br>(0.1912)     |                        |                            |                        |                            | 0.0447<br>(0.1096)     |                       |
| Demographic1         | -0.2061*<br>(0.1194)   | 0.2902<br>(0.1936)   | -1.2455***<br>(0.2693) |                        |                            |                        |                            | -0.2408<br>(0.1838)    |                       |
| Demographic2         | 0.0295<br>(0.1281)     | -0.1360<br>(0.2022)  | -1.0281***<br>(0.2992) |                        |                            |                        |                            | 0.1880<br>(0.1935)     |                       |
| AdvMath              |                        |                      | 0.9026***<br>(0.2088)  |                        |                            |                        |                            | 0.4942***<br>(0.1764)  |                       |
| ComScore             |                        |                      |                        |                        |                            |                        |                            | 0.0643*<br>(0.0372)    |                       |
| YearTransMore        | 0.4995***<br>(0.0857)  |                      |                        | 0.0281<br>(0.0503)     | 0.5958<br>(0.4697, 0.7558) | 0.7546***<br>(0.2627)  | 54.20%<br>(42.41%, 65.54%) |                        |                       |
| InvMills             |                        | -0.5095<br>(0.4343)  | -0.2301<br>(0.6188)    |                        |                            |                        |                            |                        |                       |
| √MeanSqError         |                        |                      | 1.9062***<br>(0.0667)  |                        |                            |                        |                            |                        |                       |
| Sigma                |                        |                      |                        |                        |                            |                        |                            |                        | 0.1418***<br>(0.0414) |
| Observations         | 1000                   |                      |                        |                        |                            |                        |                            |                        |                       |
| LL   Param   AIC     | -2739.7                | 32                   | 5543.4                 |                        |                            |                        |                            |                        |                       |
| LR Stat   DF   P-Val | 38.8065                | 9                    | 0.0000                 |                        |                            |                        |                            |                        |                       |

Robust standard errors in parentheses: \*p<0.10, \*\*p<0.05, \*\*\*p<0.01. Confidence intervals are 95%.

# A4: Year-Myopic Unrestricted Estimates (Suboptimal)

Table 24a: Year-Myopic Unrestricted Estimates (Suboptimal)

|                             | FAdvMath |           | FComScore | Transition |            | Accept     |            | Success    |            |
|-----------------------------|----------|-----------|-----------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
|                             | Coef     | AME       |           | Coef       | AME        | Coef       | AME        | Coef       | AME        |
| Intercept                   | 0.1201*  | 0.5300*** | 4.6362*** | -8.5778*** | -1.8014*** | -4.7827*** | -0.9153*** | -8.3592*** | -1.7287*** |
|                             | (0.0634) | (0.0158)  | (0.0879)  | (0.9369)   | (0.1610)   | (1.6494)   | (0.2990)   | (1.7684)   | (0.3127)   |
| GREQuantPct                 |          |           |           | 0.0919***  | 0.0193***  | 0.0401**   | 0.0077**   | 0.0839***  | 0.0174***  |
|                             |          |           |           | (0.0110)   | (0.0020)   | (0.0193)   | (0.0036)   | (0.0210)   | (0.0039)   |
| Gender                      |          |           |           | 0.1788     | 0.0376     | 0.3374     | 0.0646     | -0.0594    | -0.0123    |
|                             |          |           |           | (0.1417)   | (0.0297)   | (0.2315)   | (0.0442)   | (0.2300)   | (0.0476)   |
| Demographic1                |          |           |           | -0.4846**  | -0.1018**  | -0.5415    | -0.1036    | -0.2355    | -0.0487    |
|                             |          |           |           | (0.1988)   | (0.0412)   | (0.3380)   | (0.0639)   | (0.3420)   | (0.0701)   |
| Demographic2                |          |           |           | 0.0335     | 0.0070     | -0.0695    | -0.0133    | 0.5612*    | 0.1161*    |
|                             |          |           |           | (0.2101)   | (0.0441)   | (0.3531)   | (0.0676)   | (0.3209)   | (0.0661)   |
| AdvMath                     |          |           | 0.9638*** |            |            | 0.4166     | 0.0797*    | 0.6464***  | 0.1337***  |
|                             |          |           | (0.1243)  |            |            | (0.2555)   | (0.0482)   | (0.2502)   | (0.0504)   |
| ComScore                    |          |           |           |            |            | 0.2219***  | 0.0425***  | 0.0059     | 0.0012     |
|                             |          |           |           |            |            | (0.0668)   | (0.0120)   | (0.0583)   | (0.0121)   |
| YearTransMore               |          |           |           | 0.8980***  | 0.1886***  | -1.2106*** | -0.2317*** |            |            |
|                             |          |           |           | (0.1416)   | (0.0273)   | (0.2388)   | (0.0397)   |            |            |
| √MeanSqError                |          |           | 1.9698*** |            |            |            |            |            |            |
|                             |          |           | (0.0413)  |            |            |            |            |            |            |
| Obs   Pseudo-R <sup>2</sup> | 1000     | 0.0363    |           |            |            |            |            |            |            |
| LL   Param   AIC            | -3851.0  | 25        | 7752.1    |            |            |            |            |            |            |

Robust standard errors in parentheses: \*p<0.10, \*\*p<0.05, \*\*\*p<0.01.

# A4: Year-Myopic Unrestricted Estimates (Optimal)

Table 24b: Year-Myopic Unrestricted Estimates (Optimal)

|                             | FAdvMath |           | FComScore | Transition |            | Accept     |            | Success    |            |
|-----------------------------|----------|-----------|-----------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
|                             | Coef     | AME       |           | Coef       | AME        | Coef       | AME        | Coef       | AME        |
| Intercept                   | 0.1201*  | 0.5300*** | 4.6362*** | -9.1582*** | -1.9165*** | -9.2354*** | -1.6874*** | -8.4285*** | -1.7639*** |
|                             | (0.0634) | (0.0158)  | (0.0879)  | (0.9469)   | (0.1576)   | (1.8175)   | (0.2808)   | (1.7765)   | (0.3171)   |
| GREQuantPct                 |          |           |           | 0.0992***  | 0.0208***  | 0.0972***  | 0.0178***  | 0.0846***  | 0.0177***  |
|                             |          |           |           | (0.0111)   | (0.0019)   | (0.0207)   | (0.0033)   | (0.0210)   | (0.0039)   |
| Gender                      |          |           |           | 0.0002     | 0.0000     | 0.1906     | 0.0348     | -0.0419    | -0.0088    |
|                             |          |           |           | (0.1422)   | (0.0298)   | (0.2448)   | (0.0448)   | (0.2299)   | (0.0481)   |
| Demographic1                |          |           |           | -0.3522*   | -0.0737*   | -0.4229    | -0.0773    | -0.2773    | -0.0580    |
|                             |          |           |           | (0.2004)   | (0.0416)   | (0.3637)   | (0.0662)   | (0.3423)   | (0.0709)   |
| Demographic2                |          |           |           | 0.0431     | 0.0090     | -0.1152    | -0.0211    | 0.5521*    | 0.1155*    |
|                             |          |           |           | (0.2137)   | (0.0447)   | (0.3789)   | (0.0693)   | (0.3257)   | (0.0678)   |
| AdvMath                     |          |           | 0.9638*** |            |            | 0.7138***  | 0.1304***  | 0.5680**   | 0.1189**   |
|                             |          |           | (0.1243)  |            |            | (0.2625)   | (0.0463)   | (0.2501)   | (0.0513)   |
| ComScore                    |          |           |           |            |            | 0.0953     | 0.0174     | 0.0237     | 0.0050     |
|                             |          |           |           |            |            | (0.0628)   | (0.0113)   | (0.0572)   | (0.0119)   |
| YearTransMore               |          |           |           | 0.8248***  | 0.1726***  | -1.2820*** | -0.2342*** |            |            |
|                             |          |           |           | (0.1419)   | (0.0276)   | (0.2467)   | (0.0378)   |            |            |
| $\sqrt{\text{MeanSqError}}$ |          |           | 1.9698*** |            |            |            |            |            |            |
|                             |          |           | (0.0413)  |            |            |            |            |            |            |
| Obs   Pseudo-R <sup>2</sup> | 1000     | 0.0396    |           |            |            |            |            |            |            |
| LL   Param   AIC            | -3846.6  | 25        | 7743.2    |            |            |            |            |            |            |

Robust standard errors in parentheses: \*p<0.10, \*\*p<0.05, \*\*\*p<0.01.

# A4: Year-Myopic Restricted Estimates (Suboptimal)

Table 25a: Year-Myopic Restricted Estimates (Suboptimal)

|                             | FAdvMath             | FComScore             | Cutoff1             | $L(\text{Cutoff})_1$       | Cutoff2                | $P(\text{Cutoff})_2$       | Success              | Sigma              |
|-----------------------------|----------------------|-----------------------|---------------------|----------------------------|------------------------|----------------------------|----------------------|--------------------|
| Intercept                   | 0.1291**<br>(0.0636) | 4.6418***<br>(0.0884) | -0.4609<br>(0.6357) | 0.6307<br>(0.1814, 2.1926) | -0.6100***<br>(0.1827) | 35.21%<br>(32.88%, 37.60%) | -8.4650<br>(10.9416) |                    |
| GREQuantPct                 |                      |                       |                     |                            |                        |                            | 0.0819<br>(0.1199)   |                    |
| Gender                      |                      |                       |                     |                            |                        |                            | 0.1398<br>(0.1284)   |                    |
| Demographic1                |                      |                       |                     |                            |                        |                            | -0.4103<br>(0.4518)  |                    |
| Demographic2                |                      |                       |                     |                            |                        |                            | 0.2056<br>(0.4868)   |                    |
| AdvMath                     |                      | 0.9652***<br>(0.1243) |                     |                            |                        |                            | 0.3557<br>(0.4351)   |                    |
| ComScore                    |                      |                       |                     |                            |                        |                            | 0.1123**<br>(0.0529) |                    |
| YearTransMore               |                      |                       | -0.0046<br>(0.0615) | 0.6279<br>(0.1876, 2.1019) | 0.8797<br>(1.2631)     | 56.70%<br>(10.93%, 93.32%) |                      |                    |
| $\sqrt{\text{MeanSqError}}$ |                      | 1.9675***<br>(0.0412) |                     |                            |                        |                            |                      |                    |
| Sigma                       |                      |                       |                     |                            |                        |                            |                      | 0.1803<br>(0.2674) |
| Observations                | 1000                 |                       |                     |                            |                        |                            |                      |                    |
| LL   Param   AIC            | -3881.2              | 16                    | 7794.4              |                            |                        |                            |                      |                    |
| LR Stat   DF   P-Val        | 60.3013              | 9                     | 0.0000              |                            |                        |                            |                      |                    |

Robust standard errors in parentheses: \* $p < 0.10$ , \*\* $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\* $p < 0.01$ . Confidence intervals are 95%.

# A4: Year-Myopic Restricted Estimates (Optimal)

Table 25b: Year-Myopic Restricted Estimates (Optimal)

|                             | FAdvMath             | FComScore             | Cutoff1                | $L(\text{Cutoff})_1$       | Cutoff2                | $P(\text{Cutoff})_2$       | Success                | Sigma                 |
|-----------------------------|----------------------|-----------------------|------------------------|----------------------------|------------------------|----------------------------|------------------------|-----------------------|
| Intercept                   | 0.1317**<br>(0.0635) | 4.6389***<br>(0.0879) | -0.5593***<br>(0.1114) | 0.5716<br>(0.4595, 0.7111) | -0.5909***<br>(0.1494) | 35.64%<br>(34.08%, 37.24%) | -8.5595***<br>(2.1793) |                       |
| GREQuantPct                 |                      |                       |                        |                            |                        |                            | 0.0869***<br>(0.0239)  |                       |
| Gender                      |                      |                       |                        |                            |                        |                            | 0.0343<br>(0.1085)     |                       |
| Demographic1                |                      |                       |                        |                            |                        |                            | -0.2998*<br>(0.1787)   |                       |
| Demographic2                |                      |                       |                        |                            |                        |                            | 0.1207<br>(0.1762)     |                       |
| AdvMath                     |                      | 0.9645***<br>(0.1244) |                        |                            |                        |                            | 0.4241**<br>(0.1693)   |                       |
| ComScore                    |                      |                       |                        |                            |                        |                            | 0.0498<br>(0.0351)     |                       |
| YearTransMore               |                      |                       | 0.0304<br>(0.0510)     | 0.5892<br>(0.4695, 0.7394) | 0.7487***<br>(0.2510)  | 53.94%<br>(42.65%, 64.83%) |                        |                       |
| $\sqrt{\text{MeanSqError}}$ |                      | 1.9718***<br>(0.0414) |                        |                            |                        |                            |                        |                       |
| Sigma                       |                      |                       |                        |                            |                        |                            |                        | 0.1403***<br>(0.0391) |
| Observations                | 1000                 |                       |                        |                            |                        |                            |                        |                       |
| LL   Param   AIC            | -3869.1              | 16                    | 7770.3                 |                            |                        |                            |                        |                       |
| LR Stat   DF   P-Val        | 45.0826              | 9                     | 0.0000                 |                            |                        |                            |                        |                       |

Robust standard errors in parentheses: \*p<0.10, \*\*p<0.05, \*\*\*p<0.01. Confidence intervals are 95%.

# A4: Year-Myopic Unrestricted Missing (Suboptimal)

Table 26a: Year-Myopic Unrestricted Missing (Suboptimal)

|                             | FStage1                |                        | FAdvMath            |                     | FComScore             | Transition             |                        | Accept                 |                        | Success                |                        |
|-----------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|---------------------|---------------------|-----------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|
|                             | Coef                   | AME                    | Coef                | AME                 |                       | Coef                   | AME                    | Coef                   | AME                    | Coef                   | AME                    |
| Intercept                   | -0.5244***<br>(0.0589) | -0.1957***<br>(0.0192) | 0.3641<br>(0.3839)  | 0.1419<br>(0.1490)  | 4.8485***<br>(0.5941) | -8.5775***<br>(0.9369) | -1.8014***<br>(0.1610) | -4.7843***<br>(1.6495) | -0.9156***<br>(0.2990) | -8.3574***<br>(1.7682) | -1.7284***<br>(0.3127) |
| GREQuantPct                 |                        |                        |                     |                     |                       | 0.0919***<br>(0.0110)  | 0.0193***<br>(0.0020)  | 0.0401**<br>(0.0193)   | 0.0077**<br>(0.0036)   | 0.0839***<br>(0.0210)  | 0.0173***<br>(0.0039)  |
| Gender                      |                        |                        |                     |                     |                       | 0.1788<br>(0.1417)     | 0.0376<br>(0.0297)     | 0.3374<br>(0.2315)     | 0.0646<br>(0.0442)     | -0.0592<br>(0.2300)    | -0.0122<br>(0.0476)    |
| Demographic1                |                        |                        |                     |                     |                       | -0.4842**<br>(0.1988)  | -0.1017**<br>(0.0412)  | -0.5415<br>(0.3380)    | -0.1036<br>(0.0639)    | -0.2351<br>(0.3420)    | -0.0486<br>(0.0701)    |
| Demographic2                |                        |                        |                     |                     |                       | 0.0339<br>(0.2101)     | 0.0071<br>(0.0441)     | -0.0695<br>(0.3531)    | -0.0133<br>(0.0676)    | 0.5614*<br>(0.3210)    | 0.1161*<br>(0.0661)    |
| AdvMath                     |                        |                        |                     |                     | 0.9097***<br>(0.1967) |                        |                        | 0.4165<br>(0.2555)     | 0.0797*<br>(0.0482)    | 0.6464***<br>(0.2502)  | 0.1337***<br>(0.0504)  |
| ComScore                    |                        |                        |                     |                     |                       |                        |                        | 0.2219***<br>(0.0668)  | 0.0425***<br>(0.0120)  | 0.0059<br>(0.0583)     | 0.0012<br>(0.0121)     |
| YearTransMore               | 0.4793***<br>(0.0814)  | 0.1788***<br>(0.0287)  |                     |                     |                       | 0.8980***<br>(0.1416)  | 0.1886***<br>(0.0273)  | -1.2106***<br>(0.2388) | -0.2317***<br>(0.0397) |                        |                        |
| InvMills                    |                        |                        | -0.1547<br>(0.3964) | -0.0603<br>(0.1543) | -0.0030<br>(0.6083)   |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |
| $\sqrt{\text{MeanSqError}}$ |                        |                        |                     |                     | 1.9491***<br>(0.0676) |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |
| Obs   Pseudo R <sup>2</sup> | 1000                   | 0.0489                 |                     |                     |                       |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |
| LL   Param   AIC            | -2795.4                | 29                     | 5648.9              |                     |                       |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |

Robust standard errors in parentheses: \*p<0.10, \*\*p<0.05, \*\*\*p<0.01.

# A4: Year-Myopic Unrestricted Missing (Optimal)

Table 26b: Year-Myopic Unrestricted Missing (Optimal)

|                             | FStage1                |                        | FAdvMath            |                     | FComScore             | Transition             |                        | Accept                 |                        | Success                |                        |
|-----------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|---------------------|---------------------|-----------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|
|                             | Coef                   | AME                    | Coef                | AME                 |                       | Coef                   | AME                    | Coef                   | AME                    | Coef                   | AME                    |
| Intercept                   | -0.4902***<br>(0.0586) | -0.1843***<br>(0.0195) | 0.4285<br>(0.4250)  | 0.1664<br>(0.1643)  | 4.9569***<br>(0.6578) | -9.1577***<br>(0.9469) | -1.9164***<br>(0.1576) | -9.2245***<br>(1.8167) | -1.6855***<br>(0.2808) | -8.4374***<br>(1.7772) | -1.7657***<br>(0.3171) |
| GREQuantPct                 |                        |                        |                     |                     |                       | 0.0992***<br>(0.0111)  | 0.0208***<br>(0.0019)  | 0.0971***<br>(0.0207)  | 0.0177***<br>(0.0033)  | 0.0847***<br>(0.0210)  | 0.0177***<br>(0.0039)  |
| Gender                      |                        |                        |                     |                     |                       | 0.0002<br>(0.1422)     | 0.0000<br>(0.0298)     | 0.1897<br>(0.2448)     | 0.0347<br>(0.0448)     | -0.0412<br>(0.2299)    | -0.0086<br>(0.0481)    |
| Demographic1                |                        |                        |                     |                     |                       | -0.3519*<br>(0.2004)   | -0.0736*<br>(0.0416)   | -0.4248<br>(0.3637)    | -0.0776<br>(0.0662)    | -0.2785<br>(0.3423)    | -0.0583<br>(0.0709)    |
| Demographic2                |                        |                        |                     |                     |                       | 0.0434<br>(0.2137)     | 0.0091<br>(0.0447)     | -0.1174<br>(0.3788)    | -0.0214<br>(0.0693)    | 0.5504*<br>(0.3256)    | 0.1152*<br>(0.0678)    |
| AdvMath                     |                        |                        |                     |                     | 0.9270***<br>(0.1981) |                        |                        | 0.7136***<br>(0.2626)  | 0.1304***<br>(0.0463)  | 0.5665**<br>(0.2501)   | 0.1185**<br>(0.0513)   |
| ComScore                    |                        |                        |                     |                     |                       |                        |                        | 0.0952<br>(0.0628)     | 0.0174<br>(0.0113)     | 0.0237<br>(0.0572)     | 0.0050<br>(0.0119)     |
| YearTransMore               | 0.4300***<br>(0.0811)  | 0.1617***<br>(0.0292)  |                     |                     |                       | 0.8248***<br>(0.1419)  | 0.1726***<br>(0.0276)  | -1.2833***<br>(0.2467) | -0.2345***<br>(0.0378) |                        |                        |
| InvMills                    |                        |                        | -0.2068<br>(0.4399) | -0.0803<br>(0.1706) | -0.1171<br>(0.6787)   |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |
| $\sqrt{\text{MeanSqError}}$ |                        |                        |                     |                     | 1.9628***<br>(0.0678) |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |
| Obs   Pseudo R <sup>2</sup> | 1000                   | 0.0522                 |                     |                     |                       |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |
| LL   Param   AIC            | -2805.9                | 29                     | 5669.8              |                     |                       |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |

Robust standard errors in parentheses: \*p<0.10, \*\*p<0.05, \*\*\*p<0.01.



# A4: Year-Myopic Restricted Missing (Suboptimal)

Table 27a: Year-Myopic Restricted Missing (Suboptimal)

|                             | FStage1                | FAdvMath            | FComScore             | Cutoff1             | $L(\text{Cutoff})_1$       | Cutoff2                | $P(\text{Cutoff})_2$       | Success              | Sigma              |
|-----------------------------|------------------------|---------------------|-----------------------|---------------------|----------------------------|------------------------|----------------------------|----------------------|--------------------|
| Intercept                   | -0.5219***<br>(0.0589) | 0.3660<br>(0.3889)  | 4.8574***<br>(0.6005) | -0.4584<br>(0.4992) | 0.6323<br>(0.2377, 1.6820) | -0.6106***<br>(0.1783) | 35.19%<br>(27.68%, 43.51%) | -8.4597<br>(8.6873)  |                    |
| GREQuantPct                 |                        |                     |                       |                     |                            |                        |                            | 0.0814<br>(0.0950)   |                    |
| Gender                      |                        |                     |                       |                     |                            |                        |                            | 0.1396<br>(0.1268)   |                    |
| Demographic1                |                        |                     |                       |                     |                            |                        |                            | -0.4047<br>(0.3758)  |                    |
| Demographic2                |                        |                     |                       |                     |                            |                        |                            | 0.2066<br>(0.3980)   |                    |
| AdvMath                     |                        |                     | 0.9145***<br>(0.1964) |                     |                            |                        |                            | 0.3654<br>(0.3542)   |                    |
| ComScore                    |                        |                     |                       |                     |                            |                        |                            | 0.1172**<br>(0.0505) |                    |
| YearTransMore               | 0.4753***<br>(0.0813)  |                     |                       | -0.0079<br>(0.0590) | 0.6274<br>(0.2422, 1.6247) | 0.8704<br>(0.9919)     | 56.46%<br>(16.77%, 89.30%) |                      |                    |
| InvMills                    |                        | -0.1441<br>(0.4020) | 0.0077<br>(0.6141)    |                     |                            |                        |                            |                      |                    |
| $\sqrt{\text{MeanSqError}}$ |                        |                     | 1.9501***<br>(0.0677) |                     |                            |                        |                            |                      |                    |
| Sigma                       |                        |                     |                       |                     |                            |                        |                            |                      | 0.1785<br>(0.2089) |
| Observations                | 1000                   |                     |                       |                     |                            |                        |                            |                      |                    |
| LL   Param   AIC            | -2824.9                | 20                  | 5689.7                |                     |                            |                        |                            |                      |                    |
| LR Stat   DF   P-Val        | 58.8213                | 9                   | 0.0000                |                     |                            |                        |                            |                      |                    |

Robust standard errors in parentheses: \* $p < 0.10$ , \*\* $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\* $p < 0.01$ . Confidence intervals are 95%.

# A4: Year-Myopic Restricted Missing (Optimal)

Table 27b: Year-Myopic Restricted Missing (Optimal)

|                      | FStage1                | FAdvMath            | FComScore             | Cutoff1                | L(Cutoff) <sub>1</sub>     | Cutoff2                | P(Cutoff) <sub>2</sub>     | Success                | Sigma                 |
|----------------------|------------------------|---------------------|-----------------------|------------------------|----------------------------|------------------------|----------------------------|------------------------|-----------------------|
| Intercept            | -0.4903***<br>(0.0585) | 0.4347<br>(0.4277)  | 4.9623***<br>(0.6606) | -0.5519***<br>(0.1068) | 0.5758<br>(0.4671, 0.7099) | -0.5852***<br>(0.1489) | 35.77%<br>(29.38%, 42.72%) | -8.5581***<br>(2.0776) |                       |
| GREQuantPct          |                        |                     |                       |                        |                            |                        |                            | 0.0861***<br>(0.0226)  |                       |
| Gender               |                        |                     |                       |                        |                            |                        |                            | 0.0384<br>(0.1075)     |                       |
| Demographic1         |                        |                     |                       |                        |                            |                        |                            | -0.2591<br>(0.1750)    |                       |
| Demographic2         |                        |                     |                       |                        |                            |                        |                            | 0.1470<br>(0.1796)     |                       |
| AdvMath              |                        |                     | 0.9310***<br>(0.1981) |                        |                            |                        |                            | 0.4198**<br>(0.1642)   |                       |
| ComScore             |                        |                     |                       |                        |                            |                        |                            | 0.0566<br>(0.0356)     |                       |
| YearTransMore        | 0.4302***<br>(0.0810)  |                     |                       | 0.0282<br>(0.0501)     | 0.5923<br>(0.4762, 0.7368) | 0.7481***<br>(0.2432)  | 54.06%<br>(43.09%, 64.65%) |                        |                       |
| InvMills             |                        | -0.1978<br>(0.4424) | -0.1119<br>(0.6804)   |                        |                            |                        |                            |                        |                       |
| √MeanSqError         |                        |                     | 1.9632***<br>(0.0678) |                        |                            |                        |                            |                        |                       |
| Sigma                |                        |                     |                       |                        |                            |                        |                            |                        | 0.1401***<br>(0.0370) |
| Observations         | 1000                   |                     |                       |                        |                            |                        |                            |                        |                       |
| LL   Param   AIC     | -2827.7                | 20                  | 5695.3                |                        |                            |                        |                            |                        |                       |
| LR Stat   DF   P-Val | 43.5305                | 9                   | 0.0000                |                        |                            |                        |                            |                        |                       |

Robust standard errors in parentheses: \*p<0.10, \*\*p<0.05, \*\*\*p<0.01. Confidence intervals are 95%.

## A4: Waitlist Summary Statistics (Suboptimal)

Table 28a: Waitlist Summary Statistics (Suboptimal)

|              | Mean    | SD     |
|--------------|---------|--------|
| Transition   | 0.3700  | 0.4828 |
| Waitlist     | 0.3120  | 0.4633 |
| Accept       | 0.1510  | 0.3580 |
| Matriculate  | 0.0310  | 0.1733 |
| Success      | 0.3100  | 0.4625 |
| GREQuantPct  | 84.9310 | 7.5286 |
| Gender       | 0.3970  | 0.4893 |
| Demographic1 | 0.5500  | 0.4975 |
| Demographic2 | 0.2620  | 0.4397 |
| AdvMath      | 0.5300  | 0.4991 |
| ComScore     | 5.1470  | 2.0277 |
| MatScore     | 4.9370  | 2.2426 |
| YearTransMat | 0.5000  | 0.5000 |
| Observations | 1000    |        |

# A4: Waitlist Summary Statistics (Optimal)

Table 28b: Waitlist Summary Statistics (Optimal)

|              | Mean    | SD     |
|--------------|---------|--------|
| Transition   | 0.3650  | 0.4814 |
| Waitlist     | 0.3240  | 0.4680 |
| Accept       | 0.1500  | 0.3571 |
| Matriculate  | 0.0390  | 0.1936 |
| Success      | 0.3150  | 0.4645 |
| GREQuantPct  | 84.9310 | 7.5286 |
| Gender       | 0.3970  | 0.4893 |
| Demographic1 | 0.5500  | 0.4975 |
| Demographic2 | 0.2620  | 0.4397 |
| AdvMath      | 0.5300  | 0.4991 |
| ComScore     | 5.1470  | 2.0277 |
| MatScore     | 4.9370  | 2.2426 |
| YearTransMat | 0.5000  | 0.5000 |
| Observations | 1000    |        |

# A4: Waitlist Correlation Matrix (Suboptimal)

Table 29a: Waitlist Correlation Matrix (Suboptimal)

|              | Trans   | Wait    | Acc     | IM      | Suc     | GRE     | Gen     | Dem1    | Dem2    | Math    | Com     | Mat    | Year |
|--------------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|--------|------|
| Transition   | 1       |         |         |         |         |         |         |         |         |         |         |        |      |
| Waitlist     | 0.8787  | 1       |         |         |         |         |         |         |         |         |         |        |      |
| Accept       | 0.5503  | 0.2766  | 1       |         |         |         |         |         |         |         |         |        |      |
| Matriculate  | 0.2334  | -0.0084 | 0.4241  | 1       |         |         |         |         |         |         |         |        |      |
| Success      | 0.0685  | 0.0760  | -0.0049 | -0.0700 | 1       |         |         |         |         |         |         |        |      |
| GREQuantPct  | 0.3041  | 0.2745  | 0.2057  | 0.0675  | 0.2520  | 1       |         |         |         |         |         |        |      |
| Gender       | 0.0428  | 0.0138  | 0.0288  | -0.0390 | -0.0533 | -0.0398 | 1       |         |         |         |         |        |      |
| Demographic1 | -0.0146 | 0.0017  | -0.0340 | 0.0574  | 0.0413  | 0.2483  | 0.0068  | 1       |         |         |         |        |      |
| Demographic2 | 0.0804  | 0.0553  | 0.0472  | -0.0016 | -0.0208 | -0.0918 | -0.0605 | -0.6587 | 1       |         |         |        |      |
| AdvMath      | 0.0660  | 0.0417  | 0.0502  | 0.0413  | 0.1243  | 0.2799  | -0.0181 | 0.1953  | -0.1042 | 1       |         |        |      |
| ComScore     | 0.0364  | 0.0268  | 0.0493  | -0.1154 | 0.1146  | 0.2029  | 0.0783  | -0.0960 | -0.0869 | 0.2372  | 1       |        |      |
| MatScore     | 0.0622  | 0.0420  | -0.0778 | 0.1774  | -0.0496 | -0.0945 | -0.0383 | 0.0562  | 0.0370  | -0.0479 | -0.3571 | 1      |      |
| YearTransMat | 0.1947  | 0.2029  | -0.1480 | 0.0058  | 0.0000  | -0.0410 | -0.0225 | -0.0241 | 0.0318  | 0.0521  | 0.0192  | 0.4383 | 1    |
| Observations | 1000    |         |         |         |         |         |         |         |         |         |         |        |      |

# A4: Waitlist Correlation Matrix (Optimal)

Table 29b: Waitlist Correlation Matrix (Optimal)

|              | Trans   | Wait    | Acc     | IM      | Suc     | GRE     | Gen     | Dem1    | Dem2    | Math    | Com     | Mat    | Year |
|--------------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|--------|------|
| Transition   | 1       |         |         |         |         |         |         |         |         |         |         |        |      |
| Waitlist     | 0.9131  | 1       |         |         |         |         |         |         |         |         |         |        |      |
| Accept       | 0.5541  | 0.3614  | 1       |         |         |         |         |         |         |         |         |        |      |
| Matriculate  | 0.2657  | 0.0923  | 0.4796  | 1       |         |         |         |         |         |         |         |        |      |
| Success      | 0.0448  | 0.0135  | 0.0528  | 0.0302  | 1       |         |         |         |         |         |         |        |      |
| GREQuantPct  | 0.2503  | 0.1908  | 0.2389  | 0.0801  | 0.3210  | 1       |         |         |         |         |         |        |      |
| Gender       | -0.0038 | 0.0191  | -0.0489 | -0.0262 | -0.0310 | -0.0398 | 1       |         |         |         |         |        |      |
| Demographic1 | 0.0136  | 0.0034  | 0.0478  | 0.0161  | -0.0444 | 0.2483  | 0.0068  | 1       |         |         |         |        |      |
| Demographic2 | 0.0065  | 0.0005  | -0.0146 | 0.0327  | 0.0513  | -0.0918 | -0.0605 | -0.6587 | 1       |         |         |        |      |
| AdvMath      | 0.0647  | 0.0397  | 0.0645  | 0.0034  | 0.0994  | 0.2799  | -0.0181 | 0.1953  | -0.1042 | 1       |         |        |      |
| ComScore     | 0.0813  | 0.0710  | 0.0704  | -0.1063 | 0.1557  | 0.2029  | 0.0783  | -0.0960 | -0.0869 | 0.2372  | 1       |        |      |
| MatScore     | 0.0167  | -0.0215 | -0.0869 | 0.2130  | -0.0280 | -0.0945 | -0.0383 | 0.0562  | 0.0370  | -0.0479 | -0.3571 | 1      |      |
| YearTransMat | 0.1641  | 0.1624  | -0.1736 | 0.0052  | -0.0624 | -0.0410 | -0.0225 | -0.0241 | 0.0318  | 0.0521  | 0.0192  | 0.4383 | 1    |
| Observations | 1000    |         |         |         |         |         |         |         |         |         |         |        |      |

# A4: Full Waitlist-Dynamic Unrestricted Estimates (Suboptimal)

Table 30a: Waitlist-Dynamic Unrestricted Estimates (Suboptimal)

|                             | FAdvMath               |                        | FComScore              | Fm <sub>2</sub>       | Fm <sub>2A</sub>      | Transition              |                        | Accept2               |                       | Accept3                |                        | Success                |                        |
|-----------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-------------------------|------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|
|                             | Coef                   | AME                    | Coef                   | Coef                  | Coef                  | Coef                    | AME                    | Coef                  | AME                   | Coef                   | AME                    | Coef                   | AME                    |
| Intercept                   | -6.2079***<br>(0.8279) | -1.4002***<br>(0.1646) | 0.9526<br>(0.7367)     | 5.4979***<br>(0.3634) | 0.1489***<br>(0.0018) | -10.7210***<br>(1.0460) | -2.1071***<br>(0.1548) | 1.0375<br>(2.3164)    | 0.1332<br>(0.2962)    | 3.6817<br>(2.3327)     | 0.4845<br>(0.3079)     | -8.2484***<br>(1.7721) | -1.7415***<br>(0.3282) |
| GREQuantPct                 | 0.0707***<br>(0.0099)  | 0.0160***<br>(0.0020)  | 0.0566***<br>(0.0088)  | -0.0082*<br>(0.0045)  |                       | 0.1109***<br>(0.0119)   | 0.0218***<br>(0.0019)  | -0.0180<br>(0.0253)   | -0.0023<br>(0.0032)   | 0.0471*<br>(0.0271)    | 0.0062*<br>(0.0034)    | 0.0844***<br>(0.0210)  | 0.0178***<br>(0.0040)  |
| Gender                      | -0.0397<br>(0.1367)    | -0.0090<br>(0.0308)    | 0.3124***<br>(0.1188)  | -0.0468<br>(0.0637)   |                       | 0.3479**<br>(0.1474)    | 0.0684**<br>(0.0286)   | 0.3888<br>(0.2995)    | 0.0499<br>(0.0386)    | -0.7248**<br>(0.3422)  | -0.0954**<br>(0.0442)  | -0.0186<br>(0.2390)    | -0.0039<br>(0.0505)    |
| Demographic1                | 0.6068***<br>(0.1818)  | 0.1369***<br>(0.0401)  | -1.5750***<br>(0.1549) | 0.0087<br>(0.0902)    |                       | -0.1970<br>(0.2044)     | -0.0387<br>(0.0401)    | -0.1599<br>(0.4602)   | -0.0205<br>(0.0592)   | -1.1811**<br>(0.5507)  | -0.1554**<br>(0.0706)  | -0.0753<br>(0.3793)    | -0.0159<br>(0.0801)    |
| Demographic2                | 0.0513<br>(0.2027)     | 0.0116<br>(0.0457)     | -1.3568***<br>(0.1784) | 0.0814<br>(0.0969)    |                       | 0.4583**<br>(0.2215)    | 0.0901**<br>(0.0431)   | 0.2797<br>(0.4728)    | 0.0359<br>(0.0606)    | -1.0884**<br>(0.5058)  | -0.1432**<br>(0.0661)  | -0.1579<br>(0.3844)    | -0.0333<br>(0.0811)    |
| AdvMath                     |                        |                        | 0.9118***<br>(0.1212)  | 0.1320**<br>(0.0669)  |                       |                         |                        | 0.4780<br>(0.3239)    | 0.0613<br>(0.0415)    | -0.0258<br>(0.3566)    | -0.0034<br>(0.0470)    | 0.1268<br>(0.2574)     | 0.0268<br>(0.0543)     |
| ComScore                    |                        |                        |                        | 0.0112<br>(0.0166)    |                       |                         |                        | 0.0051<br>(0.0676)    | 0.0007<br>(0.0087)    | 0.1221<br>(0.0787)     | 0.0161<br>(0.0103)     | 0.0349<br>(0.0579)     | 0.0074<br>(0.0122)     |
| YearTransMat                |                        |                        |                        |                       |                       | 1.0061***<br>(0.1492)   | 0.1977***<br>(0.0264)  |                       |                       |                        |                        |                        |                        |
| m <sub>2</sub>              |                        |                        |                        |                       | 1.0524***<br>(0.0003) |                         |                        | -0.3224**<br>(0.1515) | -0.0414**<br>(0.0192) |                        |                        |                        |                        |
| m <sub>2A</sub>             |                        |                        |                        |                       |                       |                         |                        |                       |                       | -1.4912***<br>(0.1656) | -0.1962***<br>(0.0081) |                        |                        |
| √MeanSqError                |                        |                        | 1.8530***<br>(0.0392)  | 0.9790***<br>(0.0022) | 0.0041***<br>(0.0002) |                         |                        |                       |                       |                        |                        |                        |                        |
| Obs   Pseudo-R <sup>2</sup> | 1000                   | 0.3899                 |                        |                       |                       |                         |                        |                       |                       |                        |                        |                        |                        |
| LL   Param   AIC            | -3656.6                | 52                     | 7417.1                 |                       |                       |                         |                        |                       |                       |                        |                        |                        |                        |

Robust standard errors in parentheses: \*p<0.10, \*\*p<0.05, \*\*\*p<0.01.

# A4: Full Waitlist-Dynamic Unrestricted Estimates (Optimal)

Table 30b: Waitlist-Dynamic Unrestricted Estimates (Optimal)

|                             | FAdvMath               |                        | FComScore              |     | $\bar{m}_2$           |     | $\overline{m}_{2A}$    |     | Transition             |                        | Accept2               |                       | Accept3                |                        | Success                 |                        |
|-----------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|-----|-----------------------|-----|------------------------|-----|------------------------|------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|------------------------|------------------------|-------------------------|------------------------|
|                             | Coef                   | AME                    | Coef                   | AME | Coef                  | AME | Coef                   | AME | Coef                   | AME                    | Coef                  | AME                   | Coef                   | AME                    | Coef                    | AME                    |
| Intercept                   | -6.4278***<br>(0.8383) | -1.4433***<br>(0.1646) | 0.9765<br>(0.7368)     |     | 5.5054***<br>(0.3634) |     | -1.2247***<br>(0.0038) |     | -7.8688***<br>(0.9204) | -1.6527***<br>(0.1634) | -5.4487**<br>(2.3463) | -0.5308**<br>(0.2269) | -0.1602<br>(2.0596)    | -0.0213<br>(0.2735)    | -10.4819***<br>(1.8211) | -2.0411***<br>(0.2882) |
| GREQuantPct                 | 0.0732***<br>(0.0100)  | 0.0164***<br>(0.0020)  | 0.0564***<br>(0.0088)  |     | -0.0083*<br>(0.0045)  |     |                        |     | 0.0825***<br>(0.0107)  | 0.0173***<br>(0.0020)  | 0.0465<br>(0.0287)    | 0.0045<br>(0.0028)    | 0.0621**<br>(0.0266)   | 0.0082**<br>(0.0034)   | 0.1047***<br>(0.0211)   | 0.0204***<br>(0.0035)  |
| Gender                      | -0.0348<br>(0.1373)    | -0.0078<br>(0.0308)    | 0.3118***<br>(0.1188)  |     | -0.0469<br>(0.0637)   |     |                        |     | 0.0553<br>(0.1410)     | 0.0116<br>(0.0296)     | -0.5162<br>(0.3697)   | -0.0503<br>(0.0362)   | -0.1677<br>(0.3034)    | -0.0223<br>(0.0404)    | -0.0423<br>(0.2493)     | -0.0082<br>(0.0486)    |
| Demographic1                | 0.6128***<br>(0.1826)  | 0.1376***<br>(0.0401)  | -1.5764***<br>(0.1549) |     | 0.0091<br>(0.0902)    |     |                        |     | -0.2800<br>(0.1945)    | -0.0588<br>(0.0407)    | 0.2920<br>(0.6142)    | 0.0284<br>(0.0600)    | 0.4073<br>(0.4949)     | 0.0541<br>(0.0654)     | -0.5056<br>(0.3708)     | -0.0984<br>(0.0716)    |
| Demographic2                | 0.0632<br>(0.2037)     | 0.0142<br>(0.0457)     | -1.3590***<br>(0.1784) |     | 0.0816<br>(0.0969)    |     |                        |     | -0.0781<br>(0.2140)    | -0.0164<br>(0.0449)    | 0.5062<br>(0.6069)    | 0.0493<br>(0.0592)    | 0.1398<br>(0.5084)     | 0.0186<br>(0.0675)     | 0.5141<br>(0.3855)      | 0.1001<br>(0.0743)     |
| AdvMath                     |                        |                        | 0.9127***<br>(0.1212)  |     | 0.1322**<br>(0.0669)  |     |                        |     |                        |                        | 0.3109<br>(0.3770)    | 0.0303<br>(0.3646)    | -0.0573<br>(0.3646)    | -0.0076<br>(0.0484)    | -0.1314<br>(0.2671)     | -0.0256<br>(0.0520)    |
| ComScore                    |                        |                        |                        |     | 0.0112<br>(0.0166)    |     |                        |     |                        |                        | -0.0207<br>(0.0991)   | -0.0020<br>(0.0096)   | 0.0648<br>(0.0888)     | 0.0086<br>(0.0118)     | 0.1494**<br>(0.0692)    | 0.0291**<br>(0.0133)   |
| YearTransMat                |                        |                        |                        |     |                       |     |                        |     | 0.7931***<br>(0.1403)  | 0.1666***<br>(0.0277)  |                       |                       |                        |                        |                         |                        |
| $\bar{m}_2$                 |                        |                        |                        |     |                       |     | 1.4277***<br>(0.0007)  |     |                        |                        | -0.1868<br>(0.1655)   | -0.0182<br>(0.0158)   |                        |                        |                         |                        |
| $\overline{m}_{2A}$         |                        |                        |                        |     |                       |     |                        |     |                        |                        |                       |                       | -1.0984***<br>(0.1172) | -0.1459***<br>(0.0034) |                         |                        |
| $\sqrt{\text{MeanSqError}}$ |                        |                        | 1.8530***<br>(0.0392)  |     | 0.9790***<br>(0.0022) |     | 0.0057***<br>(0.0005)  |     |                        |                        |                       |                       |                        |                        |                         |                        |
| Obs   Pseudo-R <sup>2</sup> | 1000                   | 0.3770                 |                        |     |                       |     |                        |     |                        |                        |                       |                       |                        |                        |                         |                        |
| LL   Param   AIC            | -3786.1                | 52                     | 7676.3                 |     |                       |     |                        |     |                        |                        |                       |                       |                        |                        |                         |                        |

Robust standard errors in parentheses: \*p<0.10, \*\*p<0.05, \*\*\*p<0.01.



# A4: Waitlist-Hybrid Restricted Estimates (Suboptimal)

Table 31a: Waitlist-Hybrid Restricted Estimates (Suboptimal)

|                                               | $\overline{m}_{2A}$   | $P(\text{Cutoff})_1$       | $P(\text{Cutoff})_3$       | Success 1              | Success 3             | Beta                  | Sigma                 |
|-----------------------------------------------|-----------------------|----------------------------|----------------------------|------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|
| Year Transition/Matriculate Fewer   Intercept | 0.1489***<br>(0.0018) | 32.92%<br>(27.79%, 38.50%) | 23.52%<br>(13.98%, 36.77%) | -7.6626***<br>(1.7500) | -3.1538**<br>(1.5900) |                       |                       |
| GRE Quantitative Percentile                   |                       |                            |                            | 0.0803***<br>(0.0206)  | 0.0283<br>(0.0181)    |                       |                       |
| Gender                                        |                       |                            |                            | 0.0907<br>(0.0878)     | -0.0455<br>(0.1258)   |                       |                       |
| Demographic 1                                 |                       |                            |                            | -0.1575<br>(0.1325)    | -0.3403*<br>(0.2031)  |                       |                       |
| Demographic 2                                 |                       |                            |                            | 0.1673<br>(0.1341)     | -0.2274<br>(0.2014)   |                       |                       |
| Advanced Math                                 |                       |                            |                            |                        | 0.1762<br>(0.1350)    |                       |                       |
| Committee Score                               |                       |                            |                            |                        | 0.0376<br>(0.0304)    |                       |                       |
| Year Transition/Matriculate More              |                       | 24.98%<br>(22.60%, 27.52%) | 70.26%<br>(42.57%, 88.27%) |                        |                       |                       |                       |
| $\ddot{m}_2$                                  | 1.0524***<br>(0.0003) |                            |                            |                        |                       |                       |                       |
| Beta                                          |                       |                            |                            |                        |                       | 0.6194***<br>(0.0889) |                       |
| Sigma                                         |                       |                            |                            |                        |                       |                       | 0.1589***<br>(0.0526) |
| LR Statistic   DF   P-Value                   | 48.5585               | 16                         | 0.0000                     |                        |                       |                       |                       |

►► Waitlist-Dynamic Unrestricted Estimates (Suboptimal)

# A4: Waitlist-Hybrid Restricted Estimates (Optimal)

Table 31b: Waitlist-Hybrid Restricted Estimates (Optimal)

|                                               | $\overline{m}_{2A}$    | $P(\text{Cutoff})_1$       | $P(\text{Cutoff})_3$      | Success 1               | Success 3              | Beta                  | Sigma                 |
|-----------------------------------------------|------------------------|----------------------------|---------------------------|-------------------------|------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|
| Year Transition/Matriculate Fewer   Intercept | -1.2247***<br>(0.0038) | 37.56%<br>(32.38%, 43.04%) | 7.70%<br>(0.88%, 44.03%)  | -10.6778***<br>(1.4717) | -9.8095***<br>(2.1222) |                       |                       |
| GRE Quantitative Percentile                   |                        |                            |                           | 0.1193***<br>(0.0176)   | 0.0978***<br>(0.0239)  |                       |                       |
| Gender                                        |                        |                            |                           | -0.0260<br>(0.1189)     | -0.1737<br>(0.1951)    |                       |                       |
| Demographic 1                                 |                        |                            |                           | -0.5947***<br>(0.1843)  | -0.2075<br>(0.3184)    |                       |                       |
| Demographic 2                                 |                        |                            |                           | -0.0824<br>(0.1758)     | 0.4580<br>(0.2897)     |                       |                       |
| Advanced Math                                 |                        |                            |                           |                         | -0.0104<br>(0.2250)    |                       |                       |
| Committee Score                               |                        |                            |                           |                         | 0.1049*<br>(0.0570)    |                       |                       |
| Year Transition/Matriculate More              |                        | 27.28%<br>(23.97%, 30.86%) | 95.10%<br>(2.93%, 99.99%) |                         |                        |                       |                       |
| $\ddot{m}_2$                                  | 1.4277***<br>(0.0007)  |                            |                           |                         |                        |                       |                       |
| Beta                                          |                        |                            |                           |                         |                        | 0.9225***<br>(0.1209) |                       |
| Sigma                                         |                        |                            |                           |                         |                        |                       | 0.2832***<br>(0.0617) |
| LR Statistic   DF   P-Value                   | 13.3576                | 16                         | 0.6465                    |                         |                        |                       |                       |

►► Waitlist-Dynamic Unrestricted Estimates (Optimal)

# A4: Full Waitlist-Hybrid Restricted Estimates (Suboptimal)

Table 32a: Waitlist-Hybrid Restricted Estimates (Suboptimal)

|                             | $F\overline{m}_{2A}$  | Cutoff1                | $P(\text{Cutoff})_1$       | Cutoff3                | $P(\text{Cutoff})_3$       | Success1               | Success3              | Beta                  | Sigma                 |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------|------------------------|----------------------------|------------------------|----------------------------|------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|
| Intercept                   | 0.1489***<br>(0.0018) | -0.7116***<br>(0.1242) | 32.92%<br>(27.79%, 38.50%) | -5.4270***<br>(1.9647) | 23.52%<br>(13.98%, 36.77%) | -7.6626***<br>(1.7500) | -3.1538**<br>(1.5900) |                       |                       |
| GREQuantPct                 |                       |                        |                            |                        |                            | 0.0803***<br>(0.0206)  | 0.0283<br>(0.0181)    |                       |                       |
| Gender                      |                       |                        |                            |                        |                            | 0.0907<br>(0.0878)     | -0.0455<br>(0.1258)   |                       |                       |
| Demographic1                |                       |                        |                            |                        |                            | -0.1575<br>(0.1325)    | -0.3403*<br>(0.2031)  |                       |                       |
| Demographic2                |                       |                        |                            |                        |                            | 0.1673<br>(0.1341)     | -0.2274<br>(0.2014)   |                       |                       |
| AdvMath                     |                       |                        |                            |                        |                            |                        | 0.1762<br>(0.1350)    |                       |                       |
| ComScore                    |                       |                        |                            |                        |                            |                        | 0.0376<br>(0.0304)    |                       |                       |
| YearTransMat                |                       | -0.3883***<br>(0.1056) | 24.98%<br>(22.60%, 27.52%) |                        | 70.26%<br>(42.57%, 88.27%) |                        |                       |                       |                       |
| $\overline{m}_2$            | 1.0524***<br>(0.0003) |                        |                            |                        |                            |                        |                       |                       |                       |
| $\overline{m}_{2A}$         |                       |                        |                            | 0.9855**<br>(0.3937)   |                            |                        |                       |                       |                       |
| $\sqrt{\text{MeanSqError}}$ | 0.0041***<br>(0.0002) |                        |                            |                        |                            |                        |                       |                       |                       |
| Beta                        |                       |                        |                            |                        |                            |                        |                       | 0.6194***<br>(0.0889) |                       |
| Sigma                       |                       |                        |                            |                        |                            |                        |                       |                       | 0.1589***<br>(0.0526) |
| Observations                | 1000                  |                        |                            |                        |                            |                        |                       |                       |                       |
| LL   Param   AIC            | -189.7                | 21                     | 421.5                      |                        |                            |                        |                       |                       |                       |
| LR Stat   DF   P-Val        | 48.5585               | 16                     | 0.0000                     |                        |                            |                        |                       |                       |                       |

Robust standard errors in parentheses: \*p<0.10, \*\*p<0.05, \*\*\*p<0.01. Confidence intervals are 95%.

# A4: Full Waitlist-Hybrid Restricted Estimates (Optimal)

Table 32b: Waitlist-Hybrid Restricted Estimates (Optimal)

|                             | $F\bar{m}_{2A}$        | Cutoff1                | $P(\text{Cutoff})_1$       | Cutoff3              | $P(\text{Cutoff})_3$      | Success1                | Success3               | Beta                  | Sigma                 |
|-----------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|----------------------------|----------------------|---------------------------|-------------------------|------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|
| Intercept                   | -1.2247***<br>(0.0038) | -0.5082***<br>(0.1163) | 37.56%<br>(32.38%, 43.04%) | -11.0710<br>(7.1634) | 7.70%<br>(0.88%, 44.03%)  | -10.6778***<br>(1.4717) | -9.8095***<br>(2.1222) |                       |                       |
| GREQuantPct                 |                        |                        |                            |                      |                           | 0.1193***<br>(0.0176)   | 0.0978***<br>(0.0239)  |                       |                       |
| Gender                      |                        |                        |                            |                      |                           | -0.0260<br>(0.1189)     | -0.1737<br>(0.1951)    |                       |                       |
| Demographic1                |                        |                        |                            |                      |                           | -0.5947***<br>(0.1843)  | -0.2075<br>(0.3184)    |                       |                       |
| Demographic2                |                        |                        |                            |                      |                           | -0.0824<br>(0.1758)     | 0.4580<br>(0.2897)     |                       |                       |
| AdvMath                     |                        |                        |                            |                      |                           |                         | -0.0104<br>(0.2250)    |                       |                       |
| ComScore                    |                        |                        |                            |                      |                           |                         | 0.1049*<br>(0.0570)    |                       |                       |
| YearTransMat                |                        | -0.4722***<br>(0.1070) | 27.28%<br>(23.97%, 30.86%) |                      | 95.10%<br>(2.93%, 99.99%) |                         |                        |                       |                       |
| $\bar{m}_2$                 | 1.4277***<br>(0.0007)  |                        |                            |                      |                           |                         |                        |                       |                       |
| $\bar{m}_{2A}$              |                        |                        |                            | 1.9422<br>(1.4272)   |                           |                         |                        |                       |                       |
| $\sqrt{\text{MeanSqError}}$ | 0.0057***<br>(0.0005)  |                        |                            |                      |                           |                         |                        |                       |                       |
| Beta                        |                        |                        |                            |                      |                           |                         |                        | 0.9225***<br>(0.1209) |                       |
| Sigma                       |                        |                        |                            |                      |                           |                         |                        |                       | 0.2832***<br>(0.0617) |
| Observations                | 1000                   |                        |                            |                      |                           |                         |                        |                       |                       |
| LL   Param   AIC            | -275.0                 | 21                     | 592.0                      |                      |                           |                         |                        |                       |                       |
| LR Stat   DF   P-Val        | 13.3576                | 16                     | 0.6465                     |                      |                           |                         |                        |                       |                       |

Robust standard errors in parentheses: \*p<0.10, \*\*p<0.05, \*\*\*p<0.01. Confidence intervals are 95%.

# A4: Waitlist-Hybrid Unrestricted Estimates (Suboptimal)

Table 33a: Waitlist-Hybrid Unrestricted Estimates (Suboptimal)

|                             | $\overline{Fm_{2A}}$<br>Coef | Transition<br>Coef      | AME                    | Accept2<br>Coef       | AME                   | Accept3<br>Coef        | AME                    | Success1<br>Coef       | AME                    | Success3<br>Coef       | AME                    |
|-----------------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------|------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|
| Intercept                   | 0.1489***<br>(0.0018)        | -10.7143***<br>(1.0455) | -2.1065***<br>(0.1549) | 1.4111<br>(2.3121)    | 0.1810<br>(0.2948)    | 5.2706**<br>(2.3583)   | 0.6876**<br>(0.3035)   | -7.5197***<br>(0.9558) | -1.6198***<br>(0.1909) | -7.8305***<br>(1.7348) | -1.6644***<br>(0.3277) |
| GREQuantPct                 |                              | 0.1111***<br>(0.0119)   | 0.0218***<br>(0.0019)  | -0.0217<br>(0.0253)   | -0.0028<br>(0.0032)   | 0.0304<br>(0.0266)     | 0.0040<br>(0.0034)     | 0.0810***<br>(0.0113)  | 0.0175***<br>(0.0023)  | 0.0802***<br>(0.0206)  | 0.0171***<br>(0.0040)  |
| Gender                      |                              | 0.3463**<br>(0.1473)    | 0.0681**<br>(0.0286)   | 0.3925<br>(0.2997)    | 0.0503<br>(0.0386)    | -0.7569**<br>(0.3458)  | -0.0987**<br>(0.0441)  | -0.2071<br>(0.1473)    | -0.0446<br>(0.0314)    | -0.0143<br>(0.2373)    | -0.0030<br>(0.0504)    |
| Demographic1                |                              | -0.2186<br>(0.2038)     | -0.0430<br>(0.0400)    | -0.1530<br>(0.4589)   | -0.0196<br>(0.0590)   | -1.1218**<br>(0.5553)  | -0.1463**<br>(0.0709)  | -0.2002<br>(0.1986)    | -0.0431<br>(0.0427)    | -0.1192<br>(0.3732)    | -0.0253<br>(0.0792)    |
| Demographic2                |                              | 0.4335**<br>(0.2208)    | 0.0852**<br>(0.0431)   | 0.2764<br>(0.4718)    | 0.0355<br>(0.0604)    | -1.0364**<br>(0.5085)  | -0.1352**<br>(0.0661)  | -0.1484<br>(0.2220)    | -0.0320<br>(0.0477)    | -0.2127<br>(0.3782)    | -0.0452<br>(0.0803)    |
| AdvMath                     |                              |                         |                        | 0.4911<br>(0.3246)    | 0.0630<br>(0.0415)    | 0.0415<br>(0.3585)     | 0.0054<br>(0.0467)     |                        |                        | 0.1456<br>(0.2555)     | 0.0309<br>(0.0543)     |
| ComScore                    |                              |                         |                        | 0.0047<br>(0.0677)    | 0.0006<br>(0.0087)    | 0.1279<br>(0.0788)     | 0.0167<br>(0.0102)     |                        |                        | 0.0319<br>(0.0577)     | 0.0068<br>(0.0122)     |
| YearTransMat                |                              | 1.0063***<br>(0.1492)   | 0.1979***<br>(0.0265)  |                       |                       |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |
| $\bar{m}_2$                 | 1.0524***<br>(0.0003)        |                         |                        | -0.3346**<br>(0.1516) | -0.0429**<br>(0.0192) |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |
| $\bar{m}_{2A}$              |                              |                         |                        |                       |                       | -1.5313***<br>(0.1683) | -0.1998***<br>(0.0074) |                        |                        |                        |                        |
| $\sqrt{\text{MeanSqError}}$ | 0.0041***<br>(0.0002)        |                         |                        |                       |                       |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |
| Obs   Pseudo-R <sup>2</sup> | 1000                         | 0.9309                  |                        |                       |                       |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |
| LL   Param   AIC            | -165.4                       | 37                      | 404.9                  |                       |                       |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |

Robust standard errors in parentheses: \*p<0.10, \*\*p<0.05, \*\*\*p<0.01.

# A4: Waitlist-Hybrid Unrestricted Estimates (Optimal)

Table 33b: Waitlist-Hybrid Unrestricted Estimates (Optimal)

|                             | $\overline{m_{2A}}$<br>Coef | Transition<br>Coef     | AME                    | Accept2<br>Coef        | AME                    | Accept3<br>Coef        | AME                    | Success1<br>Coef        | AME                    | Success3<br>Coef       | AME                    |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|-------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|
| Intercept                   | -1.2247***<br>(0.0038)      | -8.0729***<br>(0.9326) | -1.6884***<br>(0.1635) | -7.7449***<br>(2.5864) | -0.7422***<br>(0.2352) | -0.1816<br>(2.0599)    | -0.0241<br>(0.2733)    | -10.5573***<br>(1.0083) | -2.1618***<br>(0.1698) | -9.8892***<br>(1.7557) | -1.9466***<br>(0.2871) |
| GREQuantPct                 |                             | 0.0848***<br>(0.0109)  | 0.0177***<br>(0.0020)  | 0.0690**<br>(0.0313)   | 0.0066**<br>(0.0029)   | 0.0617**<br>(0.0266)   | 0.0082**<br>(0.0034)   | 0.1188***<br>(0.0119)   | 0.0243***<br>(0.0020)  | 0.0974***<br>(0.0203)  | 0.0192***<br>(0.0035)  |
| Gender                      |                             | 0.0593<br>(0.1415)     | 0.0124<br>(0.0296)     | -0.5311<br>(0.3773)    | -0.0509<br>(0.0363)    | -0.1300<br>(0.3031)    | -0.0173<br>(0.0403)    | -0.0708<br>(0.1494)     | -0.0145<br>(0.0306)    | -0.0561<br>(0.2465)    | -0.0111<br>(0.0486)    |
| Demographic1                |                             | -0.2873<br>(0.1955)    | -0.0601<br>(0.0407)    | 0.2456<br>(0.6410)     | 0.0235<br>(0.0617)     | 0.4599<br>(0.4960)     | 0.0610<br>(0.0653)     | -0.7173***<br>(0.2061)  | -0.1469***<br>(0.0414) | -0.4344<br>(0.3668)    | -0.0855<br>(0.0718)    |
| Demographic2                |                             | -0.0791<br>(0.2150)    | -0.0165<br>(0.0450)    | 0.4982<br>(0.6312)     | 0.0477<br>(0.0606)     | 0.1980<br>(0.5096)     | 0.0263<br>(0.0675)     | -0.0743<br>(0.2199)     | -0.0152<br>(0.0450)    | 0.5745<br>(0.3821)     | 0.1131<br>(0.0743)     |
| AdvMath                     |                             |                        |                        | 0.2702<br>(0.3837)     | 0.0259<br>(0.0367)     | -0.0617<br>(0.3646)    | -0.0082<br>(0.0484)    |                         |                        | -0.1088<br>(0.2639)    | -0.0214<br>(0.0520)    |
| ComScore                    |                             |                        |                        | -0.0175<br>(0.0989)    | -0.0017<br>(0.0095)    | 0.0656<br>(0.0890)     | 0.0087<br>(0.0118)     |                         |                        | 0.1487**<br>(0.0684)   | 0.0293**<br>(0.0133)   |
| YearTransMat                |                             | 0.8006***<br>(0.1410)  | 0.1674***<br>(0.0277)  |                        |                        |                        |                        |                         |                        |                        |                        |
| $\bar{m}_2$                 | 1.4277***<br>(0.0007)       |                        |                        | -0.1255<br>(0.1679)    | -0.0120<br>(0.0159)    |                        |                        |                         |                        |                        |                        |
| $\overline{m_{2A}}$         |                             |                        |                        |                        |                        | -1.1005***<br>(0.1176) | -0.1461***<br>(0.0034) |                         |                        |                        |                        |
| $\sqrt{\text{MeanSqError}}$ | 0.0057***<br>(0.0005)       |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                         |                        |                        |                        |
| Obs   Pseudo-R <sup>2</sup> | 1000                        | 0.8919                 |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                         |                        |                        |                        |
| LL   Param   AIC            | -268.3                      | 37                     | 610.6                  |                        |                        |                        |                        |                         |                        |                        |                        |

Robust standard errors in parentheses: \*p<0.10, \*\*p<0.05, \*\*\*p<0.01.

# A4: Waitlist-Dynamic Restricted Estimates (Suboptimal)

Table 34a: Waitlist-Dynamic Restricted Estimates (Suboptimal)

|                             | FAdvMath               | FComScore              | F $\bar{m}_2$         | F $\bar{m}_{2A}$      | Cutoff1                | L(Cutoff) <sub>1</sub>     | Cutoff3                 | P(Cutoff) <sub>3</sub>     | Success              | Beta                  | Sigma                 |
|-----------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|------------------------|----------------------------|-------------------------|----------------------------|----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|
| Intercept                   | -6.2714***<br>(0.8340) | 0.8833<br>(0.7393)     | 5.4571***<br>(0.3633) | 0.1489***<br>(0.0018) | 0.3481***<br>(0.1172)  | 1.4164<br>(1.1258, 1.7820) | -15.2416***<br>(3.1088) | 13.00%<br>(3.20%, 40.28%)  | -8.5337*<br>(4.8648) |                       |                       |
| GREQuantPct                 | 0.0715***<br>(0.0099)  | 0.0575***<br>(0.0089)  | -0.0076*<br>(0.0045)  |                       |                        |                            |                         |                            | 0.0886<br>(0.0549)   |                       |                       |
| Gender                      | -0.0377<br>(0.1366)    | 0.3141***<br>(0.1187)  | -0.0582<br>(0.0637)   |                       |                        |                            |                         |                            | 0.1445<br>(0.2817)   |                       |                       |
| Demographic1                | 0.6097***<br>(0.1817)  | -1.5742***<br>(0.1549) | 0.0121<br>(0.0902)    |                       |                        |                            |                         |                            | -0.4893*<br>(0.2779) |                       |                       |
| Demographic2                | 0.0603<br>(0.2024)     | -1.3544***<br>(0.1782) | 0.0733<br>(0.0969)    |                       |                        |                            |                         |                            | -0.2386<br>(0.3301)  |                       |                       |
| AdvMath                     |                        | 0.9105***<br>(0.1212)  | 0.1148*<br>(0.0669)   |                       |                        |                            |                         |                            | 0.3908<br>(0.2501)   |                       |                       |
| ComScore                    |                        |                        | 0.0124<br>(0.0166)    |                       |                        |                            |                         |                            | 0.0421<br>(0.0642)   |                       |                       |
| YearTransMat                |                        |                        |                       |                       | -0.2401***<br>(0.0613) | 1.1140<br>(0.9659, 1.2848) |                         | 98.90%<br>(94.76%, 99.78%) |                      |                       |                       |
| $\bar{m}_2$                 |                        |                        |                       | 1.0524***<br>(0.0003) |                        |                            |                         |                            |                      |                       |                       |
| $\bar{m}_{2A}$              |                        |                        |                       |                       |                        |                            | 3.0950***<br>(0.5798)   |                            |                      |                       |                       |
| $\sqrt{\text{MeanSqError}}$ |                        | 1.8548***<br>(0.0394)  | 0.9791***<br>(0.0022) | 0.0041***<br>(0.0002) |                        |                            |                         |                            |                      |                       |                       |
| Beta                        |                        |                        |                       |                       |                        |                            |                         |                            |                      | 0.9506***<br>(0.2236) |                       |
| Sigma                       |                        |                        |                       |                       |                        |                            |                         |                            |                      |                       | 0.3633***<br>(0.0992) |
| Observations                | 1000                   |                        |                       |                       |                        |                            |                         |                            |                      |                       |                       |
| LL   Param   AIC            | -3726.6                | 36                     | 7525.3                |                       |                        |                            |                         |                            |                      |                       |                       |
| LR Stat   DF   P-Val        | 140.1329               | 16                     | 0.0000                |                       |                        |                            |                         |                            |                      |                       |                       |

Robust standard errors in parentheses: \*p<0.10, \*\*p<0.05, \*\*\*p<0.01. Confidence intervals are 95%.

►► Waitlist-Dynamic Unrestricted Estimates (Optimal)

# A4: Waitlist-Dynamic Restricted Estimates (Optimal)

Table 34b: Waitlist-Dynamic Restricted Estimates (Optimal)

|                             | FAdvMath               | FComScore              | F $\bar{m}_2$         | F $\bar{m}_{2A}$       | Cutoff1                | L(Cutoff) <sub>1</sub>     | Cutoff3                 | P(Cutoff) <sub>3</sub>     | Success                 | Beta                  | Sigma                 |
|-----------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|-----------------------|------------------------|------------------------|----------------------------|-------------------------|----------------------------|-------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|
| Intercept                   | -6.3855***<br>(0.8428) | 0.8895<br>(0.7565)     | 5.4674***<br>(0.3635) | -1.2247***<br>(0.0038) | 0.2728***<br>(0.0348)  | 1.3137<br>(1.2270, 1.4065) | -10.8886***<br>(3.3289) | 8.54%<br>(0.78%, 52.65%)   | -10.6373***<br>(1.6709) |                       |                       |
| GREQuantPct                 | 0.0729***<br>(0.0100)  | 0.0575***<br>(0.0091)  | -0.0080*<br>(0.0045)  |                        |                        |                            |                         |                            | 0.1086***<br>(0.0189)   |                       |                       |
| Gender                      | -0.0394<br>(0.1370)    | 0.3093***<br>(0.1191)  | -0.0477<br>(0.0637)   |                        |                        |                            |                         |                            | -0.3655<br>(0.2349)     |                       |                       |
| Demographic1                | 0.5960***<br>(0.1823)  | -1.5884***<br>(0.1549) | 0.0172<br>(0.0902)    |                        |                        |                            |                         |                            | -0.2786<br>(0.3409)     |                       |                       |
| Demographic2                | 0.0490<br>(0.2034)     | -1.3595***<br>(0.1787) | 0.0894<br>(0.0969)    |                        |                        |                            |                         |                            | 0.3797<br>(0.3233)      |                       |                       |
| AdvMath                     |                        | 0.9255***<br>(0.1216)  | 0.1356**<br>(0.0669)  |                        |                        |                            |                         |                            | -0.1450<br>(0.3226)     |                       |                       |
| ComScore                    |                        |                        | 0.0115<br>(0.0166)    |                        |                        |                            |                         |                            | 0.1492*<br>(0.0862)     |                       |                       |
| YearTransMat                |                        |                        |                       |                        | -0.1716***<br>(0.0352) | 1.1066<br>(1.0468, 1.1699) |                         | 95.42%<br>(87.56%, 98.40%) |                         |                       |                       |
| $\bar{m}_2$                 |                        |                        |                       | 1.4277***<br>(0.0007)  |                        |                            |                         |                            |                         |                       |                       |
| $\bar{m}_{2A}$              |                        |                        |                       |                        |                        |                            | 1.9267***<br>(0.4829)   |                            |                         |                       |                       |
| $\sqrt{\text{MeanSqError}}$ |                        | 1.8550***<br>(0.0393)  | 0.9791***<br>(0.0022) | 0.0057***<br>(0.0005)  |                        |                            |                         |                            |                         |                       |                       |
| Beta                        |                        |                        |                       |                        |                        |                            |                         |                            |                         | 0.9538***<br>(0.0337) |                       |
| Sigma                       |                        |                        |                       |                        |                        |                            |                         |                            |                         |                       | 0.2945***<br>(0.0281) |
| Observations                | 1000                   |                        |                       |                        |                        |                            |                         |                            |                         |                       |                       |
| LL   Param   AIC            | -3818.2                | 36                     | 7708.3                |                        |                        |                            |                         |                            |                         |                       |                       |
| LR Stat   DF   P-Val        | 64.0402                | 16                     | 0.0000                |                        |                        |                            |                         |                            |                         |                       |                       |

Robust standard errors in parentheses: \*p<0.10, \*\*p<0.05, \*\*\*p<0.01. Confidence intervals are 95%.



# A4: Waitlist-Dynamic Unrestricted Missing (Suboptimal)

Table 35a: Waitlist-Dynamic Unrestricted Missing (Suboptimal)

|                             | FStage1                |                        | FAdvMath              |                       | FComScore              | Fri <sub>2</sub>       | Fm <sub>2A</sub>      | Transition              |                        | Accept2               |                       | Accept3                |                        | Success                |                        |
|-----------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|------------------------|------------------------|-----------------------|-------------------------|------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|
|                             | Coef                   | AME                    | Coef                  | AME                   | Coef                   | Coef                   | Coef                  | Coef                    | AME                    | Coef                  | AME                   | Coef                   | AME                    | Coef                   | AME                    |
| Intercept                   | -6.3804***<br>(0.6106) | -2.0906***<br>(0.1572) | -3.4981*<br>(1.8860)  | -1.2239*<br>(0.6473)  | 2.8114<br>(2.6732)     | 7.2395***<br>(0.6887)  | 0.3539***<br>(0.0038) | -10.7082***<br>(1.0451) | -2.1055***<br>(0.1549) | 1.3743<br>(2.2965)    | 0.1762<br>(0.2928)    | 5.3172**<br>(2.3592)   | 0.6942**<br>(0.3037)   | -7.8194***<br>(1.7334) | -1.6624***<br>(0.3276) |
| GREQuantPct                 | 0.0661***<br>(0.0070)  | 0.0217***<br>(0.0019)  | 0.0396**<br>(0.0184)  | 0.0139**<br>(0.0063)  | 0.0394<br>(0.0258)     | -0.0260***<br>(0.0083) |                       | 0.1110***<br>(0.0119)   | 0.0218***<br>(0.0019)  | -0.0219<br>(0.0253)   | -0.0028<br>(0.0032)   | 0.0295<br>(0.0266)     | 0.0038<br>(0.0034)     | 0.0799***<br>(0.0206)  | 0.0170***<br>(0.0040)  |
| Gender                      | 0.2030**<br>(0.0880)   | 0.0665**<br>(0.0286)   | 0.1626<br>(0.1475)    | 0.0569<br>(0.0513)    | 0.6119***<br>(0.2188)  | -0.2034**<br>(0.1028)  |                       | 0.3464**<br>(0.1473)    | 0.0681**<br>(0.0286)   | 0.3963<br>(0.2997)    | 0.0508<br>(0.0386)    | -0.7544**<br>(0.3455)  | -0.0985**<br>(0.0441)  | -0.0159<br>(0.2373)    | -0.0034<br>(0.0504)    |
| Demographic1                | -0.1332<br>(0.1213)    | -0.0437<br>(0.0396)    | 0.6245***<br>(0.2084) | 0.2185***<br>(0.0703) | -1.2588***<br>(0.2771) | 0.0513<br>(0.1586)     |                       | -0.2141<br>(0.2039)     | -0.0421<br>(0.0400)    | -0.1504<br>(0.4588)   | -0.0193<br>(0.0589)   | -1.0906**<br>(0.5549)  | -0.1424**<br>(0.0711)  | -0.0979<br>(0.3742)    | -0.0208<br>(0.0795)    |
| Demographic2                | 0.2572*<br>(0.1321)    | 0.0843*<br>(0.0430)    | 0.0475<br>(0.2234)    | 0.0166<br>(0.0781)    | -1.2957***<br>(0.3259) | -0.0137<br>(0.1620)    |                       | 0.4383**<br>(0.2209)    | 0.0862**<br>(0.0431)   | 0.2732<br>(0.4721)    | 0.0350<br>(0.0604)    | -1.0075**<br>(0.5084)  | -0.1315**<br>(0.0663)  | -0.1905<br>(0.3793)    | -0.0405<br>(0.0805)    |
| AdvMath                     |                        |                        |                       |                       | 0.7506***<br>(0.2176)  | 0.0656<br>(0.1073)     |                       |                         |                        | 0.4923<br>(0.3247)    | 0.0631<br>(0.0415)    | 0.0398<br>(0.3583)     | 0.0052<br>(0.0467)     | 0.1438<br>(0.2554)     | 0.0306<br>(0.0543)     |
| ComScore                    |                        |                        |                       |                       |                        | 0.0369<br>(0.0261)     |                       |                         |                        | 0.0048<br>(0.0678)    | 0.0006<br>(0.0087)    | 0.1290<br>(0.0788)     | 0.0168*<br>(0.0102)    | 0.0328<br>(0.0577)     | 0.0070<br>(0.0122)     |
| YearTransMat                | 0.5997***<br>(0.0885)  | 0.1965***<br>(0.0266)  |                       |                       |                        |                        |                       | 1.0061***<br>(0.1491)   | 0.1978***<br>(0.0264)  |                       |                       |                        |                        |                        |                        |
| m <sub>2</sub>              |                        |                        |                       |                       |                        |                        | 1.0263***<br>(0.0007) |                         |                        | -0.3288**<br>(0.1479) | -0.0422**<br>(0.0187) |                        |                        |                        |                        |
| m <sub>2A</sub>             |                        |                        |                       |                       |                        |                        |                       |                         |                        |                       |                       | -1.5304***<br>(0.1678) | -0.1998***<br>(0.0074) |                        |                        |
| InvMills                    |                        |                        | -0.2289<br>(0.3545)   | -0.0801<br>(0.1241)   | -0.7304<br>(0.5361)    |                        |                       |                         |                        |                       |                       |                        |                        |                        |                        |
| √MeanSqError                |                        |                        |                       |                       | 1.8994***<br>(0.0682)  | 0.9581***<br>(0.0145)  | 0.0112***<br>(0.0005) |                         |                        |                       |                       |                        |                        |                        |                        |
| Obs   Pseudo-R <sup>2</sup> | 1000                   | 0.4934                 |                       |                       |                        |                        |                       |                         |                        |                       |                       |                        |                        |                        |                        |
| LL   Param   AIC            | -2023.1                | 60                     | 4166.3                |                       |                        |                        |                       |                         |                        |                       |                       |                        |                        |                        |                        |

Robust standard errors in parentheses: \*p<0.10, \*\*p<0.05, \*\*\*p<0.01.

# A4: Waitlist-Dynamic Unrestricted Missing (Optimal)

Table 35b: Waitlist-Dynamic Unrestricted Missing (Optimal)

|                             | FStage1                |                        | FAdvMath             |                      | FComScore              |     | Fm2                   |                       | Fm2A                   |     | Transition             |                        | Accept2                |                        | Accept3                |                        | Success                |                        |
|-----------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|----------------------|----------------------|------------------------|-----|-----------------------|-----------------------|------------------------|-----|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|
|                             | Coef                   | AME                    | Coef                 | AME                  | Coef                   | AME | Coef                  | AME                   | Coef                   | AME | Coef                   | AME                    | Coef                   | AME                    | Coef                   | AME                    | Coef                   | AME                    |
| Intercept                   | -4.8625***<br>(0.5540) | -1.6784***<br>(0.1650) | -3.3658*<br>(1.8728) | -1.1857*<br>(0.6491) | 1.8384<br>(2.4312)     |     | 6.2905***<br>(0.7189) |                       | -0.3093***<br>(0.0043) |     | -8.0678***<br>(0.9324) | -1.6875***<br>(0.1635) | -7.7385***<br>(2.5841) | -0.7415***<br>(0.2347) | -0.1808<br>(2.0591)    | -0.0240<br>(0.2734)    | -9.8861***<br>(1.7554) | -1.9462***<br>(0.2871) |
| GREQuantPct                 | 0.0510***<br>(0.0065)  | 0.0176***<br>(0.0020)  | 0.0419**<br>(0.0177) | 0.0148**<br>(0.0061) | 0.0420*<br>(0.0231)    |     | -0.0174**<br>(0.0086) |                       |                        |     | 0.0848***<br>(0.0109)  | 0.0177***<br>(0.0020)  | 0.0682**<br>(0.0312)   | 0.0065**<br>(0.0029)   | 0.0620**<br>(0.0266)   | 0.0082**<br>(0.0034)   | 0.0976***<br>(0.0203)  | 0.0192***<br>(0.0035)  |
| Gender                      | 0.0357<br>(0.0858)     | 0.0123<br>(0.0296)     | 0.0639<br>(0.1456)   | 0.0225<br>(0.0513)   | 0.2914<br>(0.1923)     |     | 0.0890<br>(0.1128)    |                       |                        |     | 0.0591<br>(0.1415)     | 0.0124<br>(0.0296)     | -0.5395<br>(0.3783)    | -0.0517<br>(0.0364)    | -0.1356<br>(0.3031)    | -0.0180<br>(0.0403)    | -0.0596<br>(0.2466)    | -0.0117<br>(0.0486)    |
| Demographic1                | -0.1721<br>(0.1174)    | -0.0594<br>(0.0404)    | 0.4192**<br>(0.1970) | 0.1477**<br>(0.0683) | -1.1334***<br>(0.2557) |     | 0.1101<br>(0.1627)    |                       |                        |     | -0.2879<br>(0.1955)    | -0.0602<br>(0.0407)    | 0.2533<br>(0.6433)     | 0.0243<br>(0.0619)     | 0.4261<br>(0.4952)     | 0.0566<br>(0.0654)     | -0.4539<br>(0.3662)    | -0.0894<br>(0.0716)    |
| Demographic2                | -0.0380<br>(0.1294)    | -0.0131<br>(0.0446)    | -0.0492<br>(0.2143)  | -0.0173<br>(0.0755)  | -0.8501***<br>(0.2867) |     | 0.1106<br>(0.1773)    |                       |                        |     | -0.0799<br>(0.2150)    | -0.0167<br>(0.0449)    | 0.5085<br>(0.6333)     | 0.0487<br>(0.0608)     | 0.1735<br>(0.5088)     | 0.0230<br>(0.0675)     | 0.5555<br>(0.3812)     | 0.1093<br>(0.0742)     |
| AdvMath                     |                        |                        |                      |                      | 1.0421***<br>(0.1961)  |     | 0.1118<br>(0.1240)    |                       |                        |     |                        |                        | 0.2795<br>(0.3842)     | 0.0268<br>(0.0368)     | -0.0581<br>(0.3645)    | -0.0077<br>(0.0484)    | -0.1045<br>(0.2639)    | -0.0206<br>(0.0520)    |
| ComScore                    |                        |                        |                      |                      |                        |     | 0.0053<br>(0.0312)    |                       |                        |     |                        |                        | -0.0174<br>(0.0989)    | -0.0017<br>(0.0095)    | 0.0645<br>(0.0889)     | 0.0086<br>(0.0118)     | 0.1478**<br>(0.0684)   | 0.0291**<br>(0.0133)   |
| YearTransMat                | 0.4862***<br>(0.0847)  | 0.1678***<br>(0.0277)  |                      |                      |                        |     |                       |                       |                        |     | 0.8004***<br>(0.1410)  | 0.1674***<br>(0.0277)  |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |
| $m_2$                       |                        |                        |                      |                      |                        |     |                       | 1.2910***<br>(0.0008) |                        |     |                        |                        | -0.1179<br>(0.1517)    | -0.0113<br>(0.0144)    |                        |                        |                        |                        |
| $m_{2A}$                    |                        |                        |                      |                      |                        |     |                       |                       |                        |     |                        |                        |                        |                        | -1.0993***<br>(0.1173) | -0.1460***<br>(0.0034) |                        |                        |
| InvMills                    |                        |                        | -0.3619<br>(0.4395)  | -0.1275<br>(0.1545)  | -0.0012<br>(0.5745)    |     |                       |                       |                        |     |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |
| $\sqrt{\text{MeanSqError}}$ |                        |                        |                      |                      | 1.7743***<br>(0.0631)  |     | 1.0532***<br>(0.0129) |                       | 0.0145***<br>(0.0006)  |     |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |
| Obs   Pseudo-R <sup>2</sup> | 1000                   | 0.4716                 |                      |                      |                        |     |                       |                       |                        |     |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |
| LL   Param   AIC            | -2143.9                | 60                     | 4407.8               |                      |                        |     |                       |                       |                        |     |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |                        |

Robust standard errors in parentheses: \*p<0.10, \*\*p<0.05, \*\*\*p<0.01.

# A4: Waitlist-Dynamic Restricted Missing (Suboptimal)

Table 36a: Waitlist-Dynamic Restricted Missing (Suboptimal)

|                      | FStage1                | FAdvMath              | FComScore              | Fm <sub>2</sub>        | Fm <sub>2A</sub>      | Cutoff1               | L(Cutoff) <sub>1</sub>     | Cutoff3                | P(Cutoff) <sub>3</sub>     | Success             | Beta                  | Sigma               |
|----------------------|------------------------|-----------------------|------------------------|------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|----------------------------|------------------------|----------------------------|---------------------|-----------------------|---------------------|
| Intercept            | -6.3854***<br>(0.6222) | -3.4955*<br>(1.8891)  | 2.8010<br>(2.7427)     | 7.1897***<br>(0.6891)  | 0.3539***<br>(0.0038) | 0.3447<br>(0.2369)    | 1.4115<br>(0.8873, 2.2456) | -15.2825**<br>(6.4479) | 12.63%<br>(1.76%, 53.89%)  | -8.1530<br>(7.7494) |                       |                     |
| GREQuantPct          | 0.0662***<br>(0.0071)  | 0.0397**<br>(0.0185)  | 0.0402<br>(0.0265)     | -0.0254***<br>(0.0083) |                       |                       |                            |                        |                            | 0.0841<br>(0.0876)  |                       |                     |
| Gender               | 0.2028**<br>(0.0882)   | 0.1634<br>(0.1475)    | 0.6180***<br>(0.2190)  | -0.2247**<br>(0.1027)  |                       |                       |                            |                        |                            | 0.1718<br>(0.3545)  |                       |                     |
| Demographic1         | -0.1360<br>(0.1214)    | 0.6339***<br>(0.2084) | -1.2499***<br>(0.2776) | 0.0656<br>(0.1587)     |                       |                       |                            |                        |                            | -0.4460<br>(0.2837) |                       |                     |
| Demographic2         | 0.2547*<br>(0.1322)    | 0.0562<br>(0.2229)    | -1.2917***<br>(0.3267) | -0.0198<br>(0.1621)    |                       |                       |                            |                        |                            | -0.2234<br>(0.3332) |                       |                     |
| AdvMath              |                        |                       | 0.7526***<br>(0.2176)  | 0.0283<br>(0.1074)     |                       |                       |                            |                        |                            | 0.2449<br>(0.2493)  |                       |                     |
| ComScore             |                        |                       |                        | 0.0398<br>(0.0261)     |                       |                       |                            |                        |                            | 0.0517<br>(0.0637)  |                       |                     |
| YearTransMat         | 0.6046***<br>(0.0900)  |                       |                        |                        |                       | -0.2388**<br>(0.1113) | 1.1117<br>(0.8544, 1.4464) |                        | 98.87%<br>(70.77%, 99.97%) |                     |                       |                     |
| m <sub>2</sub>       |                        |                       |                        |                        | 1.0263***<br>(0.0007) |                       |                            |                        |                            |                     |                       |                     |
| m <sub>2A</sub>      |                        |                       |                        |                        |                       |                       |                            | 3.0968**<br>(1.2801)   |                            |                     |                       |                     |
| InvMills             |                        | -0.2419<br>(0.3534)   | -0.7991<br>(0.5481)    |                        |                       |                       |                            |                        |                            |                     |                       |                     |
| √MeanSqError         |                        |                       | 1.9101***<br>(0.0695)  | 0.9584***<br>(0.0145)  | 0.0112***<br>(0.0005) |                       |                            |                        |                            |                     |                       |                     |
| Beta                 |                        |                       |                        |                        |                       |                       |                            |                        |                            |                     | 0.9496***<br>(0.0051) |                     |
| Sigma                |                        |                       |                        |                        |                       |                       |                            |                        |                            |                     |                       | 0.3621*<br>(0.2142) |
| Observations         | 1000                   |                       |                        |                        |                       |                       |                            |                        |                            |                     |                       |                     |
| LL   Param   AIC     | -2093.9                | 44                    | 4275.8                 |                        |                       |                       |                            |                        |                            |                     |                       |                     |
| LR Stat   DF   P-Val | 141.5488               | 16                    | 0.0000                 |                        |                       |                       |                            |                        |                            |                     |                       |                     |

Robust standard errors in parentheses: \*p<0.10, \*\*p<0.05, \*\*\*p<0.01. Confidence intervals are 95%.

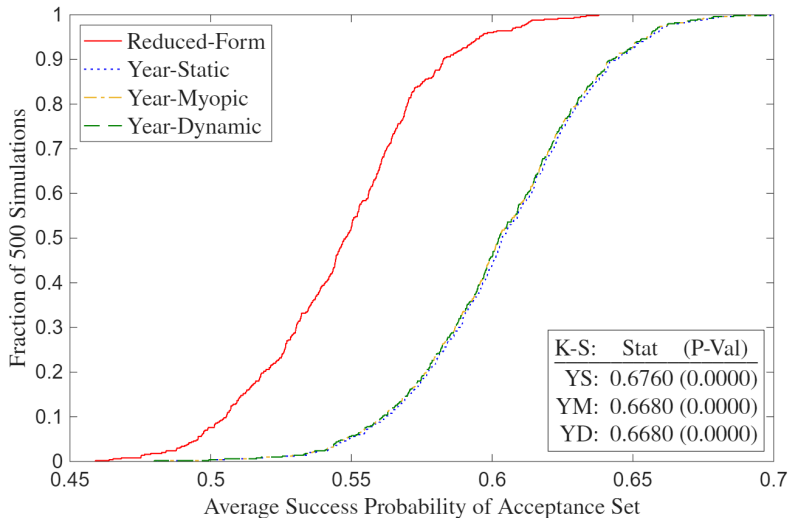
# A4: Waitlist-Dynamic Restricted Missing (Optimal)

Table 36b: Waitlist-Dynamic Restricted Missing (Optimal)

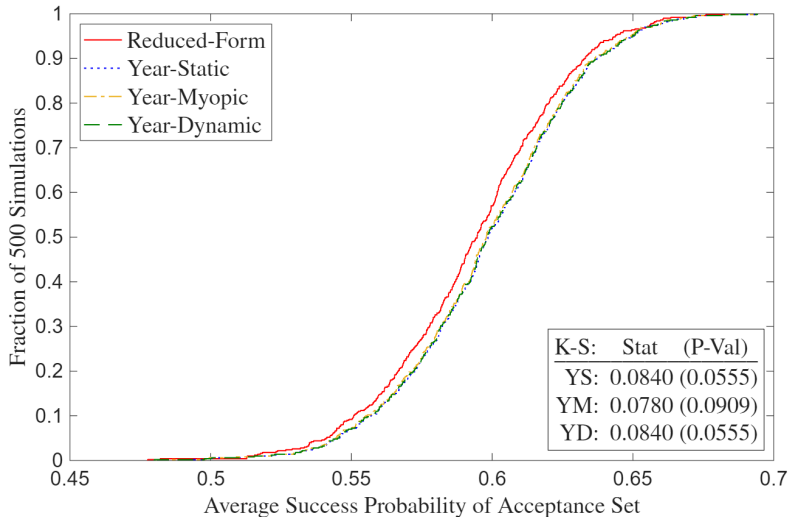
|                             | FStage1                | FAdvMath             | FComScore              | $\bar{m}_2$           | $\bar{m}_{2A}$         | Cutoff1                | $L(\text{Cutoff})_1$       | Cutoff3                 | $P(\text{Cutoff})_3$       | Success                 | Beta                  | Sigma                 |
|-----------------------------|------------------------|----------------------|------------------------|-----------------------|------------------------|------------------------|----------------------------|-------------------------|----------------------------|-------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|
| Intercept                   | -4.8616***<br>(0.5602) | -3.3608*<br>(1.8772) | 1.8102<br>(2.4663)     | 6.2650***<br>(0.7187) | -0.3093***<br>(0.0043) | 0.2697***<br>(0.0343)  | 1.3096<br>(1.2245, 1.4005) | -10.5162***<br>(2.4227) | 9.90%<br>(1.81%, 39.53%)   | -10.1044***<br>(1.7608) |                       |                       |
| GREQuantPct                 | 0.0510***<br>(0.0065)  | 0.0420**<br>(0.0177) | 0.0439*<br>(0.0235)    | -0.0171**<br>(0.0086) |                        |                        |                            |                         |                            | 0.1033***<br>(0.0203)   |                       |                       |
| Gender                      | 0.0360<br>(0.0858)     | 0.0631<br>(0.1459)   | 0.2795<br>(0.1928)     | 0.0906<br>(0.1128)    |                        |                        |                            |                         |                            | -0.3537<br>(0.2316)     |                       |                       |
| Demographic1                | -0.1719<br>(0.1174)    | 0.4208**<br>(0.1973) | -1.1529***<br>(0.2563) | 0.1064<br>(0.1627)    |                        |                        |                            |                         |                            | -0.2621<br>(0.3374)     |                       |                       |
| Demographic2                | -0.0379<br>(0.1294)    | -0.0463<br>(0.2148)  | -0.8508***<br>(0.2883) | 0.1103<br>(0.1773)    |                        |                        |                            |                         |                            | 0.3731<br>(0.3240)      |                       |                       |
| AdvMath                     |                        |                      | 1.0446***<br>(0.1986)  | 0.1079<br>(0.1240)    |                        |                        |                            |                         |                            | -0.1879<br>(0.3391)     |                       |                       |
| ComScore                    |                        |                      |                        | 0.0055<br>(0.0312)    |                        |                        |                            |                         |                            | 0.1416*<br>(0.0826)     |                       |                       |
| YearTransMat                | 0.4856***<br>(0.0851)  |                      |                        |                       |                        | -0.1701***<br>(0.0347) | 1.1047<br>(1.0451, 1.1677) |                         | 95.54%<br>(86.61%, 98.61%) |                         |                       |                       |
| $\bar{m}_2$                 |                        |                      |                        |                       | 1.2910***<br>(0.0008)  |                        |                            |                         |                            |                         |                       |                       |
| $\bar{m}_{2A}$              |                        |                      |                        |                       |                        |                        |                            | 1.8792***<br>(0.3680)   |                            |                         |                       |                       |
| InvMills                    |                        | -0.3751<br>(0.4435)  | -0.1080<br>(0.5806)    |                       |                        |                        |                            |                         |                            |                         |                       |                       |
| $\sqrt{\text{MeanSqError}}$ |                        |                      | 1.7658***<br>(0.0622)  | 1.0534***<br>(0.0129) | 0.0145***<br>(0.0006)  |                        |                            |                         |                            |                         |                       |                       |
| Beta                        |                        |                      |                        |                       |                        |                        |                            |                         |                            |                         | 0.9513***<br>(0.0058) |                       |
| Sigma                       |                        |                      |                        |                       |                        |                        |                            |                         |                            |                         |                       | 0.2923***<br>(0.0262) |
| Observations                | 1000                   |                      |                        |                       |                        |                        |                            |                         |                            |                         |                       |                       |
| LL   Param   AIC            | -2177.3                | 44                   | 4442.5                 |                       |                        |                        |                            |                         |                            |                         |                       |                       |
| LR Stat   DF   P-Val        | 66.7052                | 16                   | 0.0000                 |                       |                        |                        |                            |                         |                            |                         |                       |                       |

Robust standard errors in parentheses: \* $p < 0.10$ , \*\* $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\* $p < 0.01$ . Confidence intervals are 95%.

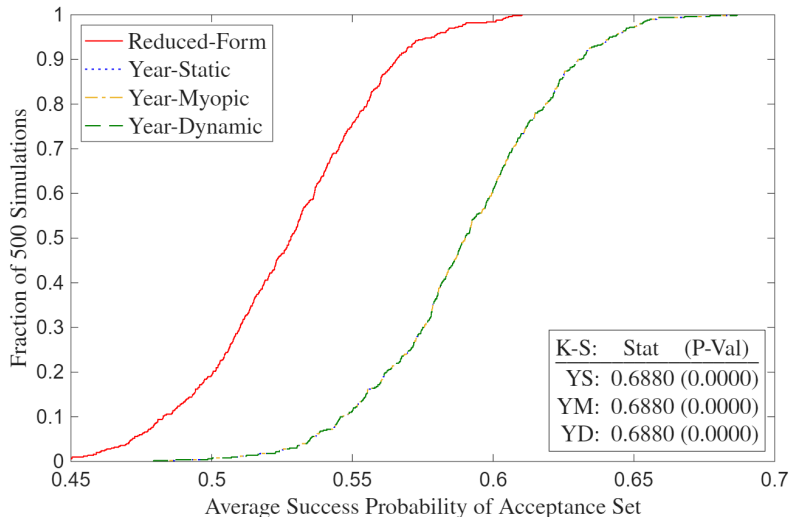
## A4: Full Deviation Gains (Suboptimal)



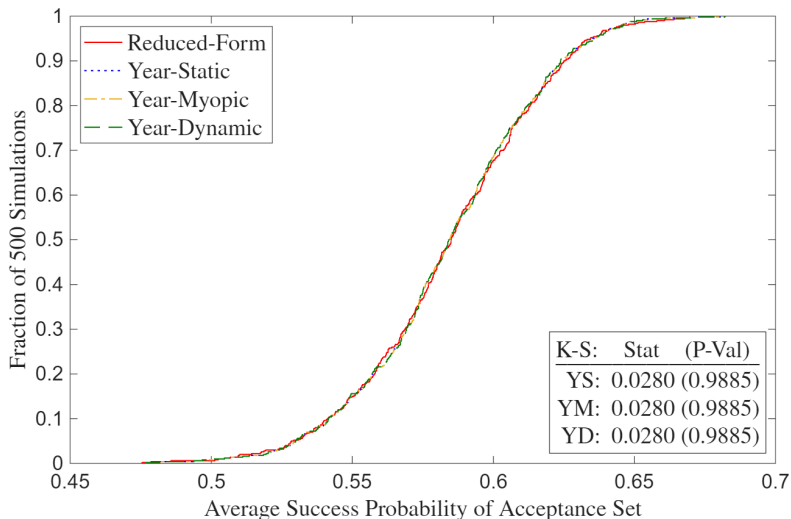
## A4: Full Deviation Gains (Suboptimal)



## A4: Deviation Gains Missing (Suboptimal)

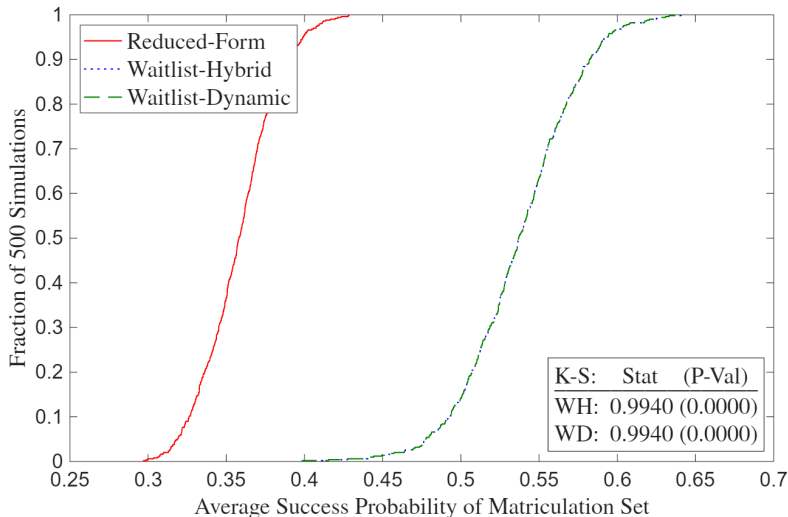


## A4: Deviation Gains Missing (Optimal)



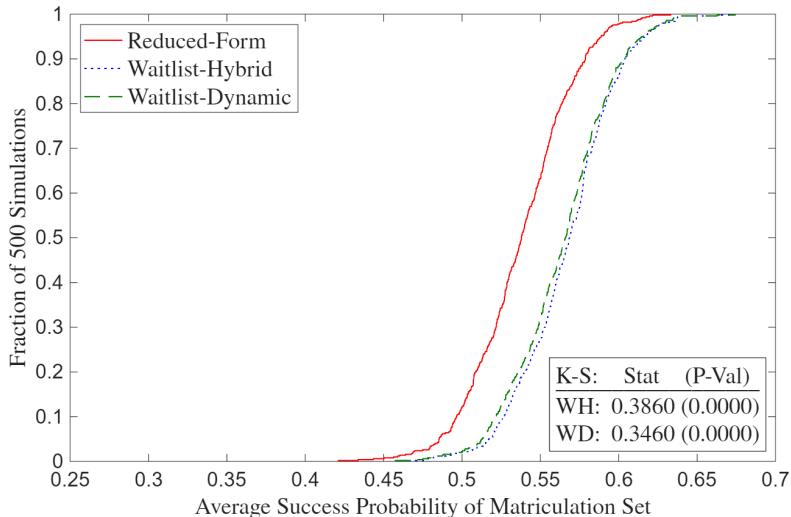


## A4: Full Waitlist Deviation Gains (Suboptimal)

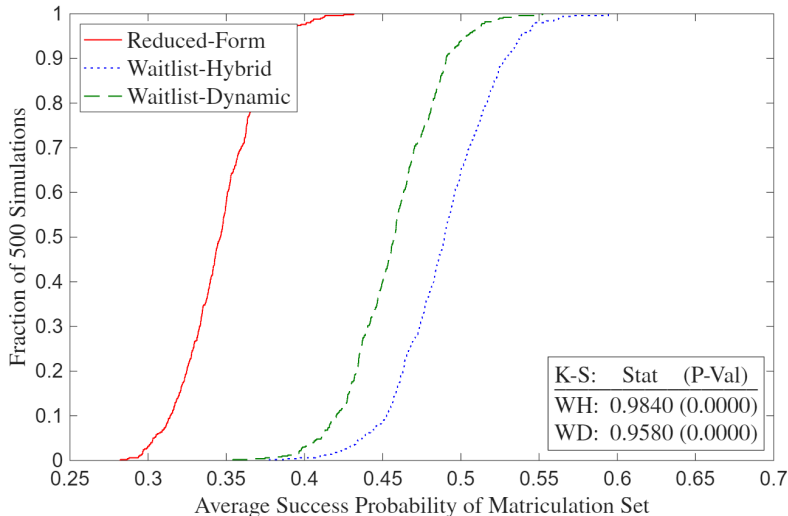


►► Highlighted Waitlist Deviation Gains (Suboptimal)

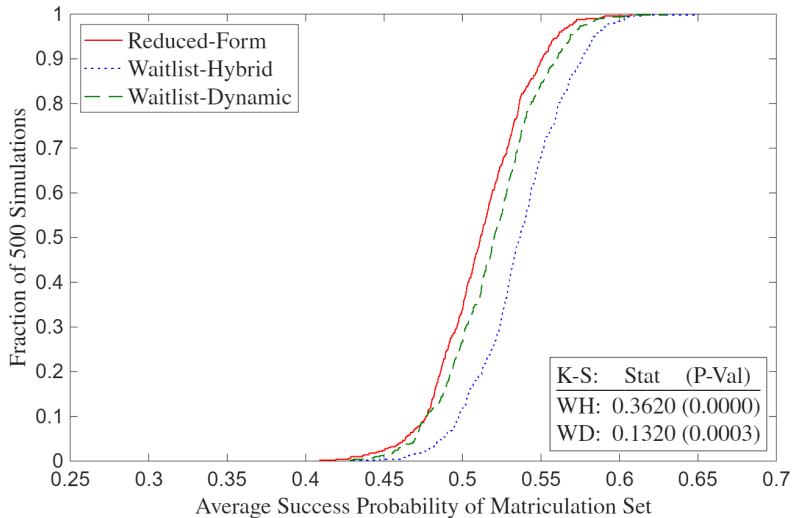
# A4: Full Waitlist Deviation Gains (Optimal)



## A4: Waitlist Deviation Gains Missing (Suboptimal)



## A4: Waitlist Deviation Gains Missing (Optimal)



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